



समृद्ध किसान खुशहाल राजस्थान

कृषि विकास से लेकर कृषकों के सम्मान तक
अन्नदाता के साथ राजस्थान सरकार



कृषि सुविधाओं का विस्तार

- 43,800 किलोमीटर कृषि भूमि की तारबंदी पर 482.46 करोड़ का अनुदान
- 72.36 लाख कृषकों को ₹122.66 करोड़ के निशुल्क बीज मिनिफिट वितरित
- पीएम कुसुम कंपोनेंट बी में 67,408 सोलर पंप के सेट की स्थापना पर ₹1134 करोड़ का अनुदान
- 50 हजार कृषकों को गोवंश से जैविक खाद उत्पादन हेतु गोवर्धन जैविक उर्वरक योजना के तहत प्रति कृषक ₹10 हजार की सहायता

किसान सम्मान निधि

- ₹11,008 करोड़ से अधिक राशि किसानों को हस्तांतरित
- योजना के तहत लगभग 71 लाख से अधिक कृषक परिवार लाभान्वित
- प्रधानमंत्री किसान सम्मान निधि योजना के तहत ₹6000 प्रति वर्ष की आर्थिक सहायता में मुख्यमंत्री किसान सम्मान निधि योजना के तहत ₹3000 वार्षिक की अतिरिक्त सहायता। इस प्रकार पात्र किसान परिवार को ₹9000 की वार्षिक आर्थिक सहायता

पशुपालन एवं डेयरी

- 1.03 लाख गोपालक परिवारों को ₹775 करोड़ तक ब्याजमुक्त ऋण
- मुख्यमंत्री मंगला पशु बीमा योजना के तहत 23.12 लाख पशुओं का निःशुल्क बीमा
- 1962 मोबाइल वेटेरिनरी सेवा से 64.17 लाख पशुओं का उपचार एवं 17.49 लाख से अधिक पशुपालक लाभान्वित
- मुख्यमंत्री दुग्ध उत्पादक सम्बल योजना में लगभग 5 लाख किसानों को ₹5 प्रति लीटर की दर से ₹1,401 करोड़ का अनुदान

गेहूं खरीद एवं बोनस

- गेहूं के समर्थन मूल्य ₹2,585 प्रति क्विंटल पर ₹150 अतिरिक्त बोनस
- वर्ष 2026-27 में 3.22 लाख किसानों से 27.12 लाख मैट्रिक टन गेहूं खरीद, ₹407 करोड़ बोनस का भुगतान

कृषि विकास

- 35,893 हजार से अधिक खेत तलाई (फार्म पॉण्ड) का निर्माण
- खेत तलाई निर्माण पर ₹328 करोड़ का अनुदान
- लगभग 99 हजार किसानों को पाइपलाइन स्थापना पर अनुदान
- 10.85 लाख वर्गमीटर शेडनेट हाउस स्थापित

फसल सुरक्षा

- प्रधानमंत्री फसल बीमा योजना में ₹9,657 करोड़ के बीमा क्लेम वितरित
- खरीफ 2025 में देश में सर्वाधिक 2.19 करोड़ फसल बीमा पॉलिसियां

सहकारिता एवं भंडारण

- किसानों को ब्याज मुक्त अल्पकालीन फसली ऋण ₹67 हजार करोड़ रुपए वितरित
- सहकारी समितियों के लगभग 10 लाख नए सदस्य बनाए गए
- 8,525 पैक्स का कम्प्यूटरीकरण
- 1,955 नई ग्राम सेवा सहकारी समितियों का गठन
- गांवों में आधुनिक कृषि गोदामों का निर्माण
- 242 श्रीअन्न (मिलेट) उत्पाद आउटलेट्स की शुरुआत

राजस्व एवं किसान सुविधा

- राजस्व न्यायालयों में 5.63 लाख मामलों का निस्तारण
- ग्रामीण सेवा शिविरों के माध्यम से लाखों राजस्व प्रकरणों का समाधान

UKRAINE'S MILITARY SAYS IT STRUCK RUSSIAN OIL REFINERY 1,300 KM AWAY

Kyiv seeks Patriot missiles as Russia hits Danube port

Romania scrambles jets as 'aerial target' enters its airspace

Reuters
August 13

RUSSIA STRUCK Ukraine's largest grain export port on the Danube Thursday, causing damage and starting a fire, authorities said, after President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned that Ukraine needed more US air defence missiles to get through winter.

The port of Izmail, near the Romanian border in Ukraine's southern region of Odesa, handles exports of grain and other commodities. The Izmail regional state administration said on Telegram the overnight strikes had damaged port infrastructure and taken out power in the southeast of the city.

Romania, a NATO and European Union member, scrambled two fighter jets on Thursday, its defence ministry said on X, when an 'aerial target' spent two minutes in Romanian airspace before leaving for Ukraine, where explosions were heard.

The attack on Izmail and record-low Danube water levels could complicate Ukraine's plans to use the river to ship grain to Europe.



Rescue workers at the site of a Russian drone strike in Odesa. REUTERS

A Russian naval blockade of Ukraine's Black Sea ports sent grain exports tumbling 76% year-on-year so far in August, Valeriy Tkachev, deputy head of state railway Ukrzaliznytsia's commercial department, said.

Ukraine is among the world's largest producers of wheat, corn and sunflower seeds and around 90% of its exports of such crops go through the Black Sea.

On Thursday, Ukraine's military said it struck an oil refinery and petrochemical complex in the Russian republic of Bashkortostan, about 1,300 km from Ukrainian border.

Zelenskyy said on Tuesday that Kyiv had handed proposals

to US negotiators for a plan to end the conflict, which started when Russia launched its full-scale war on Ukraine in February 2022. But there have been no signs so far of a resumption of peace talks.

Ukraine has repeatedly called for a ceasefire. Russia says it wants a settlement, but it must involve Ukraine fully ceding four regions Moscow claims - including land Russia does not yet control - something that Kyiv has refused to consider.

Late on Wednesday, Zelenskyy told CNN that Ukraine needs at least 5% of the current US stockpile of Patriot interceptor missiles to ward off surging Russian ballistic missile attacks.

Putin visits islands seized from Japan in World War II, draws Tokyo's ire

Tokyo: Russian President Vladimir Putin visited a disputed island close to Japan on Thursday prompting a strong condemnation from Tokyo, which said his actions had made any improvement of relations between the countries difficult.

The island, known in Russia as Iturup and in Japan as Etorofu, is one of four in the Kuril chain close to Japan's main islands seized by Moscow in the days after Japan's surrender in World War Two.

Tokyo has maintained its claim to them, making their return a condition for concluding a formal peace treaty that would unlock closer economic ties.

It "hurts the feelings of the Japanese people and is absolutely unacceptable," Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi said in a televised statement. "We hope that the Russian side will take the seriousness of this matter fully to heart," she added.

Ties between Moscow and Tokyo soured after Putin ordered the full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022. REUTERS

Israel sends troops into West Bank homes besieged by Jewish settlers

Settlers block families, cut water & power; US envoy calls it 'criminal'

Reuters
Qusra, August 13

ISRAELI TROOPS took up positions inside Palestinian homes in the occupied West Bank village of Qusra on Thursday, the mayor said, after settlers trapped Palestinian families this week in a siege Palestinians say is aimed at forcing them from their land.

The siege began during the weekend when Jewish settlers closed off the road to the three homes in the Palestinian village of Qusra and set up a tent in their front yards, refusing to allow anyone to enter or leave. The settlers had earlier cut off their electricity and water.

By Thursday evening, Israeli troops were still holding positions in three Qusra homes, according to the mayor Abed Al Athem Wadi.

In a statement, the military said soldiers had been deployed in Qusra since Thursday morning to protect residents and maintain security, and "were instructed the Qusra residents will

remain in their homes."

The military added that "soldiers will not operate inside the Palestinian family's home located near the site where the tent that was evacuated and dismantled had been erected". It was not immediately clear which of the three homes the military was referring to.

Loui Ridi, a Palestinian-American based in Ohio whose brother is besieged in his home, said that he felt helpless. "It is terrifying, frustration, fear of my family for their lives," he said.

The United Nations said in a statement that some 15 Palestinians including two children were trapped inside their homes with no water or electricity.

The US Ambassador to Israel, Mike Huckabee, said Israeli military and police "have gone at our request to remove the Israeli terrorists doing this," adding: "The actions of those doing this to this family's home is criminal."

Palestinians say Israeli authorities allow settlers to seize land and resources across the West Bank with impunity, including in areas where they hold Israeli-issued ownership documents.

The military has come under increasing pressure to halt rogue land seizures by settlers emboldened by the government of PM Benjamin Netanyahu.

• BRIEFLY

BANGLADESH

Ruling BNP nominates Mirza Fakhrul as presidential candidate



Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir . EXPRESS

Bangladesh Nationalist Party that our dedicated secretary general, Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir, has become the BNP's presidential candidate," he said. PTI

UNITED STATES

Judge dismisses Trump lawsuit against Harvard

A FEDERAL judge dismissed a lawsuit on Thursday by US President Donald Trump's administration that alleged Harvard University failed to protect Jewish and Israeli students from harassment. US District Judge Richard Stearns said the Trump administration's lawsuit, filed in March, had not plausibly shown an ongoing violation of federal civil rights law. AP

THE NETHERLANDS

Rotterdam port explosion kills 1, injures several

AN EXPLOSION at the Dutch port of Rotterdam on Thursday killed at least one person and injured several others, city police said. Police said the blast at Europe's biggest port occurred late Thursday morning and that a crime scene has been set up to try to establish what caused it, adding that the explosion "appears to be a workplace accident for time being." AP

'Bittersweet decision': Karoline Leavitt quits as WH press secretary

Associated Press
Washington, August 13

WHITE HOUSE press secretary Karoline Leavitt, the youngest person to hold the role, will leave the Trump administration at the end of the month to spend more time with her young family.

Leavitt, 28, called it a "bittersweet decision" in a social media post Wednesday shortly after President Donald Trump announced she would be stepping down. She recently returned to the White House podium after the birth of her second child, a daughter named Viviana, in May. She also has a 2-year-old son.

"The truth is since returning to the White House after the birth of my daughter, I have felt in my heart that I cannot be the best mom my two young children deserve while devoting the constant time, energy, and attention required of the White House Press Secretary — and that is why I have ultimately made the bittersweet decision to depart the White House and embark on a new chapter in my life," Leavitt wrote.

Trump did not outline plans for who might replace her in the high-profile role. He said in



White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt. FILE

a social media post of his own that her decision to leave is one "I totally understand and respect!" and indicated she would continue to play a role in his orbit.

"Karoline will now be one of my top outside advisors, and an influential voice within the Republican Party, as we work to defy History, and conclusively win the Midterm Elections," the president wrote.

Leavitt worked as a spokesperson for MAGA Inc., a super PAC supporting Trump, before joining his 2024 campaign. In 2022, she ran for Congress in New Hampshire, winning a 10-way Republican primary before losing the general election to incumbent Democratic Rep. Chris Pappas.

ADOPTED SEPARATELY 40 YEARS AGO

2 India-origin women in Netherlands discover they are sisters after DNA test

Reuters
s-Hertogenbosch, August 13

MEENA AND Minal were left as infants at orphanages in India and grew up in different adoptive families in the Netherlands, just a short drive apart. Now, 40 years later, a DNA test has shown that the childhood friends are biological sisters.

Growing up, neither was aware that they had a sister. Then, as teenagers in 1996, while living just 100 miles apart, they crossed paths at a gathering for adopted children and felt an unusually strong connection.

Their friends were amazed by their likeness and the girls swapped addresses. In correspondence, they jokingly called each other 'sis' before losing touch for 15 years.

"For years, I felt a hole in my heart," said Meena Geltink, 43, a mother of three, struggling to put words to her overwhelming feeling of joy. "It's like a missing puzzle piece has been found."

Geltink told her sister Tuesday at an emotional reunion in the Netherlands: "When I see



Meena Geltink (L) & Minal Tijssen

you, it's like I'm home."

Since discovering their relationship through a MyHeritage DNA test in April, which yielded a rare 100% match, the sisters spend hours every day talking and messaging.

Minal Tijssen, 44, said she had no record of any birth relatives. Tijssen, who lives in France with her partner and two sons, was sitting on the couch in April when a pop-up on her phone said her DNA results were in. "Mina: Sister. I couldn't believe it."

"We were friends before we were sisters," Tijssen said. "We were sisters the whole time, but we didn't know."

Who controls Strait of Hormuz? Competing claims by Iran and US

Reuters
Dubai, August 13

THE STRAIT of Hormuz is "under Iran's control and management", the recently appointed head of Iran's Basij paramilitary unit said on Thursday, a day after US President Donald Trump said the United States had "total control" of the strategic waterway.

Hossein Taeb said the US had sought to disrupt what he described as the Islamic Republic's popularity in the region by launching another war in the Strait of Hormuz, but had once more been defeated despite claiming Iran had neither an air force nor a navy.

"Today you see that the Strait of Hormuz is under the management and control of the Islamic Republic," Taeb said according to semi-official Fars news, adding that Iran was con-

tinuing on its course in complete security.

After the start of the war, which began with US-Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28, Tehran effectively shut the strait, through which a fifth of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas was previously shipped.

The US subsequently imposed a naval blockade on Iranian shipping and ports, while saying it would protect freedom of navigation for vessels travelling to and from non-Iran ports. In June, the two countries reached an interim agreement declaring a permanent ceasefire and calling for a swift return to freedom of navigation in Gulf.

The deal unravelled a few weeks later after Iran resumed limited attacks on vessels that it said were sailing contrary to the arrangements under the agreement, prompting the US to restart strikes on Iran.

Norwegian minister backs Iran's right to protect itself

Islamabad: Norwegian Foreign Minister Espen Barth Eide on Thursday backed Iran's right to protect itself as a state and expressed support for Pakistan's mediatory role in the ongoing US-Iran war as he held talks with Deputy PM Ishaq Dar and discussed bilateral cooperation and international developments.

He said that while Norway had "significant disagreements with Iran on other issues, they also have the right to be pro-

tected as a state".

During the meeting, both sides reviewed the whole gamut of bilateral cooperation.

"I also really want to reiterate our strong support for the very important role that Pakistan has taken in this dramatic war that started on February 28 with the US-Israel attack on Iran," Eide, who is on a two-day visit to Pakistan, said while talking to the media after delegation-level talks with Dar. PTI



Total Eclipse of the Sun

The moon completely covers the sun during a total solar eclipse as seen from the Galactica Centre, near the Javalambre Astrophysical Observatory in Arcos de las Salinas, near Teruel, Spain, on Thursday. REUTERS

Searched AI for ways to kill family: India-origin teen charged with murdering mother and brother in US

Press Trust of India
New York, August 13

A 17-YEAR-old Indian-origin boy has been charged with murdering his mother and younger brother in their suburban home in Massachusetts, officials said.

Arjun Aravind, a resident of Acton, has been charged with two counts of murder, two counts of assault and battery on a household or family member, two counts of assault and battery, use of a vehicle without authority, and theft of a motor vehicle in connection with the

deaths of his brother Siddharth Aravind, 14, and mother Sudha Venkatesan, 45.

It is alleged Arjun fatally assaulted his mother and brother inside their home on Tuesday before fleeing the scene. Both victims were found with "obvious trauma", but Chief Medical Examiner has yet to release information on the exact cause and manner of death.

Middlesex District Attorney Marian Ryan and Acton Police Chief Douglas Sturniolo said the deaths occurred on Tuesday inside the family's Martha Lane home in Acton, about 48

km from Boston.

Authorities said on Wednesday that shortly after 6.37 pm on August 11, Acton Police received a call from Arjun's father, who had been unable to reach his family members. A tutor who was expected at the home had been unable to make contact with anyone inside.

After arriving at the home, police found the two victims dead inside. Siddharth was found on the first floor and Sudha in the finished basement, authorities said. Arjun was not in the home and had fled in his mother's car, police said.



Farmer Maarten Janse drives his tractor on a drought-stricken wheat field in Wolphaartsdijk, the Netherlands, on Tuesday. AP

crop. His potatoes are used to make French fries for companies including McDonald's, but they're likely going to be too small this year.

"People want long fries," he says as he holds one of the pota-

atoes. "That's going to be tough this year."

Ten Cate is one of the lucky farmers because he is allowed to irrigate his crops. But, even so, he estimates his harvest this year will be down by about one-third

compared to average years. "It's not just the drought that is the problem," he says.

"It is also the sun, the dry air and especially the hot days we have had this year. The potatoes just can't handle that combination very well."

In Bosnia, where agriculture contributes roughly 5% of annual GDP and 10% of all employment, grain farmer Slavisa Lukic stood in one of his corn fields as stalks blew limply in the breeze.

His crops have been hit by repeated heat waves and drought conditions. He said this year's corn yield would be very poor, if he manages to harvest one at all. Lukic expects this year's corn yield will be around 1.5 to 2 tons per hectare.

The drought is even hitting

one of the Czech Republic's most famous products: beer.

Plezenský Prazdroj, the country's largest beer producer, expects to incur losses this year due to a stunted hops yield. Jakub Zaoral, the brewer's sustainability manager, said that changes in rainfall patterns - characterized by long periods of dryness with occasional heavy storms - mean that when rain does fall, it runs off the dry soil.

That results in inconsistent yields and increasingly low groundwater levels. "There's no choice but to simply accept the fact that one year will be great and the next won't be," he said.

"If it were to happen three times in a row, it could very well become an existential problem for hop growers," Zaoral added.

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The Indian EXPRESS

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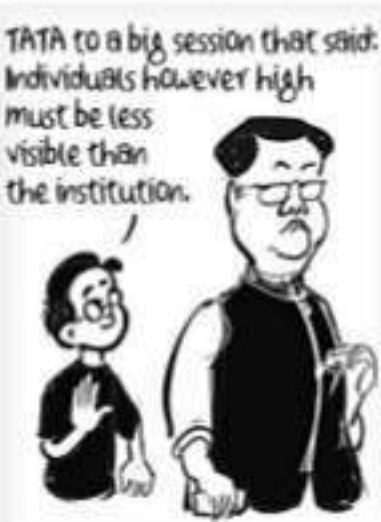
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Happening today

● **ELECTION WILL** be held for Karnataka Assembly Speaker and Council Chairperson.

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



INSIDE PAGES 8, 12
EMINENT HISTORIAN SUMIT SARKAR DIES AT 87

MELONI JIBE AT RAHUL EVENT AS HE MOCKS MODI; BJP HITS BACK

EXPRESS special

The other Jharkhand story: They fought odds, cleared prelims, but exam got cancelled

Over 2,000 who cleared JPSC Combined Civil Services prelims have to start over

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 13

THE JHARKHAND government's decision to cancel the 14th JPSC Combined Civil Services examination is being counted as a win by protesters in Ranchi. But for over 2,200 candidates who had cleared the prelims, the August 9 announcement spells a setback many say they may not recover from.

The Indian Express spoke to eight such aspirants — from an engineer who gave up a job, to an Adivasi woman who took time out from helping her father at work, to a wheelchair-bound aspirant who spent



Candidates who cleared prelims protest in Ranchi. SHUBHAM TIGGA

years preparing — who said that while they support strict action on paper leaks, cancelling an exam without a thorough probe defies logic.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Stormy Monsoon Session ends

NDA and Opposition MPs protest at Parliament on the last day of the Monsoon Session, Thursday. Both Houses passed 12 Bills during the session. PTI

REPORTS, PAGE 6

DU's revised History syllabus drops paper on Delhi Sultanate

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, August 13

STUDENTS PURSUING a post-graduate degree in History at Delhi University (DU) no longer have the option of choosing a course on the Delhi Sultanate, which examines how the medieval state was formed, how authority was exercised, and how political, religious and cultural life evolved, records reviewed by The Indian Express show.

The paper, "The Delhi Sultanate: Structures of Authority in Medieval North India (13th-14th Centuries)", which was being taught in Semester III,

E. EXPLAINED

Policy shift

There have been syllabus revisions at DU since it began restructuring programmes under the National Education Policy 2020. The post-graduate revision follows changes in DU's undergraduate programme from 2022-23 in line with the policy.

has been dropped from DU's newly notified syllabus, along with several other long-run-

ning courses on medieval, ancient and modern India.

Some of the other omissions in the third semester include papers on "History of North India, c. 1400-1550", "Gender and Women in Early India: 1500 BCE to 1000 CE", "Political Processes and Structure of Politics in Ancient India" and "Religion and Society in Ancient Indian Literature".

Official records show these courses were cleared at various stages of the syllabus approval process but did not figure in the final notification issued on August 7. Of the 38 Discipline

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 12

FADNAVIS ORDERS PROBE

Kirpan attack on Sukhbir in Maharashtra, assailant held



Akali Dal chief Sukhbir Singh Badal in Nanded district, Thursday. PTI

SAD chief sustains hand injury after he is attacked by man dressed as a Nihang

Express News Service
Chandigarh, Mumbai, Pune, August 13

SHIROMANI AKALI Dal president and former Punjab Deputy Chief Minister Sukhbir Singh Badal was injured Thursday in a kirpan attack by a man dressed as a Nihang at a gurdwara in Nanded in Maharashtra.

Sixty-four-year-old Badal sustained a hand injury and was taken to a local hospital for treatment — he was seen step-

ping out of a car with a cloth wrapped around his right hand. He was attacked at Gurdwara Mata Sahib Devan Ji, Mugat in Nanded.

His alleged assailant, identified by police as 62-year-old Jaspal Singh from Pune, was arrested.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, who ordered a probe into the incident, spoke to Badal and enquired about his well-being. CMO

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Protest against CJI: Bar Council blackballs NALSAR graduates, then rolls back order

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, August 13

HOURS AFTER it directed all state bar councils not to enrol any 2026 graduate from the NALSAR (National Academy of Legal Studies and Research)

University of Law, Hyderabad, as an advocate until further notice, the Bar Council of India (BCI) on Thursday withdrew its directive.

The controversy stems from a campaign by around 450 NALSAR students against in-

viting Chief Justice of India Surya Kant for the university's convocation.

"After thorough discussion, the members are of the unanimous view that as per the latest report, vast majority of the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Two-day summit celebration of spiritual succession on the occasion of 86th Independence Day

In the holy and ancient saintly lineage of Muni Kunjar, Agam Chakshu Adi Sagar Ankalikar Maharaj

Historic, wonderful, and divine Padarohan (Installation) ceremony of the unparalleled bearer of Shraman culture and supreme ascetic, revered Antarmana Acharya Shri 108 Prasanna Sagar Ji Maharaj by the visionary of Pushpagiri Tirth, Sonkatch, Ganacharya revered Acharya Shri 108 Pushpadant Sagar Ji Maharaj

Two-day Patta Vibhushan Mahotsav 15-16 August 2026

Pattacharya Padarohan of the visionary of 'Har Maas, Ek Upvaas' mega campaign for the welfare of the world, revered Antarmana Acharya Shri 108 Prasanna Sagar Ji Maharaj

Pattavibhushan Ritual Ceremony 15 AUGUST 2026 → Cultural Evening & Poetry recital

From 1.00 P.M. to 4.00 P.M.

Chanting of mantras, offering of scriptures and conferment of the Patta by revered Acharya Shri Pushpadant Sagar Ji Maharaj

Ancient scriptural procedure for the Pattacharya position

Spiritual address by the newly appointed Pattacharya

From 7:00 P.M.

Under the leadership of the Poet & Orator of the Era **Dr. Kumar Vishwas Ji**

Poetess Ms. Sakshi

Poet Mr. Deepak Danand

Poet Mr. Mahendra Madhur

Pattavibhushan Anointing Ceremony in the holy presence of saints

16 August 2026 : From 1:00 P.M. TO 4.00 P.M.

Yogirshi Swami Ramdev Ji Maharaj

Ayurveda Shiromani Acharya Balkrishna Ji Maharaj

Pandit Pradeep Ji Mishra renowned Shivakatha Narrator

Mahamandaleshwar Shri Premanand Puri Ji

Shri Mahesh Guruji renowned Shivakatha Narrator

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Watch worldwide live broadcast

Live worldwide broadcast of this two-day festival will be available on abp News, abp LIVE, Aastha TV, Sanskar TV, Dharmasandesh TV, Fasting Foundation page, Antarmana Channel, Adinath TV, Jinvani TV, and Paras TV as well as on their respective YouTube channels and Facebook pages.

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Kirpan attack on Sukhbir in Maharashtra, assailant held

sources said. Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde spoke to Badal's wife and MP Harsimrat Kaur who was present there when the attack took place — also accompanying the Badals were their three children.

District Collector Rahul Kardile said Badal was on a visit to Nanded. "When he was coming out of the Gurdwara Mata Sahib located at Mugat in Nanded, a sevadar at the location suddenly attacked him around 1.50 pm. A police sub-inspector of the Special Protection Unit tried to stop the attacker. Both Mr Badal and the sub-inspector sustained injuries in the attack. They have been admitted to a hospital and are out of danger. The sevadar is currently in police custody and further probe is on."

Superintendent of Police Neelabh Rohan said Jaspal Singh, the alleged assailant, had been placed under arrest. "Our probe suggests that the accused was born and brought up in Pune and had completed his LLB. He had been living in Nanded since 2023. Further investigation into the sequence of events and motive is currently underway."

Teams of the Pune City Police and Maharashtra Anti-Terrorism Squad conducted a search at Singh's house in the Pulgate area of Pune. "A joint search was conducted. His family members were home. They have been questioned. The information obtained in the search will be passed on to the team probing the attack," an officer said.

Sources said Singh used to work in Mumbai with a corporate firm and had retired in 2023. He then became a sevadar at the Nanded gurdwara.

According to the sources, Singh told police that it was not a planned attack, and that he pulled out his kirpan only when he saw Badal.

Earlier in the day, the Badals visited Takht Sachkhand Sri Hazur Sahib in Nanded. The SAD leader's team had shared photographs of the Badal couple, their two daughters, son and son-in-law.

Jharkhand

The notification for the examination was issued this January for 103 posts. The prelims were held on April 19, and the result was declared on July 2, with 2,204 candidates qualifying. But as allegations of irregularities emerged, the state government cancelled the exam, while the CID asked those who had cleared the prelims to submit carbon copies of their OMR sheets. According to sources, nearly 1,800 have done so.

For those who cleared the exam, cancelling it meant going through the process — and all the uncertainty that comes with it — yet again.

Quit a job for this

It was on July 22, three days before the Jharkhand Public Service Commission's 14th Combined Civil Services Main examination was to begin, that Ajit Kumar and his wife Neha Kesari were on a train from Maharashtra, heading to Jharkhand.

They had cleared the preliminary examination and were optimistic about the mains, scheduled from July 25 to 27. For the

couple, the journey was not just another trip home; it was the next step in a plan they had spent years preparing for.

Then, somewhere around Madhya Pradesh, Ajit opened WhatsApp and read a message that shocked him: the JPSC examination had run into trouble over alleged irregularities involving an OMR sheet.

"At first, I didn't believe it and went to JPSC website to check. It clearly said the JPSC 14th mains had been postponed," Ajit, 32, told *The Indian Express*.

A B.Tech graduate from Hazaribagh in 2015, Ajit had moved through a series of private-sector jobs — and even started his own coaching venture — before finally deciding to prepare for competitive exams. In 2024, he cleared prelims but could not get through the mains. "I began preparing again and cleared the 14th JPSC prelims," he said.

After the results were declared on July 2, Ajit quit his private-sector job in Maharashtra to focus on mains. But cancellation meant something bigger than merely starting from scratch — it meant loss of another precious opportunity for the family.

"I made it to the interview stage of the 7th-10th JPSC exam-

ination but did not make it through, so this was a second chance," Neha said. "Even travelling for this examination was expensive: due to time constraints, Ajit eventually took a flight that cost him Rs 30,000. After the exam was cancelled, dono ek doosre se silent ho gaye us din se (we've been silent towards each other since then)."

After the exam was cancelled, Ajit began mobilising over 200 aspirants against the decision. The group is now holding meetings to decide its next course of action.

First in her family

For Adivasi woman Madhuri Aind, 26, clearing the JPSC exam would have meant fulfilling a dream she had fought for against all odds. Madhuri and her family scraped a living selling household items from a thela (handcart) in Ranchi, where they had moved a few years ago in search of work.

Studying for JPSC was challenging: unlike many others who took coaching, she used the few resources at her disposal, such as state libraries and the internet. The shock of the cancellation, therefore, hit her hard.

"I feel like I am becoming hopeless. I have worked so hard to reach this stage. I had already cleared the 2025 JPSC backlog and the 14th JPSC prelims. With these exams now cancelled, I don't know how long it will take me to regain confidence."

It's a feeling that Anamika Tiwari, a wheelchair-bound aspirant, shares.

"For someone who is in a wheelchair and often has to depend on others, reaching this stage is extremely difficult. When such a person gathers the courage to prepare for and clear an examination of this scale, and then it gets cancelled, it becomes a massive challenge, not only physically but also mentally," she said.

The frustration is not limited to those who fear losing a first breakthrough; it also runs through candidates who have already spent years navigating the state's long recruitment process. Among them is Kunal Prasad, a 31-year-old Hazaribagh resident with a master's degree in Economics from Indira Gandhi National Open University.

This year's prelims were Prasad's second attempt — in his first in 2016, he cleared the prelims but could not get through the mains.

"I deliberately changed from science to the humanities so I could crack the civil services. Natural justice dictates that those who had not committed any wrongdoing should not be made to suffer for the actions of others," he said.

Some journeys are longer than others. Among them is 38-year-old Pradeep Ram Lohra.

Lohra began preparing for government exams after graduating in 2009. While he cleared the prelims, mains and interview of the sixth JPSC exam in 2016, the exam eventually became entangled in a legal dispute over merit list. Supreme Court eventually ordered a revised merit list, leaving him out and forcing him to retake the test.

For women aspirants, who already face social and personal pressures beyond the exam itself, the cancellation adds another layer of complication.

"If I fail because I was not good enough, I will accept it," said 26-year-old Roshni Sinha. "But now it feels like my hard work will be wasted because of someone else." In Dumka, 31-year-old Sweta Marandi agrees. "I quit my job in January to study for the exam," said Marandi, a former librarian. "When I saw my result, I cried. It felt like a huge achievement. Now, I have to look at other job options."

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BCI

students of NALSAR (2026 passout students) are innocent and they were not inclined to take part in the move of disrespect," the BCI said in its revised directive.

"Accordingly, the Council modifies the order of Chairman with regard to the ban on the enrolment of the NALSAR students with the State Bar Councils. All the students will be entitled to get enrolled with the State Bar Councils of their choice," it said.

The BCI said it would await the NALSAR Vice-Chancellor's "inquiry report" before taking any further action. "No student shall be made to suffer without any fault on his part," it said, adding that "a handful of teachers and outsiders were instrumental in instigating the innocent students".

In its earlier directive on Thursday, the BCI directed all state bar councils not to enrol any 2026 graduate from NALSAR as an advocate until further notice.

The apex regulatory body for the legal profession sought a "factual report about the persons instrumental in initiating, organising, or mobilising the campaign" opposing the CJT's participation in the convocation.

It asked the V-C to submit a report within three days, including a "complete copy of the representation, petition, memorandum or other communication submitted to the university authorities concerning the proposed participation or invitation (of the CJT)... and the complete list of signatories available in the official records of the university".

It also asked the university to identify those who were principally involved in initiating,

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will have to consider whether drafting, circulating, coordinating, or mobilising the campaign; communicating with the media; administering online groups used for coordination; or issuing calls for boycott, obstruction, or disruption.

While stating that it wasn't yet disqualifying any graduate under Section 24A of the Advocates Act, it cautioned that enrolling those whose conduct remains under active examination could "create a fait accompli and render the examination ineffective".

The BCI said it had taken note of reports and material in the public domain concerning "an organised campaign" against the CJT's proposed participation. "A student of law, having no regard or respect for the highest judicial office of the country, is not expected to be a responsible or sensible advocate, teacher or a judge. Such persons shall always be a liability on the profession," it said.

It further alleged that "groupism and dirty politics" among some members of the academic staff played an active role in "misleading, instigating and misguiding the students".

The BCI noted a "material distinction between legitimate expression and conduct which involves organised intimidation, coercion, personal vilification, disruption, obstruction or an organised call for boycott directed against a constitutional functionary or an institutional programme".

Both the directives were addressed to the NALSAR V-C and "Secretary, All State Bar Councils", and signed by BCI Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra.

In a statement issued at night, NALSAR said it had received both letters from the BCI, adding that the V-C had been asked to submit an inquiry report. "Given the nature of the request, the University

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In full bloom

Amrit Udyan, a garden located inside the Rashtrapati Bhavan complex in New Delhi, is scheduled to open to the public on Sunday. Indigenous and native flowering plants will be the major attraction. ABHINAV SAHA

CJP’S JANTAR MANTAR PROTEST

SC to hear plea on police use of face recognition tech, sharing data of protesters

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 13

THE SUPREME Court on Thursday agreed to hear a plea filed by a Rajya Sabha MP challenging the Delhi Police’s use of facial recognition technology to monitor protesters, including the collection and sharing of their biometric data with private companies, during the recent protest at Jantar Mantar by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) over NEET-UG irregularities.

A three judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant changed the plea filed by CPI(M) Rajya Sabha MP A A Rahim with pending petitions over CJP protest.

Appearing for Rahim, senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy said the besides the use of facial recognition against protesters, the data has been shared with two private companies.

“One maps your face, and one is a vehicle. So, spectacles are used and a vehicle is also used. And the data is taken without permission. These private companies host the data, in violation of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, CrPC, etc,”



The protest last month. FILE

Guruswamy told the bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The bench said it would hear the petition along with other related matters. The court is already seized of petitions raising the legality of use of facial recognition technology and biometric information to profile people during the Jantar Mantar protest.

The petitioners have contended that the use of facial recognition technology violates the SC’s 2017 judgment in K S Puttaswamy vs union of India, which held that any infringement of the Right to Privacy must be authorised by law, pursue a legitimate

aim, and be proportionate to the objective sought to be achieved.

In his plea, Rahim said the Delhi Police’s standing orders governing protests, and the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act, 2022, do not authorise the biometric surveillance of persons in civilian assemblies. It added that automated extraction and matching of protesters’ biometric identifiers was done and matched with permanent national criminal databases.

The Delhi Police had told the SC earlier that its surveillance had found that 2,873 individuals, who have cases of murder, rape and child abuse lodged against them, visited the Jantar Mantar during the protest in July.

After apprehensions were raised that personal information and digital data of the protesters recorded by the police may be used to harass them, the SC, on July 28, asked the authorities to ensure it is preserved and not brought into the public domain for the time being. Also, while directing the release of detained minors, the SC had said no coercive action should be taken against the students.

Noida homebuyers’ money diverted to F1 track, e-way by Jaypee Infra: ED

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 13

MONEY COLLECTED from Jaypee homebuyers allegedly went to a Formula One track, a hospital company, a charitable trust and an expressway, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) told the Delhi High Court Tuesday.

While Rs 32,825 crore was collected from 25,000 homebuyers in Noida and Greater Noida, Rs 13,833 crore was allegedly diverted to these entities, the agency said — meaning 42 paise of every rupee collected did not go towards construction.

The central probe agency, represented by standing counsel Rahul Tyagi, made these submissions during the bail hearing of Manoj Gaur, the former CMD of Jaypee Infratech Ltd. (JIL).

Gaur was arrested by the ED last November in connection with a 2018 money laundering case involving the alleged diversion of Rs 13,800 crore of homebuyers’ money.

After hearing the ED’s submissions, Justice Purushendra Kumar Kaurav observed that “no prima facie” case for bail was made out for Gaur. “Mr Tyagi, are you saying Rs 13,000 crore? That is too big an amount... prima facie, no case for bail is made out,” the court said, adding that a custody period of merely

nine months could not, prima facie, weigh in favour of Gaur’s release.

The ED claimed the diverted money travelled along six channels, each of them to an entity that Gaur himself controlled.

“Gaur drew Rs 48.91 crore in salary from Jaiprakash Associates Ltd. (JAL) between 2009-10 and 2021-22, years in which the company was making losses, at a peak of 93 times the median pay of its own employees,” Tyagi submitted before the High Court.

The arguments on bail will now be heard on August 18. Gaur is expected to reply to the ED’s submissions.

The case against Gaur and Jaypee Infratech began after homebuyers of Jaypee Wishtown and Jaypee Greens projects filed complaints with the Economic Offences Wings (EOW) in Delhi and UP.

According to the ED’s prosecution complaint filed in January against Gaur, the two companies, JAL and JIL, collected over Rs 33,000 crore for the construction and completion of residential projects in Noida and Greater Noida, but allegedly diverted close to Rs 13,000 crore for other purposes.

According to the ED, homebuyers’ money was allegedly diverted to Jaypee Group subsidiaries

and other group entities: Jaypee Healthcare Ltd, Jaiprakash Sewa Sansthan and Jaypee Sports International Ltd, used for construction of the Yamuna Expressway and routed to entities controlled by Gaur.

Major properties that remain incomplete are in the Jaypee Greens Wishtown complex in Noida. Most properties in the project, which is centred in Sector 128 and is spread across Sectors 129, 131, 133, and 134, were booked in 2011.

Petition in SC

Vandana Sabharwal, who booked a flat in the Kasablanca project at Jaypee Wishtown in Noida’s Sector 128, has filed a writ petition in the Supreme Court seeking a court-monitored investigation in the case.

She said her home is nowhere in sight and she hasn’t got her money back either. She also cited the ED’s “inaction” and alleged collusion between various authorities in her petition.

“After over seven years, only Rs 400 crore has been provisionally attached, which amounts to approximately 2.9 paise in every rupee diverted,” the petition states.

The Supreme Court issued notice and sought the ED’s response to the petition. The matter will now be heard on September 3.

Liquor ‘scam’: CBI re-narrating evidence, say Kejriwal, Sisodia

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 13

AAP LEADERS Arvind Kejriwal and Manish Sisodia have told the Delhi High Court that the Central Bureau of Investigation’s challenge to their discharge in the alleged liquor policy case does not point to any “perversity” in the trial court’s order, but merely seeks to ‘re-examine and re-narrate’ evidence already tested by the court.

In February, a trial court had discharged 23 accused in the case, including the two AAP leaders. In its observations, it also pointed to a “shoddy probe” by the CBI.

The CBI then moved the Delhi HC with a criminal revision plea challenging the discharge. Kejriwal and Sisodia also moved applications seeking the dismissal of the probe agency’s challenge.

Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma, who was earlier dealing with the plea, had stayed the trial court’s recommendation for action against the CBI’s investigating officer in the case.



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EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 JUNE, 2026

S. No.	Particulars	(₹ in lakhs except earning per share)							
		Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended		Year Ended		Quarter Ended		Year Ended	
		30 June, 2026	31 March, 2026	30 June, 2025	31 March, 2026	30 June, 2026	31 March, 2026	30 June, 2025	31 March, 2026
		Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total income from operations	91.82	-	-	-	4,629.24	7,500.39	5,023.89	24,526.25
2	Net profit/(loss) for the period before tax and exceptional items	(12.34)	13.19	(19.86)	(41.84)	(453.13)	(365.43)	126.45	51.86
3	Net profit/(loss) for the period after tax and exceptional items	(12.34)	13.19	(19.86)	(42.09)	(441.34)	(267.38)	87.29	20.18
4	Total comprehensive income/(loss) for the period (comprising profit/(loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax))	(12.34)	13.19	(19.86)	(42.09)	(436.03)	(231.56)	82.43	41.42
5	Paid-up equity share capital (face value of ₹ 1 each)	3,290.00	3,290.00	3,143.55	3,290.00	3,290.00	3,290.00	3,143.55	3,290.00
6	Earnings per share in rupees (quarterly not annualised)								
	Weighted average number of equity shares of ₹ 1 each	32,90,00,000	31,44,35,247	31,43,55,000	31,44,35,247	32,90,00,000	31,44,35,247	31,43,55,000	31,44,35,247
	- Basic (in ₹)	(0.00)	0.00	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.13)	(0.09)	0.03	0.01
	- Diluted (in ₹)	(0.00)	0.00	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.13)	(0.09)	0.03	0.01

Notes:

1 The above results were reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee & approved by the Board of Directors of Kamdhenu Ventures Limited at their respective meetings held on 13 August, 2026. The Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated financial results for the quarter ended 30 June, 2026 have been limited reviewed by the Statutory Auditors of the company, and they have issued audit report with unmodified opinion on the above results.

2 The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited standalone and consolidated quarterly ended 30 June, 2026 results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the unaudited financial results are available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com and on the company website www.kamdhenupaints.com

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of Kamdhenu Ventures Limited

Sd/-
Saurabh Agarwal
Managing Director
DIN: 00005970

Place: Gurugram
Date: 13 August, 2026







Personnel of the armed forces during the full-dress rehearsal for the 80th Independence Day, at Red Fort in New Delhi on Thursday. TASHI TOBGYAL

Delhi Master Plan: 40 lakh homes, more rental housing and smaller flats proposed

Gayathri Mani

New Delhi, August 13

THE MUCH-AWAITED Delhi Master Plan 2047 projects that the Capital will need about 40 lakh additional homes by 2047, as population growth, smaller households and continued urban expansion put pressure on the city's housing stock.

Officials said that affordable housing is set to become a central part of the policy, with public and private developers encouraged to build smaller homes ranging from 25 to 60 sq m of carpet area. "The approach is intended to make housing more accessible while allowing developers to fit more homes onto scarce land," an official said.

The plan also proposes incentives for private developers who can develop hostels for students and young workers, dormitories with shared accommodation to keep rents low, and dedicated worker housing for labourers.

The master plan's housing

strategy seeks to tackle Delhi's projected shortage on two fronts — adding new homes while squeezing more capacity out of existing residential areas. It places affordable and rental housing at the centre of the approach, with smaller homes, land pooling and higher densities around public transport hubs expected to generate much of the new supply.

Multi-pronged housing strategy

The plan outlines a multi-pronged approach to closing the gap: building new homes, redeveloping existing residential areas, regenerating existing neighbourhoods and expanding affordable rental housing. It also proposes expanding housing options across income groups and ownership and rental models. "...while promoting an enhanced built environment with improved safety, livability, and quality of life," the plan said.

Affordable housing would be the priority, with the plan

● New Master Plan: Key highlights

40 lakh homes needed by 2047

- **25-60 sqm** affordable homes proposed
- **30 lakh** units possible through land pooling & TOD
- **Rental housing** for students, workers and labourers

calling for serviced land — equipped with roads, water and sewerage — to support new development and giving private developers a major role in building the homes.

Officials said the plan proposes new housing in land-pooling areas, where multiple landowners can combine their land for development; Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) zones around Metro stations and other major public-transport hubs; and both high-den-

sity corridors and low-density areas (LDA). "...public agencies will primarily act as facilitators," the official said.

"At the same time, existing housing areas shall be regenerated and upgraded to improve the quality of the built environment, infrastructure and public amenities. This shall include employer housing, resettlement colonies, cooperative group housing societies and housing developed by the DDA," the plan said.

Officials highlighted that the government sees land-pooling and transit-oriented areas as major sources of new housing, including smaller homes, with the potential to add about 30 lakh housing units.

The plan also aims to increase the housing supply by redeveloping existing neighbourhoods and allowing greater density; and proposes regeneration for the renewal of planned residential areas, including Delhi Development Authority housing, cooperative housing societies, employer-

provided housing and resettlement colonies. "Regeneration will enable optimal utilisation of land to create new housing, and improve the quality of existing housing stock," the plan said.

Curbing illegal colonies, construction

The plan also emphasises on prevention of further growth of unauthorised colonies and illegal construction. "Disincentives such as levying prohibitive property tax, higher electricity charges, higher water charges, etc. may be considered by the local bodies to curb unauthorised construction... Use of eco-friendly materials, innovative construction technology and disaster resilient structures shall be encouraged for sustainability and time-bound delivery," it said.

On unauthorised colonies, the plan said regeneration would facilitate "development of proper road network, open spaces, facilities and accessibility to emergency vehicles, fire

tenders etc".

Further, the plan highlighted that a large number of residents in such colonies live in rental accommodation and that regeneration could facilitate greater availability of rental housing. "...Area Improvement Plan for the Urban Villages shall be prepared by the concerned local body. Many of the urban villages are of heritage importance and shall adopt a mix of regeneration and conservation strategies," it said.

The plan proposes in-situ rehabilitation of notified JJ clusters, wherever feasible, while relocation to vacant Economic Weaker Section housing. "Only notified JJ clusters shall be improved through in-situ slum rehabilitation or any other area improvement schemes (private/government), wherever feasible. Relocation to available vacant EWS stock or other alternate site may be considered for in-situ rehabilitation/upgradation or as part of city level slum improvement strategies," it said.

14 days, two road accidents, one target: Delhi Police cracks revenge plot that's 27 years old

Sakshi Chand

New Delhi, August 13

FIRST CAME a Hyundai i10, bearing down on the scooter of 46-year-old Deepak Dabas on an Outer Delhi road on July 2. Fourteen days later, a Scorpio came for him again. While the first accident left Deepak injured, the second left him dead — and, police say, exposed a 27-year-old village rivalry that had turned into a planned revenge killing.

A resident of Majra Dabas, Deepak was near Prem Pyau Road on July 2 when the Hyundai i10 allegedly hit his scooter. He survived after falling into a farm, escaping with injuries.

On July 16, he was allegedly hit by a Scorpio near Chandpur Majra Road. A PCR call was received at Kanjhawala police station and officers found Deepak dead. His damaged scooter lay about 100 m away.

What caught attention of the police were tyre marks on his chest and legs. Police suspected the Scorpio had not simply struck him once but had been driven over him repeatedly. "Usually, when someone is run over, there are only one set of tyre marks. In this case, there were multiple tyre marks, as if someone had repeatedly run him over," an officer privy to the investigation said.

What initially appeared to be two road accidents was subsequently investigated as a planned killing, resulting in the arrest of five persons — main conspirator Pawan alias Jagpal Dabas, Sagar Kala, Atul alias Monty, Sahil and Prince alias Tili.

The roots of the alleged revenge went back 27 years. Police said Deepak had allegedly misbehaved with Pawan's sister, all residents of the same village. Pawan's uncle's son, Rajpal, had then allegedly thrashed Deepak. Deepak, police said, retaliated by attacking Rajpal, setting off a rivalry that continued for years.

Pawan's sister eventually married and moved away. But police said Deepak continued to intimidate her whenever she returned to her maternal home. "Deepak would go around in his tractor, make sounds with the vehicle to grab attention. Last year, he also did something similar to Pawan's close friend Sagar Kala's sister. It was then that the two decided to take revenge," an officer said.

The plan began in February, police said, when Sagar's brother Saajan allegedly opened fire outside Deepak's residence to scare him.

The first attempt to kill Deepak came on July 2, police said. An FIR was registered in connection with incident. Sagar (30) was allegedly driving the car. "Pawan was angry with Sagar and told him that in the second attempt, he would drive," said the officer.



(From top) Deceased Deepak Dabas, main accused Pawan alias Jagpal Dabas and the Scorpio car used in the crash.

EXPRESS

Two weeks later, police said, Sagar ran over Deepak. Following this, the Scorpio was recovered.

An FIR was lodged and a joint team of the Kanjhawala police and Special Staff was formed. While the Kanjhawala police team was led by SHO Inspector Krishan Kumar, the Special Staff team was headed by Inspector Sandeep Godara.

The first breakthrough came on July 17, when police arrested Sagar. During questioning, he allegedly said that he had intentionally hit Deepak with the Hyundai i10 on July 2 to kill him.

The car was subsequently recovered from Atul (30), who was also arrested.

"Pawan, who had a long-standing enmity with Deepak, planned the killing. He had earlier fired outside the house of Deepak's brother... Two more arrests followed," said DCP (Rohini) Shashank Jaiswal.

He added that Sahil (23) was arrested on July 22 for allegedly harbouring Pawan and attempting to destroy evidence. Prince (24) was arrested on July 26 for allegedly arranging the Scorpio. Police said Tili is the nephew of jailed gangster Kala Jhatedi.

After the murder, police said, Pawan kept changing his location. He first went to Meerut, then Hisar, Rajasthan and Gujarat. As the Kanwar season began, he travelled to Haridwar and stayed in tents used by Kanwariyas. He was eventually arrested on August 12.

Pawan has four previous criminal cases, while Sagar Kala and Atul have two each, police said.

60 km of road space reclaimed in Gurgaon anti-encroachment drive

Abhimanyu Hazarika

Gurgaon, August 13

NINE DAYS after assuring the Supreme Court that all illegal encroachments within its jurisdiction would be removed within two weeks, the Gurgaon Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) has reclaimed over 60 km of road (right of way) across the city as of Thursday, data shared by the authority showed.

Right of way (RoW) refers to public land legally meant for un-obstructed roads, footpaths, utilities, and emergency access.

The campaign has targeted major arterial corridors across Old Gurgaon, Golf Course Extension Road, the Southern Peripheral Road, and newly devel-

oped sectors towards Manesar.

Since Monday, the authority had deployed 12 multi-departmental enforcement teams and heavy machinery to clear public land, sector-dividing roads, green belts, and footpaths.

The drive has seen a steady day-by-day expansion in coverage across the city's road network, a GMDA spokesperson said. On Monday, teams reclaimed around 16 km of road space, focusing primarily on dense stretches in Old Gurgaon.

Another 15 km was covered the next day, targeting sector-dividing roads, commercial corridors, and key intersections.

On Wednesday, field teams cleared encroachments along 13 km of government land and arterial stretches, clearing criti-

cal road margins.

The campaign on Thursday saw its largest single-day expansion as operations shifted into New Gurgaon, clearing nearly 25 km of encroached right of way.

In Old Gurgaon, teams cleared obstructions along Old Railway Road, Dhanwapur Road, Sheetla Mata Road, and the sector-dividing roads between Sectors 4, 7, 8, and 9.

Along Golf Course Extension Road and the Southern Peripheral Road network, the operation cleared major corridors including the Vatika Chowk to Ghata stretch and the Vatika Chowk to National Highway stretch. Teams removed encroachments from New Gurgaon sectors towards Manesar.

34 Delhi govt schools set to be demolished post structural audit

Sophiya Mathew

New Delhi, August 13

THIRTY-FOUR Delhi government schools have been identified for demolition following structural and infrastructure assessments, with the Directorate of Education (DoE) now carrying out a final evaluation of the survey findings before deciding the extent of demolition and redevelopment required at each site, officials said on Thursday.

They added that ground assessment, including drone-based surveying, has been completed and teams within the DoE are currently examining the findings.

The assessment is looking not only at structural safety but

also at the infrastructure and construction requirements of the schools, including which portions need to be demolished, repaired or redeveloped.

Of the 34 schools identified, demolition proposals for nine have already received approval, officials said. Work is underway in 16 other cases, while the remaining proposals are at different stages of assessment and processing.

The exercise is part of a wider effort by the Delhi government to create a detailed digital and physical assessment of its government school infrastructure, officials said.

The DoE has completed digital profiling of 1,090 schools, documenting the condition of buildings and facilities

to identify infrastructure gaps and prioritise works, they added.

Delhi Education department officials said they are simultaneously working on improving school infrastructure. It has proposed construction of 27 permanent school buildings on vacant land parcels under the DoE at an estimated cost of around Rs 900 crore.

The proposed buildings are expected to be constructed as Ground 4, earthquake-resistant structures, officials said.

The 27 sites have been divided into five geographical clusters to enable faster execution and monitoring. The projects are expected to be completed within about 18 months, officials said.

● PARSI NEW YEAR TOMORROW

Salli Gosht, Chicken Berry Pulao & Lagan-nu-Custard: What's cooking for Navroz

Anusree K C

New Delhi, August 13

SALLI GOSHT, Patra ni Machi, Pulao Dal and of course, Lagan-nu-Custard — ask a Parsi family what makes Navroz special and the answer is likely to come from the dining table.

In Delhi, preparations for the Parsi New Year — to be celebrated on August 15 — are as much about deciding what will be cooked in the kitchen as they are about prayers at the Agiary, the Parsi fire temple. For the community, defined by food traditions passed on from one generation to the next, the Navroz feast is a delicious way of coming home.

For home chef Firozi Kiranjia, the memories begin with breakfast. "Parsi New Year would ideally start with Sagan ni Sev with Mithu Dahi — made of vermicelli, flavoured with cardamom, nutmeg and served

with chilled sweet yoghurt. Or we cook Parsi Ravo, a sweet semolina pudding," she says recalling Navroz celebrations in Mumbai during her childhood.

By lunchtime, the spread gets richer. There is Pulao Dal or Mora Dal Chawal, served with Parsi Patio — a red gravy cooked with prawns or fish. "We also cook Salli Gosht, a mutton or lamb curry, and Patra-ni-Machi, fish coated in green coconut chutney, wrapped in banana leaves and steamed," says Firozi, who is hosting 'Bhoole Bisre' at Varq, Taj Mahal in New Delhi for Navroz.

Benaifer C Bagli runs Bagli's Kitchen, a catering service from Sohna Road in Gurgaon, a role she inherited from her mother-in-law Dhun Daraiua Bagli.

For Benaifer, lunch means Dhan Dar Patio — plain boiled basmati or jeera rice, yellow toor dal and patio. Chicken



(Clockwise from above) Non-veg thali, Jardaloo Chicken, Mutton Pulao, Lagan-nu-Custard and Patra-ni-Machi served on Navroz. EXPRESS

Berry Pulao is also a popular dish, she says.

Then comes dessert: Lagan-nu-Custard. Both Benaifer and Firozi insist it is the sweet that must make an appearance on the Navroz table. "With Pallonji sodas we close the meal. The raspberry flavour was my fa-

vourite as a child," Firozi says.

Firozi's pop-up at Taj Mahal leans into dishes she says rarely make it to restaurant menus elsewhere in the city. "We have an à la carte menu — Irani cutlets, Patrani Machi, Chicken Farcha (fried chicken), Salli Gosht, Jardaloo Chicken, Berry

Pulao, Dhansak (chicken or mutton with a mixture of lentils and vegetables)," she lists. There is Lagan-nu-Custard and Parsi Mawa cake for dessert.

At Benaifer's kitchen, the menu changes with every function. "This time, we are making Chicken Pulao Dal and Parsi

Mutton Puff. We try to do something different every time so the flavours don't get monotonous."

Adil Nargolwala, president of Delhi Parsi Anjuman says the body's Navroz feast will feature Chicken Pulao, Bafat nu Ghosh, Masala Daar, Dum Aloo,

Bafat nu Paneer.

Explaining the history of how Parsi community moved to Delhi in large numbers, he says, "When the British moved their capital from Kolkata to Delhi, a large number of Parsis who were doctors, businessmen, government officials, moved to Delhi. That is how the initial set of Parsis came to Delhi from then Bombay and Calcutta."

India's Parsi community celebrates two major festivals in a year. "One is Jamshedi Navroz, which falls on March 21, when we celebrate the spring equinox. It is similar to the Basant Panchami celebrated by Hindus. Then it's Navroz or Parsi New Year. It's when our calendar changes and a New Year begins,"

says Adil.

The community celebrates Navroz in August because it follows the Shahenshahi calendar, which doesn't adjust for leap years. So, over the centuries, the date has drifted nearly 200 days from its original position, landing squarely in August instead of March.

Before the New Year are 10 days of remembrance, known as Gatha days. "This is similar to the Shraadh performed in Hinduism, where we pray for the departed" says Adil.

On the day of New Year, homes are scrubbed and decorated with flowers. Families dress in traditional clothes and head to the Agiary, carrying offerings of milk, fruit and sandalwood. "We worship the fire," says Adil.



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CURTAINS ON STORMY MONSOON SESSION

Rijiju targets Cong for disruption; Opp got upper hand, says Ramesh

Jatin Anand & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, August 13

THE 25-DAY-LONG Monsoon Session of Parliament, which came to an end on Thursday, was marred by adjournments, sloganeering, allegations and counter-allegations due to a sustained standoff between the ruling BJP-led NDA and the Opposition INDIA bloc on various issues.

Both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha were adjourned sine die after the recitation of the national song *Vande Mataram* immediately after their sittings resumed in the morning. It turned out to be a stormy session that saw relentless protests by the Opposition members, within and outside Parliament, on police crackdown on Jantar Mantar student protesters during their march on Parliament on July 20 — the opening day of the session — besides alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, with several Bills passed without a debate.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi were present in the Lok Sabha on the last day of the session. This was the first time that both Modi and Shah were present in the House in the wake of the Opposition's persistent demand that Shah make a statement on police action against student protesters.

Addressing media persons, Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju blamed the Congress for "disrupting" the parliamentary proceedings during the session, claiming that it was for the first time that the Opposition "ran away" from discussion



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, along with Union ministers Rajnath Singh, Amit Shah and Nitin Gadkari, stands for *Vande Mataram* in Lok Sabha on Thursday. PTI

when the government wanted it. "It was a good session... We have passed 12 Bills. But it was not a good session in terms of discussion. From the point of view of time-allocation, productivity in Lok Sabha was 19%; in Rajya Sabha, it was 39%. In the Rajya Sabha, even if there was a ruckus from the Opposition, some NDA and Opposition members would engage in a discussion."

"But, in my (three-decade) parliamentary experience, this was the first instance when the Opposition ran away from discussion. This is not good for a parliamentary form of democracy. They did not let a discussion take place, the Opposition ran away from it," Rijiju alleged. "Regarding the Congress, it appears now all they think that their job is, is sloga-

neering and carrying placards... I feel for the Congress MPs, especially the young ones. How will they gain experience if this goes on... I hope this will improve during the Winter Session. In this session, 12 Bills were passed; only one was discussed in Lok Sabha (anti-exam paper leak Bill); all 12 Bills were discussed in Rajya Sabha."

When asked whether the NDA government, which was said to have the "delimitation package", including the proposed legislation to advance the implementation of 33% women quota in the Lok Sabha and the state Assemblies, high on its list of priorities for this session, was considering a special session for the purpose, Rijiju said, "That is a matter for the future, we will discuss that later."

On its part, the Congress alleged that never before had a government been so "scared and rattled" as the Modi government was during the Monsoon Session, adding that the Opposition scored five "big achievements". It also underlined that the Opposition unity was on full display during the entire session.

Congress MP and communication in-charge Jairam Ramesh said Modi and Shah stayed away from the parliamentary proceedings, appearing only on the last day just before the House was adjourned sine die. "I want to remind you that the Monsoon Session has been washed out and 11 years ago in 2015, the Monsoon Session was washed out and the reason was the Vyapam scam. After 11 years, again an issue related to the youth re-

sulted in a washout," Ramesh said. He was accompanied by Congress Deputy Leader in Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi.

"So nothing has changed in 11 years. There were laws made and now reels are being made but nothing has changed," Ramesh said. "The Opposition walked together on the path we collectively decided." Listing the Opposition's "achievements", he said one success was that the Centre's proposed "One Nation, One Election" move was put off till the Winter Session as the Opposition raised several questions and the joint committee examining it did not table its report.

Similarly, the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBASA) Bill, 2025 was not brought as the joint panel examining it could not submit its report, he said. "We objected and raised questions and that report was also put off," Ramesh said the "third success" of the Opposition was that the constitutional amendment Bill proposing that the PM or a CM be removed from office automatically if they are arrested and detained for 30 consecutive days, could not be brought as a report on it was also not tabled by its parliamentary panel due to "collective pressure exerted by the Opposition".

"The fifth success is that the attempt to get a tainted two-thirds majority was underway but could not succeed and the Constitution Amendment Bill involving delimitation could not be brought," he said, claiming, "They don't have a two-thirds majority and will never get it."

Gogoi said, "We have seen many sessions but have never seen the government so scared and rattled as it was this time."

Opposition says it outplayed the BJP; what comes next?

Manoj CG
New Delhi, August 13

AS THE Monsoon Session of Parliament concluded on Thursday, Opposition parties appeared convinced that they had pushed the BJP on the defensive. The reason: they had, at least for the time being, derailed the Centre's big-ticket legislative agenda, including delimitation, women's reservation, and amendments to the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act or FCRA, while maintaining "sustained pressure" on the government over student protests.

INDIA bloc leaders, cutting across party lines, admitted that the narrative in the run-up to the session was not in their favour after Assembly poll losses in West Bengal, Assam, and Tamil Nadu, as well as the splits and defections that followed. The prevailing sense was that the Opposition was demoralised and that the narrative was "firmly with the government". There was speculation that the government was aggressively trying to cobble together the numbers needed to bring back the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill to implement the women's reservation law and to push through the Delimitation Bill.

With the DMK no longer willing to walk with the INDIA bloc, the TMC fractured, and the NCP (SP) sending ambiguous signals, speculation was rife that more desertions could further cripple the Opposition. As the Monsoon Session ended without transacting much business, the government did manage to get 12 Bills passed, although only one was passed after a proper discussion

CWC set to meet next week to chalk out an action plan to move its campaign on the issues of exam paper leaks, Ram temple donation thefts

in the Lok Sabha. Yet, the Opposition, barring a handful of leaders, doesn't appear to be ruling the fact that it could not use Parliament as a platform to corner the Centre and articulate its issues and views clearly.

On the contrary, the Opposition believes it managed to shift the narrative, at least for the time being, while ensuring that its internal fissures did not come to the fore. It believes that the absence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah — who have often led attacks against the Opposition — from House gave it an "unexpected advantage".

"It was a rare slip by the BJP... the powerful Shah avoiding Parliament. This helped us spin a narrative that they (the government) are scared," an Opposition leaders said. Another leader elaborated, using a cricketing analogy: "The opening batsmen did not come out to bat. They were sitting in the pavilion. They were scared to bat on a turning pitch." The government has accused the Opposition of "running away from discussions and debates."

While the CJP — which spearheaded the Gen Z protests and succeeded in forcing the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister — concentrates on its future

steps and establishing itself, the Opposition, especially Congress, remained firm in attacking the Centre and Shah over the July 20 police crackdown on protesters during a march to Parliament.

The Congress also believes that the issue of unemployment and the lack of job creation could prove to be the BJP government's Achilles heel. While the protests were triggered by exam paper leaks, the principal Opposition party's assessment is that they reflect the wider angst among the youth. This, coupled with Ram Temple donation row or "chanda chori", which the SP believes has resonance among people, is likely to be front and centre of the Opposition's narrative and campaign plans in the coming days.

Even as the Opposition's moral high ground over the Jantar Mantar police action was slightly dented by the police action against protesters in Ranchi by the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha-Congress government, the Congress believes Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi sent out a clear message that the police action was wrong and he stood by the protesters. The Congress Working Committee (CWC), the party's highest decision-making body, is set to meet next week to chalk out an action plan to take forward its campaign on the two issues.

"Harping on the July 20 police crackdown and absence of Shah from Parliament will have a limited shelf life. We will have to be imaginative to bring to the fore what we believe is the angst among the youth over jobs. The challenge is how we will be able to do it," said a Congress leader.

Front foot to backfoot: BJP narrative takes a hit in House

CAPITAL CONTEXT

BY LIZ MATHEW

A WEEKLY LOOK AT POLITICS FROM THE VANTAGE POINT OF NEW DELHI

IN THE weeks leading up to the Monsoon Session, the government appeared to be comfortably placed, with the Opposition on the defensive after internal fractures and high-profile defections in key regional parties TMC and Shiv Sena (UBT).

The Session began on July 20 and the narrative shifted on the first day itself following the police action against thousands of youngsters intent on marching to Parliament to protest against exam paper leaks and demand the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as Union Education Minister. The protesters scored a win as Pradhan resigned on July 25. Then, a couple of weeks later, came the setback in the Assembly bypolls in two constituencies once considered the BJP's bastion, one of which is BJP president Nitin Nabin's seat.

As the Monsoon Session concluded Thursday, it was the BJP that appeared on the defensive, as the Opposition stuck to its stand that Union Home Minister Amit Shah must answer specific allegations of police excesses on July 20. In the end, amid the Opposition's protests, Shah did not



X/ @SANJAYJAISWALMP

When we agreed on issues to be debated, Opposition changed its stance: Sanjay Jaiswal, BJP's chief whip in Lok Sabha

end up making a statement.

Amid the deadlock, Bills were pushed through without adequate debate. However, the Centre could not push through the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which required a simple majority, and recommended it to a Joint Committee of Parliament. Neither the Constitution Amendment Bill to operationalise the women's quota law nor the Delimitation Bill were introduced, as was expected before the Session, since BJP remained unsure about its numbers.

In the meantime, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat's dismissal of the aspersions cast on the Gen Z demonstrations undercut attempts to build a narrative on the alleged role of external forces in the protests. "The sarsangchalak's comment came at a

time when the party was trying to keep up a brave face. It was a big setback for BJP and the government. The RSS being on a different page when the party is preparing for elections in a crucial state such as Uttar Pradesh is bad news. The BJP leadership has to work hard on setting the narratives right now," said a national office-bearer of the party.

Several senior BJP leaders admitted that the Monsoon Session had been "a failure" but claimed that the "damage for the Opposition was bigger" as it could not establish a narrative "by repeatedly changing the goalpost" in Parliament. "Parliament cannot function like this. They kept shifting not just the goalpost but the field itself. Whenever we agreed on the issues to be debated, the Opposition changed its stance. You ask for the Home Minister's statement and when he is ready, you cannot say that 'we do not want to listen to his lectures'," said Sanjay Jaiswal, the BJP's chief whip in the Lok Sabha.

Another BJP leader said the Centre pushing through 12 Bills amid stormy scenes was a "legal and constitutional" success. In Parliament, too, BJP was surprised that Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla did not suspend "MPs who were not allowing the House to function", insiders said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



RS passes mining Bill, minister says won't affect states' revenue

Pratyush Deep & Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, August 13

AMID CONCERNS over the possibility of states losing revenue from taxes, cess and other levies on mineral extraction following the passage of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, Union Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy on Thursday said the legislation would not result in any revenue loss for states.

The Bill, passed by both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha, seeks to prohibit states from imposing specified levies on mineral right and mineral-bearing lands, except in accordance with conditions or curbs prescribed by the Centre.

The Bill comes despite the Supreme Court in 2024 upheld the power of states to levy tax on mineral rights and mineral-bearing land. The SC allowed states to collect tax arrears from April 1, 2005 onwards, but without interest or penalty.

Once the Bill becomes an Act, it will also extinguish unpaid or unrecovered dues arising from such levies imposed before the amendment Act's commencement. However, levies that have been paid or recovered will not be eligible for a refund. Some estimates suggest that the total value of such outstanding dues across the mining sector could be around Rs 2 lakh crore.

As per the government, the intention of the amendment is to bring greater uniformity in the prices of key major minerals and prevent their rising costs from feeding into inflation and infrastructure costs. The MMDR Act distinguishes between major minerals, which are regulated primarily by the Centre, and minor minerals, whose regulation is largely entrusted to state governments.

On Thursday, Reddy said Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VbR6RGJOKH6oBd0F>



Union Minister G Kishan Reddy in Rajya Sabha on Thursday. ANI

ment. This session was a complete washout because of the deadlock between the government and Opposition over allegations of corruption in the 2G spectrum allocation. The Opposition demanded a probe by a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC), while the government said the Public Accounts Committee could do the same.

Parliamentary functioning again nosedived in the 2013 Winter Session, ahead of the 2014 Lok Sabha polls. A resurgent BJP with Narendra Modi as its Prime Ministerial candidate sought to put the government on the mat over the draft JPC findings on telecom licence allocations.

Led by then Lok Sabha MP P C Chacko, the JPC had given a clean chit to then PM Manmohan Singh and then Union Finance Minister P Chidambaram, instead blaming former

the new amendment will apply only to major minerals including iron ore, coal, bauxite, manganese and copper, and would likely affect around 11 mineral-producing states. He said minor minerals are outside the scope of the proposed legislation.

"If prices of these minerals increase, it affects infrastructure activities, which will eventually impact common people. If the price of limestone increases, rates of cement will go up, and if iron ore prices increase, the rate of steel will increase. That is why we wanted to keep the prices of these four-five major minerals balanced."

On concerns over states' finances, Reddy said all taxes and other levies on major minerals are collected by state governments and not the Centre. The revenue of states from the mineral sector has increased from Rs 13,258 crore in 2014-15 to Rs 71,035 crore in 2024-25, he said.

Senior officials in the Ministry of Mines said there are around 14 levies in the mineral sector which included environmental cess, pollution cess among others. "These levies will continue to be there..." a senior ministry official said.

about 40% of India's minerals.

Soren tells PM to reconsider mining Bill, flags its impact on Jharkhand

Press Trust of India
Ranchi, August 13

JHARKHAND CHIEF Minister Hemant Soren on Thursday urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to reconsider the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, saying curbs on state levies could significantly reduce the state's fiscal space and affect its ability to address the social and environmental costs of mining.

In a letter to Modi, Soren said mining revenue accounted for 84.9% of the state's non-tax revenue in 2024-25, as per the State Economic Survey for 2025-26. Soren, who also sought intervention from President Droupadi Murmu, said the Mineral Bearing Land Cess was expected to generate around Rs 7,110 crore annually and described mineral-related revenue as crucial to the state's finances. "Any substantial restriction on this revenue would directly affect Jharkhand's ability to sustain development, welfare and social-security interventions."

Jharkhand accounts for about 40% of India's minerals.

Lok Sabha records productivity of just 15% — lowest in a decade

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, August 13

THE PRODUCTIVITY at the end of the Monsoon Session on Thursday was 15% in the Lok Sabha, and 33% in the Rajya Sabha, according to PRS Legislative Research. This is the lowest productivity rate recorded since the 2016 Winter Session.

Data on every Parliament session, available since 2009, show there have been sessions where one or both Houses have occasionally seen even bigger washouts than the current session.

UPA years

The 2010 Winter Session, when the Congress-led UPA was in power for its second term and the BJP was the principal Opposition, was a complete washout. The Lok Sabha functioned for only 5% of its scheduled time in the session and the Rajya

Sabha just 2%, according to data.

This session was a complete washout because of the deadlock between the government and Opposition over allegations of corruption in the 2G spectrum allocation. The Opposition demanded a probe by a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC), while the government said the Public Accounts Committee could do the same. Parliamentary functioning again nosedived in the 2013 Winter Session, ahead of the 2014 Lok Sabha polls. A resurgent BJP with Narendra Modi as its Prime Ministerial candidate sought to put the government on the mat over the draft JPC findings on telecom licence allocations.

Led by then Lok Sabha MP P C Chacko, the JPC had given a clean chit to then PM Manmohan Singh and then Union Finance Minister P Chidambaram, instead blaming former



Lok Sabha Deputy LoP Gaurav Gogoi, TMC MP Saugata Roy and other opposition leaders stage a protest at Parliament, Thursday. ANI

Communications and Information Technology Minister A Raja for misrepresentation of facts. The Opposition dubbed it a "cover-up".

The session was further mired by protests — by MPs from Andhra Pradesh over the creation of Telangana, and over the plight of displaced people

after the Muzaffarnagar riots in Uttar Pradesh. The session saw the Lok Sabha function for only 6% of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha 19%.

The following Interim Budget Session in 2014, just before Lok Sabha polls, was also a near washout as protests against the UPA government intensified

ahead of campaigning for the election. The Lok Sabha functioned for 21% of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha 27%.

NDA years

After the Narendra Modi government came to power, the 2015 Monsoon Session fared poorly. The Lok Sabha functioned for 46% of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha just 9%. The Opposition had disrupted Parliament over the Lalit Modi controversy, demanding the sacking of then Union Minister of External Affairs Sushma Swaraj for allegedly using influence to secure British travel documents for Modi, and the Vyapam scam involving alleged irregularities in admissions and recruitment in BJP-ruled Madhya Pradesh.

The Lok Sabha subsequently saw the suspension of 25 of the 44 Congress MPs for five days, leading to a boycott of

proceedings by several Opposition parties in solidarity with the suspended MPs. The Rajya Sabha could not conduct Question Hour throughout the session, though the Lok Sabha held Question Hour for a few days and also conducted some legislative business in the absence of Opposition parties.

The 2016 Winter Session was also a virtual washout, amid Opposition protests over demonetisation, with the Lok Sabha functioning for just 15% of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha 18%. The 2018 Budget Session also saw major disruptions, with the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, functioning for just 21% and 27% of their scheduled time, respectively. The issues that washed out the session and left many Bills pending included Cauvery river water sharing between Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry, Andhra Pradesh's demand for recogni-

tion as a special category state, and Opposition protests over an alleged fraud at the Punjab National Bank, among others.

The 2021 Monsoon Session saw the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, respectively, functioning for just 21% and 29% of their scheduled time with the Pegasus snooping allegations and the three farm laws leading to disruptions.

The 2023 Budget Session saw the Lower House function for 33% of its scheduled time and the Upper House 24%. The standoff this time was due to the Opposition demand for a parliamentary committee to probe the Adani Group over allegations of stock manipulation and accounting fraud, Rahul Gandhi's statement abroad that Indian democracy was "under attack", and the disqualification of Gandhi from Parliament following his conviction by a Surat court on a defamation charge.

OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY COMMISSIONER OF POLICE:
EAST DISTRICT, DELHI

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PUBLIC NOTICE

The General public is hereby informed that the following unclaimed Motor Vehicles of different makes/Models, seized U/S 66 D.P. Act by Police Station of East District and presently lying at various Police Stations, East District shall be disposed off by auction through MSTC Limited Shortly.

In case of any claim for any of these vehicles, they may personally approach the undersigned with all relevant documents, proving the ownership on or before **14.08.2026**. No claim shall be entertained after **03.09.2026** and vehicles will be disposed off by auction.

THE LIST OF UNCLAIMED VEHICLES SEIZED U/S 66 D.P. ACT, 1978

SUBJECT / LIST OF VEHICLES FIT FOR AUCTION OF EAST DISTRICT

S. No.	DD No. & Date	Reg. No.	Engine No.	Chasis No.	Make	Date of Registration (Life/Age)	Police Station
1	64A 10/04/2025	UP 81 BE 0207	25195	58056	TVS APACHE	19.06.15	Mayur Vihar
2	06A 22/04/2025	UK 08 AN 4084	50833	50111	HERO SPLENDER	14.03.17	Mayur Vihar
3	16A 27/04/2025	DL 7 SBX 6678	04158	02766	HERO PASSION PRO	15.06.15	Mayur Vihar
4	47A 18/07/2025	HR 41 H 8398	53026	47582	SUZUKI HAYATE	12.08.16	Mayur Vihar
5	14A 25/09/21	DLYSAY8003	3734	3850	M/CY	27/04/2007	Shakarpur
6	17A 19/11/21	DL13SA2741	13167	875	M/CY	14/09/2007	Shakarpur
7	33A 15/01/22	DL3SAF6666	49	14961	SCOOTY	12/Mar/13	Shakarpur
8	42A 19/03/22	DL7SAP6301	52940	54190	M/CY	15/11/2005	Shakarpur
9	32A 14/04/22	UP16AX0487	36749	36726	SCOOTY	11/Jan/14	Shakarpur
10	06A 08/05/22	DL12SD0899	3385	3833	M/CY	21/08/2014	Shakarpur
11	18A 08/05/22	DL13SV0480	71428	77902	M/CY	19/12/2017	Shakarpur
12	46A 25/07/22	HR01W3165	80362	27372	M/CY	15/11/2007	Shakarpur
13	69A 13/05/23	DL5SAL6378	30298	7153	M/CY	13/06/2014	Shakarpur
14	69A 19/05/23	UP50AJ1262	70018	31311	SCOOTY	28/05/2014	Shakarpur
15	124A 11/01/2021	DL8SAM9606	89153	11125	BAJAJ PULSER 150	30/Sep/11	Pandav Nagar
16	61A 18/01/2021	DL8SBS3894	71382	78183	HONDA SCOOTY	DEC 24, 2016	PANDAV NAGAR
17	38A 22/01/2021	UP16AH3018	43614	93209	PULSER 135	JAN 09, 2012	PANDAV NAGAR
18	84A 23/03/2021	DL3SCO1746	34071	12914	SCOOTY	FEB 13, 2014	PANDAV NAGAR
19	55A 11/04/2021	DL5SAT6567	29648	26364	HERO DUET	JUNE 16, 2016	PANDAV NAGAR
20	73A 15/04/2021	DL7SBT9567	40079	40085	HONDA ACTIVA	AGUST 11, 2014	PANDAV NAGAR
21	9A 26/05/2021	DL7SBL8261	45353	97012	PULSER	AGUST 21, 2011	PANDAV NAGAR
22	7A 12/06/2021	DL7SBR5307	21981	5159	TVS JUPITER	APRIL 22, 2015	PANDAV NAGAR
23	38A 09/07/2021	DL7SBF5965	1619	70202	HONDA ACTIVA	APRIL 14, 2010	PANDAV NAGAR
24	88A 03/08/2021	UP16BP9607	24189	43503	TVS STAR CITY	SEP. 17, 2017	PANDAV NAGAR
25	94A 17/03/2022	DL11SX3947	98565	8930	CT 100 BAJAJ	SEP 14, 2018	PANDAV NAGAR
26	118A 27/04/2022	DL8SBE2039	103931	13001	SCOOTY SUZUKI	SEP. 19, 2012	PANDAV NAGAR
27	97A 19/05/2022	DL3SDP5262	5525	1584	SPLENDER PLUS	FEB 21, 2017	PANDAV NAGAR
28	10A 25/05/2022	DL7SBH6963	56268	53649	PASSION PRO	NOV 09, 2010	PANDAV NAGAR
29	30A 04/11/2022	WB01R6857		28838	SPLENDER BLACK		PANDAV NAGAR
30	84A 13/01/2023	UK07DJ4553	60440	80557	KTM DUKE 390	NOV 16, 2018	PANDAV NAGAR
31	38A 05/03/2023	DL3SBG1995	33749	21175	BAJAJ DISCOVER	JAN 15, 2008	PANDAV NAGAR
32	19A 28/04/2023	DL5SBD1296	69536	70570	HONDA ACTIVA	JUNE 05, 2013	PANDAV NAGAR
33	81A 22/05/2023	DL1SQ8903	26061	14101	PASSION +	MARCH 26, 2007	PANDAV NAGAR
34	29A 13/07/2023	HR26BJ5537	14598	3759	HONDA SHINE	APRIL 22, 2011	PANDAV NAGAR
35	76A 18/06/2023	UP/20X/ 4812	16930	15065	M/Cy	18.10.2010	Laxmi Nagar
36	76A 29/10/2022	DL/13SH/ 5333	70920	94353	S/Cy	16/Oct/10	Laxmi Nagar
37	78A 03/03/2022	DL/13SR/ 3113	93987	22834	S/Cy	10/Oct/13	Laxmi Nagar
38	17A 14/05/2023	DL/7SCK/ 9147	2626	4852	S/Cy	05/Oct/20	Laxmi Nagar
39	123A 26/04/2022	DL/7SCG/ 5694	94212	94152	S/Cy	31/Mar/19	Laxmi Nagar
40	53A 24/02/2022	DL/9SBY/ 4453	19687	93350	S/Cy	31/Mar/20	Laxmi Nagar
41	12A 13/08/2020	DL/3SBP/0352	8046	7054	M/Cy	26/Nov/08	Laxmi Nagar
42	79A 16/08/2024	DL/8SCT/0708	21024	22621	S/Cy	12/Nov/19	Laxmi Nagar
43	13A 30/09/2024	DL/7SBW/4090	7307	4818	M/Cy	11/Feb/14	Laxmi Nagar
44	09A 20/10/18	UP/15/AK/6568	81942	82524	SCOOTY	29.05.2009	Madhu Vihar
45	30A 06/08/23	UK04V0272	15640	24688	CAR RENULT KWID	06.02.2016	Madhu Vihar
46	08A 26/01/24	DL14SB9804		12970	SCOOTY		Madhu Vihar
47	95A 08/06/24	DL7SVW4608	30412	-	SCOOTY		Madhu Vihar
48	84A 12/07/24	DL3SBY6908	21622	22422	SCOOTY	22.10.2011	Madhu Vihar
49	64A 17/07/24	DL5SBG8435	25050	76617	SCOOTY	07.01.2013	Madhu Vihar
50	91A 10/08/24	DL14SF2686	29120	13317	M/CY	05.07.2014	Madhu Vihar
51	47A 29/08/24	DL7SBY2015	225487	74079	SCOOTY		Madhu Vihar
52	102A 24/09/24	DL5SDB3501	67218	45803	SCOOTY	11.09.2023	Madhu Vihar
53	37A 23/01/22	UP 14BL 0453	16707	14327	m/cy	28/Jul/11	GHAZIPUR
54	96A 01/02/22	DL 3SET 6255	71754	72316	m/cy	30/Jan/21	GHAZIPUR
55	58A 13/03/22	DL 5SCF 3361	54690	18179	m/cy	20/Jun/19	GHAZIPUR
56	26A 11/04/22	DL 7SBN 4685	64171	33492	m/cy	16/Dec/11	GHAZIPUR
57	85A 23/06/22	DL 6SAE 0416	----	----	m/cy	21/Mar/09	GHAZIPUR
58	11A 24/06/22	DL 6SAN 2644	----	20796	m/cy	-	GHAZIPUR
59	50A 03/08/22	DL 5SGD 1456	----	----	Scooty		GHAZIPUR

S. No.	DD No. & Date	Reg. No.	Engine No.	Chasis No.	Make	Date of Registration (Life/Age)	Police Station
60	15A 24/08/22	DL 7SBS 9857	----	28552	m/cy	22/Nov/14	GHAZIPUR
61	26A 29/08/22	DL 3SCN 2064	----	92332	m/cy	27/May/13	GHAZIPUR
62	80A 17/11/22	DL 7SBU 4374	75067	----	m/cy	06/Apr/15	GHAZIPUR
63	57A 18/11/22	DL 7SCD 7059	----	----	m/cy	26/Oct/17	GHAZIPUR
64	64A 04/12/22	DL 7SBF 6086	90754	----	Scooty	23/Apr/10	GHAZIPUR
65	76A 30/01/23	UP 14DW 3266	13980	85782	m/cy	01/Dec/18	GHAZIPUR
66	05A 20/02/23	DL 2SP3771	56964	28850	m/cy	02/Apr/16	GHAZIPUR
67	47A 27/02/23	DL 4SNB 4751	----	47390	m/cy	21/Feb/07	GHAZIPUR
68	47A 03/03/23	PB 10CA6816	1084	----	m/cy	20/Jun/07	GHAZIPUR
69	100A 11/04/23	DL 12GD 2157	----	----	m/cy	31/Dec/22	GHAZIPUR
70	51A 22/04/23	DL5SBK 4681	----	81945	m/cy	13/Nov/22	GHAZIPUR
71	58A 05/05/23	DL 7SBD 3476	48211	20590	m/cy	30/Jul/08	GHAZIPUR
72	98A 13/05/23	DL 7SBW 1024	6726	811	m/cy	31/Oct/13	GHAZIPUR
73	06A 29/06/23	WITHOUT NO. PLATE	85417	22053	m/cy		GHAZIPUR
74	107A 24/09/23	UP 14FL 3445	73156	5206	m/cy	15/Feb/23	GHAZIPUR
75	81A 04/11/23	WITHOUT NO. PLATE	82585	72392	m/cy		GHAZIPUR
76	33A 10/02/24	DL 10SS 9191	----	----	Scooty	30/Mar/17	GHAZIPUR
77	12A 27/02/24	UP 16FT 3079	34794	28150	m/cy	16/Jul/18	GHAZIPUR
78	61A 02/03/24	DL 6SAA 7399	----	23296	m/cy	02/Aug/18	GHAZIPUR
79	94A 15/03/24	DL 7SAA 3673	17382	40413	m/cy	21/Jul/03	GHAZIPUR
80	58A 16/03/24	DL 7SBC 9099	76790	21231	m/cy	02/Sep/08	GHAZIPUR
81	87A 05/04/24	DL 3SCG 6924	22551	14258	m/cy	29/Jun/13	GHAZIPUR
82	69A 12/04/24	DL 5SSB 2127	3690	----	m/cy		GHAZIPUR
83	103A 04/05/24	DL 3SBN 1707	1514	14896	m/cy	23/Nov/08	GHAZIPUR
84	27A 06/05/24	UP 81AW 9225	92946	6209	m/cy	13/Jan/14	GHAZIPUR
85	86A 08/05/24	DL 7SBN 4410	10863	9745	m/cy	03/Dec/11	GHAZIPUR
86	55A 16/05/24	UP 13BA 5754	74055	22032	m/cy	09/Feb/18	GHAZIPUR
87	106A 01/06/24	UP 7ST 5803	24215	2665	m/cy		GHAZIPUR
88	70A 01/07/24	DL 7SCA 1418	----	----	m/cy	09/Aug/16	GHAZIPUR
89	29A 04/07/24	DL 7SCR 2088	----	92739	m/cy	28/Nov/23	GHAZIPUR
90	53A 09/07/24	UP 79F 5359	15917	17536	m/cy	15/Oct/12	GHAZIPUR
91	112A 13/08/24	DL 7SAH 2462	61177	62348	m/cy	10/Oct/05	GHAZIPUR
92	99A 08/10/24	UP 16CD 5807	----	13368	m/cy	26/Apr/19	GHAZIPUR
93	05A 11/11/24	DL 5SDD 0429	14042	14216	m/cy		GHAZIPUR
94	77A 11/12/24	UP 33AZ 0845	15436	6551	m/cy	24/May/18	GHAZIPUR
95	126A 17/12/24	UP 64N 6051	31292	7827	m/cy	20/Nov/10	GHAZIPUR
96	10A 24/12/24	DL5SAP 5977	26865	26461	m/cy	11/Sep/15	GHAZIPUR
97	84A 25/12/24	DL 3SEV 2863	3355	9197	m/cy	22/Jun/21	GHAZIPUR
98	95A 25/12/24	DL 13SH 2759	74412	15160	m/cy	01/Sep/10	GHAZIPUR
99	119A 14/07/2021	DL/11SB/2488	10618	8793	SPL	14.7.21	KALYANPURI
100	84A 28/12/2024	UP/14BE/6881	1702	13863	CD DELUX	28.12.24	KALYANPURI
101	78A 31/12/2023	DL/2SM/6781	73977	74823	ACTIVA	31.12.23	KALYANPURI
102	71A 19/01/2025	DL/7SBS/0769	99478	5381	PULSAR	19.1.25	KALYANPURI
103	30A 31/05/2022	DL/7SAS/2697	39930	64544	TWO WHEELER	31.5.22	KALYANPURI
104	120A 31/08/2020	DL/3SBM/6401	31085	27838	ACTIVA	31.8.20	KALYANPURI
105	108A 25/07/2022	UP/16BC/2601	12265	12653	ACTIVA	25.7.22	KALYANPURI
106	29A 13/12/19	DL2SM8612	27485	40725	SCOOTY	14.11.2014	PIA
107	12A 16/12/19	DL13SDB1994			SCOOTY	14.11.2014	PIA
108	07A 19/11/20	UP14CA8835	22979	94344	SCOOTY	18.09.2013	PIA
109	87A 16/10/20		14522	18903			PIA
110	50A 23/01/021	DL3SBL1173	20484	10171	M/CYCLE	30.07.2008	PIA
111	40A 25/02/21	DL5SBD5191	77381	21241	M/CYCLE	07.11.2013	PIA
112	22A 31/03/21	DL5SAZ8227	3124	3157	SCOOTY	04.07.2017	PIA
113	27A 10/12/21	DL7SCC9081	79140	81970	SCOOTY	18.07.2017	PIA
114	18A 06/12/21	DL7SBC3088	64295	15838	M/CYCLE	06.02.2008	PIA
115	40A 05/02/22	TWO RING (SILVER)			M/CYCLE		PIA
116	35A 13/02/22	UP82AA1211	16738	12555	M/CYCLE	22.07.2017	PIA
117	69A 13/12/22	UP16AB4377	20998	10973	M/CYCLE	12.10.2010	PIA
118	88A 10/05/22	UP14EB6184	36371	11569	M/CYCLE	28.06.2019	PIA
119	22A 23/08/22	UK04M0074	8877	60884	M/CYCLE	01.03.2012	PIA
120	08A 09/09/22	UP14AD4798			M/CYCLE		PIA
121	08A 13/11/22	DL7SAK8943	43705	43278	M/CYCLE	01.05.2005	PIA
122	15A 05/04/23	DL5SBY4721	275	115	SCOOTY	14.08.2015	PIA
123	73A 05/04/23	DL5SBU2594	23294	23074	SCOOTY	01.11.2013	PIA
124	86A 22/05/23	DL2SQ5030	18099	18083	SCOOTY	05.12.2016	PIA
125	122A 04/07/23	DL7SBM7288	40383	40261	SCOOTY	14.09.2012	PIA
126	30A 29/08/23	DL4SCC6314	53391	53515	SCOOTY	07.12.2012	PIA
127	60A 04/09/23	DL13SS8577	21041	28173	SCOOTY	23.02.2017	PIA
128	60A 04/09/23	DL10SV2766	990	78777	SCOOTY	22.03.2018	PIA
129	9A 08/10/23	UP22AM1698	12708	37660	M/CYCLE	02.07.2019	PIA

S. No.	DD No. &
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AFTER PHUKET-DELHI PILOT TESTS POSITIVE FOR MARIJUANA

Air India group makes one-time drug test mandatory for all its pilots

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 13

WITH THE pilot-in-command of the Air India Phuket-Delhi flight that suddenly lost altitude on August 4 testing positive for marijuana, the airline group has decided to conduct mandatory drug tests of all its pilots — Air India and Air India Express — starting Thursday.

In an internal memo to its pilots, the group said this one-time exercise “goes beyond the regulatory requirements” listed in the Directorate General of Civil Aviation’s (DGCA) rules on testing for psychoactive substances. According to the internal memo, the tests will be conducted alongside training sessions at the airline’s Gurugram academy, after flights at briefing centres and offices, or at locations designated by the pilots’ home bases.

According to sources, pilots who are currently on leave will be expected to undergo the tests upon resuming duty. The

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entire exercise is expected to take a few days.

Air India didn’t issue any official comment on the communication. Together, the group’s two airlines have about 5,000 pilots and a fleet of nearly 300 aircraft.

As per the DGCA’s existing Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR) on testing for psychoactive substances, random dope tests on 10% of the flight crew or pilots, and air traffic controllers are mandatory each year. Apart from the routine random testing, dope tests are also usually carried out after a safety-related incident.

“As you know, Air India already fully complies with all regulatory requirements prescribed by India’s DGCA, which are similar to those practised in other major aviation jurisdictions including Europe and the United States. We nevertheless now feel that it is important to go further. Accordingly, we have decided to undertake a full screening of all group pilots

provided by your respective

As per the existing Civil Aviation Requirements (CAR) on testing for psychoactive substances, random dope tests on 10% of the flight crew or pilots, and air traffic controllers are mandatory each year

for any substances or medications that are not permitted under prevailing regulations. This testing is mandatory and will start today, 13 August 2026,” the airline said in its internal memo.

“It (test) will be conducted concurrent with training at the Gurugram Academy, post flight at our Flight Briefing Centres/ Air India Offices, or at locations provided by your respective

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+4RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 passengers and four cabin crew members; 17 of the 24 injured had to be hospitalised. The aircraft had 137 passengers, six cabin crew members, and two pilots on board. The incident was classified as serious and is being investigated by the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB).

While the initial drug screening of the pilot-in-command had returned a ‘non-negative’ result, the confirmation test was found to be positive, with the substance identified as marijuana, according to sources. It is not clear when the substance was consumed, or whether he was operating the flight under its influence.

According to sources, the pilot informed the authorities that he was on sleep medication, as prescribed by his family doctor. He is also learnt to have said that he was standing behind the co-pilot’s seat at the time of the incident, and was not at the aircraft’s controls.

The development comes days after an Air India Airbus A320 aircraft — VT-EXO — operating a flight from Phuket to Delhi on August 4 encountered a sudden altitude drop of about 300 feet, causing injuries to 20

Sena party symbol hearing: Collective responsibility to keep democracy alive, says SC

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, August 13

ADVISING AGAINST underestimating other institutions, the Supreme Court on Thursday said that keeping democracy alive is a “collective responsibility” and not just that of the judiciary.

A three-judge bench presided by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said this as Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the Shiv Sena (Uddhav Bal Thackeray) faction, urged that only the Supreme Court can do something effectively on the repeated instances of assembly speakers not deciding disqualification petitions on time.

“This is a seminal opportunity for Your Lordships to lay down the law. This is not how...speakers should function in this country if really we want to adhere to the principles on which our constitution was founded. It’s a very sad state of affairs across the board... Whichever party is in

power, it shows that the disqualification is not heard... Every party does the same,” Sibal told the bench also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The court was hearing petitions by the Uddhav faction challenging the Election Commission of India’s decision to recognise the Eknath Shinde-led group as the real Shiv Sena and to allot the party’s bow and arrow symbol to it.

The bench, however, did not seem to agree with the suggestion that only the judiciary can do something about it. The CJI said that even the Parliament can find a solution.

“Of course it can, but any ruling party, whoever is in Parliament will not allow this to happen. Because they benefit from it. So only Your Lordships can correct. Ultimately the burden of keeping the democracy alive is with you. Not with us,” said Sibal.

Justice Bagchi however said, “it’s a collective responsibility”. The CJI added, “let’s not

underestimate. Our other institutions are also quite committed”.

“Of course, I am just saying the way it functioned over the last 20-30-40 years is a great matter of concern for all of us. And ultimately the law is to be laid down by Your Lordships... Parliament will pass laws and continue to pass laws, but the test is here. This is a great opportunity to preserve the values that we embrace,” Sibal added.

Sibal questioned the powers of the ECI under Paragraph 15 of the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, to decide on splits in a political party and said, “it’s a very dangerous proposition of law to say that after the petition is filed under paragraph 15, subsequent events not demonstrated on the day of the filing will demonstrate whether the party claiming has the right to get the symbol because of subsequent events.”

The court will continue hearing the matter on August 18.

Rahul calls BJP-RSS ‘bunch of jokers’; BJP hits back with ‘arrogance’ barb

Meloni jibe at Cong event as Rahul mocks Modi’s foreign policy; BJP says it’s a new low for public discourse

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 13

ADDRESSING THE Rachnatmak Congress National Convention at Constitution Club of India on Thursday, Rahul Gandhi called members of the BJP-RSS “a bunch of jokers” with no understanding of India. He hugged a party colleague on stage and mocked PM Narendra Modi’s foreign policy, accusing him of being “convinced” that diplomacy was “all about hugging”.

The BJP struck back by accusing Rahul of disrupting parliamentary proceedings through “arrogance, indiscipline and obstinacy”, with two party leaders condemning the hug episode as “vulgar” and a “new low in public discourse”.

Rahul said the Opposition was fighting people with no grasp of India’s philosophy or history. “A lot of people in India are behaving like cowards. But you’re fighting a bunch of jokers, clowns who have no idea about our philosophy, no idea about our history...” he said.

Rahul hugged Congress leader Sandeep Dikshit on stage to illustrate his point about PM Modi’s foreign policy. Dikshit then asked him: “*Meloni samajh ke toh nahii pakda tha* (did you hug me thinking I was Italian PM, Giorgia Meloni)?” Rahul replied: “I have not, I have not reached that yet.”

On foreign policy, Rahul said it had become ingrained in Modi’s thinking that it was about



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi at Rachnatmak Congress National Convention in New Delhi on Thursday. ENS

hugging world leaders. “I don’t know where this idea came from, that foreign policy means hugging politicians,” he said.

Rahul also claimed the RSS had been “captured and utilised by large capital, Mr Adani and Mr Ambani”, and that the organisation, originally an expression of the small Indian businessman, had long ceased to represent them.

Rahul also cited Shah’s absence from Parliament as evidence of the government’s unease. “You saw Amit Shah, so-called Chanakya, so-called Sardar Patel. He disappeared, he ran away, he could not enter Parliament for 20 days. For the first time, they are feeling India’s expression,” he said.

Reacting to the Meloni jibe, BJP national Mahila Morcha president Vanathi Srinivasan said that while criticism was the right of every political party, “insulting women and reducing public life to vulgar jokes is not”.

“Mocking PM Modi and Italian PM Giorgia Meloni, while Congress leaders laugh along, reflects a serious lack of political maturity. Debate policies. Challenge decisions. But respect people. This is a new low for public discourse,” she said.

Minister of State for Education and Development of North-Eastern Region Sukanta Majumdar called Rahul’s remarks “deeply disgraceful”.

Beant Singh’s assassination: How political mood around a convict is changing

Kamaldeep Singh Brar
Amritsar, August 13

FOR YEARS, Jagtar Singh Hawara was a name Punjab’s political establishment treated with extreme caution.

Born on May 17, 1970, in Hawara village of Fatehgarh Sahib, Hawara was convicted for his role in the 1995 assassination of then Punjab chief minister and Congress leader Beant Singh and regarded as a high-risk prisoner. After his escape from Burali Jail in Chandigarh in January 2004, successive Punjab governments were reluctant even to keep him in a Punjab prison. So, since he was re-arrested by a Delhi Police Special Cell team in June 2005, he has remained lodged in the Capital, first in high-security Tihar and now in Mandoli jail.

Today, however, as Assembly polls approach in Punjab and the Panthic vote is seen as up for the asking, the political mood around Hawara could hardly be more different. From the ruling AAP to the Congress

and sections of the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) and the BJP, politicians and political groups in Punjab are backing Hawara’s demand for parole “on humanitarian grounds” to meet his mother, Narinder Kaur, 83, who is unwell. Even Beant’s grandson Ravneet Singh Bittu, now with the BJP, has joined the calls for Hawara’s release.

The momentum coincides with sustained mobilisation by Sikh organisations, particularly the Qaumi Insaaf Morcha, a campaigner for the release of what it calls political prisoners. In February, it held a gathering in Hawara Kalan in Fatehgarh Sahib seeking parole for Hawara.

Punjab CM Bhagwant Singh Mann has recommended that the parole be at least for 10 days. Both Mann and Bittu have met Governor Gulab Chand Kataria to press their case, with the CM hoping that Hawara can meet his mother after over three decades. On Thursday, Kataria said he had recommended parole for Hawara “on humanitarian grounds”. However, sources



AAP Congress, SAD and BJP are all pitching for parole for Jagtar Singh Hawara (in photo), who once escaped prison and was convicted in 2007. FILE

said that Hawara has declined the two-day parole granted by the Delhi Prison Department, and wants regular parole.

The shift in Hawara’s circumstances is perhaps best captured by the unlikely popularity of a song celebrating the militant, which goes, “*Punjre devich band nai rehna aisse shera ne* (Lions won’t remain locked in cages forever).” The song found a place during the recent Jantar Mantar

protest in Delhi, and went viral on social media, celebrating Hawara as a figure of Sikh pride. His supporters have also been building support on the ground, with longtime aide Jaswant Singh saying panchayats in dozens of Fatehgarh Sahib villages had passed resolutions supporting his parole. The numbers stand at around 150, including resolutions from Hindu temples.

The AAP government’s pro-Hawara tilt is a contrast from March, when it had opposed parole for him. In a letter to the Punjab and Haryana High Court, the government said, “... 25 criminal cases are registered against the convict, Jagtar Singh Hawara. Due to this, the Senior Superintendent of Police, Fatehgarh Sahib, and the Director, Bureau of Investigation, have not recommended granting parole to the prisoner.” In July, HC proceedings showed he faced 36 cases; had been convicted in seven, completed sentences in six, and was serving life sentence in the Beant assassination case. At his parole hearing back in

June 2025, Hawara’s counsel told the court that he had spent about 29 years in custody and had never been granted parole or remission. In the July hearing, the HC ordered a time-bound procedure for deciding his parole application. Hawara’s initiation into militancy began with the Babbar Khalsa International, and he went underground during this period.

Beant Singh was killed in a suicide bombing outside the Punjab and Haryana Civil Secretariat on August 31, 1995, killing both him and the suicide bomber Dilawar Singh, as well as 15 others. In January 2004, Hawara escaped Burali jail through a tunnel with co-accused Jagtar Singh Tara, Paramjit Singh Bheora and another convict, Devi Singh. Six months later, in June 2005, he was arrested by the Delhi Police Special Cell.

In 2007, a trial court sentenced Hawara to death. In 2010, the HC commuted it to life, with no release, saying it had found Hawara to be an active participant in the conspiracy.

RG Kar case: Two years on, TMC leader held over ‘role in cover-up’

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, August 13

THE WEST Bengal Police Thursday arrested former Trinamool Congress (TMC) MLA Nirmal Ghosh from Sambalpur in Odisha in connection with a fresh FIR over over his alleged involvement in the “hurried cremation” of the doctor, who was raped and murdered at the state-run RG Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata in 2024.

Police said that Ghosh, who had been untraceable for days, was being brought back to West Bengal by road and is likely to be produced before the Barrackpore court in North 24 Parganas district on Friday.

The arrest follows a fresh FIR registered on Monday by the Barrackpore Police at Khardah Police Station, based on a complaint filed by the victim’s father. The victim’s father alleged that the accused were also present at his house where the body was first brought and exerted pressure on the family to quickly take it to the crematorium despite their unwillingness to do so.

Rs 513 CRORE IN EXCESS BUDGET DRAWN OVER SEVEN YEARS

CAG highlights unrealistic rates, cost overestimation by CPWD

Damini Nath
New Delhi, August 13

THE COMPTROLLER and Auditor General of India (CAG) has flagged “discrepancies” in the Central Public Works Department’s (CPWD) methodology for determining its Schedule of Rates — the basis for project cost estimation and tendering, finding that 93 percent of projects were awarded at costs below CPWD estimates.

In its report on the Union Government’s Economic and Service Ministries, tabled in Parliament on Wednesday, the CAG found that the rates in

CPWD’s Delhi Schedule of Rates (DSR) 2021 were unrealistic. The report says that the CPWD did not conduct a market survey before revising the schedule in 2021.

“The methodology adopted by CPWD for collection of base rates was not realistic. During the period from January 2022 to January 2023, out of 5,011 works, 4,666 or 93%, were awarded at tendered costs less than the estimated cost prepared based on DSR 2021,” the report said.

The CAG underlined the significance of an accurate schedule of rates, noting that CPWD’s budget is based on estimated

project costs. The department’s Budget Estimates rose from Rs 2,027.33 crore in 2020-21 to Rs 3,100.57 crore in 2021-22 and Rs 4,314.08 crore in 2022-23.

“If the rates of Schedule of Rates items are higher than prevailing market rates, the estimated project cost increases, which may result in undue benefit to the contractor,” the report warned, adding that accuracy of the estimates was imperative given the volume of public funds involved.

The CAG also flagged a “faulty process” for calculating contractor profit and overhead charges.

BJP MP stripped of ‘Banga Bibhushan’ after derogatory remarks on Netaji

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, August 13

A DAY after West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari warned against derogatory remarks on Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose, the government on Thursday withdrew and annulled the Banga Bibhushan award conferred to BJP Rajya Sabha MP Nagendra Ray, popularly known as Ananta Maharaja.

The order, issued by the Information and Cultural Affairs Department on Thursday, said the decision would take effect immediately.

Ray was conferred the state’s highest civilian honour by former chief minister Mamata

Banerjee on February 21, 2026 during an International Mother Language Day ceremony in Kolkata. The government said the award recognised “distinguished and exemplary contributions” to the state and its people and carried “a high degree of dignity, prestige, and institutional purpose”.

The order said that after the award was conferred, “certain facts and circumstances” came to the government’s notice which were considered serious enough to raise questions about Ray’s continued retention of the honour. “Upon such consideration, the competent authority is satisfied that the continued retention of the Banga Bibhushan

by Nagendra Ray alias Ananta Maharaj is inconsistent with the dignity, prestige and purpose of the honour,” the order read.

The government has directed that Ray’s name be removed from official lists of Banga Bibhushan recipients. He will also no longer be entitled to represent himself as a recipient of the award or claim any recognition, privilege or benefit specifically arising from it.

Ray had allegedly described Netaji as a “war criminal” and questioned the contribution of the Indian National Army to India’s freedom struggle. He had also purportedly claimed that Netaji had played no role in the freedom movement.

Saffron, white, saffron: Kolkata’s Academy of Fine Arts caught in BJP vs Left ‘paint war’

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 13

FROM SAFFRON to white and then back to saffron: A room in the Academy of Fine Arts in Kolkata has turned into a new battleground between the ruling BJP and the Left.

Two months after the BJP stormed to power in West Bengal after trouncing the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC in the Assembly polls, on July 12, some BJP activists painted a room of the Academy, used as its ticket counter, saffron in apparent deference to the new regime. This was protested by several Left-leaning intellectuals and artists. The Academy, which has a gallery and

many art works by several major artists, is one of the state’s leading cultural institutions.

Subsequently, some of the Left intellectuals, led by renowned theatre actor Chandan Sen, met Bengal BJP chief Samik Bhattacharya to protest against the Academy’s ticket counter room being painted saffron and to urge him not to politicise the institution. Samik said, “Those who have done it (painted it saffron), have made a mistake. The politics of changing colours is not BJP’s goal. Painting everything everywhere is not part of BJP’s agenda. You identify them, and we will take action.”

Nearly a month later, on August 11, a group of Left activists

and theatre artists went to the Academy and painted the ticket counter room white — from saffron. They were accompanied by CPM leader and former MP Bikash Bhattacharya, a lawyer. Officials from the Hastings police station were deployed there to avert any untoward incident.

A day later, however, a group of BJP workers led by the party’s Shibpur MLA Rudranil Ghosh, also a film actor and director, gathered at the Academy premises and repainted the ticket counter room saffron, amid chants of “*Jai Shri Ram*” and “*Vande Mataram*”.

Addressing BJP workers, Ghosh claimed, “You can see in the photo that the original colour



After Left activists painted the Academy’s ticket counter room white, claiming Samik Bhattacharya’s assurance was not met, MLA Rudranil Ghosh-led BJP workers repainted it saffron. EXPRESS

of this ticket counter was saffron with chocolate border. We just want to restore this, which was changed by the previous TMC government. But some Left intellectuals are trying to fool people, and to put red flags here. They never said a word on developments at the Academy (during the TMC rule). When its administration did wrong things, these artists never protested.”

Ghosh also alleged that Samik was “wrongly briefed” by the Left intellectuals. He said, “Samik Babu had given a call to free politics. We are following that path. If the colour changes again, it will be turned saffron once more. Why are you speaking in anti-India tones,

when India’s favourite colour is saffron? They misled Samik Bhattacharya. He is a busy man. No one told him what colour was here before.”

On his part, Samik said, “First some people hung red flags there. Others then painted an Academy room saffron. Then, some intellectuals came to me. I assured them, no political activity will be held at the Academy. Even after that, why CPM went there, why Bikash Bhattacharya went there? They changed the colour again. Naturally, if there is an action, an equal reaction should be there. We are against putting saffron colour on every installation because saffron is the colour of sacrifice.”

Thespian Chandan Sen maintained that the ticket counter room was “never saffron and was originally terracotta-coloured”. He said, “We wrote to the state government, BJP state president and the trustee board of Academy of Fine Arts after this room was painted saffron. BJP state chief called us. Our delegation sat with him. He sought 15-day time. When he did not do anything even after 15 days, we decided to do something and so it was painted white.”

Targeting the BJP over the row, Left filmmaker Kamaleswar Mukherjee said in a social media post, “No political opinion or ideology can be established by brute force.”

The Ideas Page



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DIS/AGREE

THE BEST OF BOTH SIDES

A weekly column, which offers not this-versus-that, but the best of both sides, to inform the debate



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

In the wake of the Jantar Mantar protests, what's the role of student politics?

Campus, democracy's first classroom



KANHAIYA KUMAR

THE MADHYA Pradesh High Court, responding to a PIL filed by student leaders including from the NSUI, has directed the state government to conduct elections in the state's university and college student unions. It is a welcome and long-delayed step. Student union elections in Madhya Pradesh have been conducted irregularly since 2006, when professor HS Sabharwal was murdered allegedly by ABVP activists (the six people booked were later acquitted) opposed to his conduct of elections in Ujjain's Madhav College.

Unfortunately, Madhya Pradesh is not an exception. It represents the national norm of governmental indifference or even repression of student politics — a trend that has accelerated significantly in the last decade. The Allahabad University Students Union, which has in the past been led by stalwarts like Hemwati Nandan Bahuguna, Narayan Dutt Tiwari, Shankar Dayal Sharma, and V P Singh, was abolished by the University's academic council in 2019. Aligarh Muslim University Student Union — of which Mahatma Gandhi himself was a life member — has been inactive since 2019. At the Tata Institute of Social Sciences, the administration has dissolved the student union and moved to an unelected students' council. Aside from Kerala and a handful of select universities — prominent among these being Panjab University, Delhi University, Jawaharlal Nehru University, Patna University, and the University of Hyderabad — the tradition of student elections has come to an abrupt halt.

The ostensible grounds for this aversion is the role that money and muscle power play in student elections. This is a very real concern, as evinced by professor Sabharwal's murder. But these are factors that operate in our Assembly and Lok Sabha elections as well, perhaps in a much more consequential way. The university is only emblematic of our society, just like our general body politic is. The refusal to conduct elections on these grounds is only a pretext. The recommendations of the Lyngdoh Committee (2006) on student elections have been made binding on educational institutions by the Supreme Court. They offer a meaningful and workable pathway to clean polls. Unfortun-

nately, university authorities — for instance, at Allahabad University — have used the Lyngdoh Committee to shut down elections altogether.

The aversion to student politics is actually motivated by a desire to eradicate pipelines of student leadership. Globally, as well as in India, it is organised student movements that have led political change. Some of our most prominent national leaders have come from student politics — including leading lights of the current regime, such as Arun Jaitley, Manoj Sinha, and Ravi Shankar Prasad. Yes, student politics is often a launchpad for politicians. But when the gates of our Parliament are open for criminals and industrialists, why are student leaders not kosher?

Our claim to be a democracy, and even the mother of democracy, appears hollow when faced with the reality of how our students are denied their rights to unionise and be represented in the administration of our higher education institutions. Education is not just a process of formal skilling for employment, it is also the process through which a citizenry is created. We become voters after being students. The attempts to divorce students from politics, also seen in the craven statements by several of Delhi's leading national universities during the protests last month, under-value the meaning of education. Critical thinking and freedom of expression, which are pillars of academia, cannot be limited to the classroom.

An elected student body also serves another purpose — it enables the authorities, be it the university administration or the state — to have a meaningful conversation with legitimate representatives of students. The organic nationwide student protests of the last few months have shown the need for the same. Indeed, the angst of the students on the streets of India is not divorced from the denial of their political agency and infantilisation in higher education. Students are demanding a voice, in their educational institutions to begin with, and in the uppermost echelons of politics if need be.

The leadership of the Indian National Congress is very keen on student elections, to the extent that internal elections are now being conducted in the National Students Union of India (NSUI). But the successful democratisation of our higher education will need the support of all parties and a shared resolve. This must be one of the key pillars of any resolution to the current crisis in our education sector.

The writer is in charge of the National Students Union of India, and former president, Jawaharlal Nehru University Students Union

Student politics has to be duty-oriented



YOGESH SINGH

THE CONFERMENT of the 2026 Dirac Medal, one of Physics' highest honours, upon Padma Bhushan professor Deepak Dhar is the fruit of nearly four decades of dedicated research in Indian institutions. It illustrates the conditions under which sustained scholarly excellence becomes possible. Stable, disruption-free academic environments enable the continuity and collaborative depth required for work of this calibre. Such environments are not merely administrative preferences. They constitute the necessary foundation for the development of genuine knowledge and intellectual confidence among successive generations of university students.

This intellectual confidence has long found expression in the distinctive place students have occupied in the nation's public life. From active participation in the freedom struggle to mobilisation during the Emergency and engagement with a range of contemporary social and political questions, students have consistently contributed to broader national conversations.

Yet the quality of that engagement depends heavily on how student representation is organised. When it is conducted with academic seriousness, transparency and a clear separation from external political interference, it becomes a genuine school of democratic responsibility. Age-appropriate eligibility criteria, insistence on regular attendance, academic integrity and modest campaign practices help ensure that leadership emerges from all sections of society.

The decision to hold student elections across universities and colleges in Madhya Pradesh offers an opportunity to demonstrate that electoral processes on campus can be conducted with seriousness, modest means, transparent rules and a clear focus on the welfare of the students. When elections train young people in public speaking, coalition-building, and the responsible exercise of authority, they strengthen both democratic habits and the institutional culture on which genuine rights depend. It is only when students embrace their duties towards the institution and their peers that their rights to representation and voice acquire lasting legitimacy and effectiveness.

Student politics, at its best, is a training ground for discussion, debate and the establishment of responsible narratives. A

university campus exists to nurture holistic development, compassionate thinking and a mindset that places the national interest and the pursuit of knowledge above factional advantage. When student leadership embraces this purpose, politics ceases to be a source of disruption and becomes a force for institutional strengthening.

A constructive, duty-oriented approach to student politics in universities and colleges would prioritise initiatives that strengthen the academic and social fabric of campuses. Campaigns focused on peer-study groups, research mentoring and support for learners can expand opportunity while raising overall standards. Cultural and educational efforts, through students' organisations, against ragging, emphasising respect, inclusion and institutional belonging offer more durable solutions than purely punitive measures alone. Structured peer mentoring programmes help newer students navigate academic and personal challenges. Regular, well-prepared debates and seminars on national and global issues provide forums for reasoned argument. Such activities train students in evidence-based discussion, listening, skills essential both to scholarship and to democratic citizenship.

Engagement with university administrations through data-backed proposals and dialogue tends to produce more durable outcomes. Success, in this framework, can be measured by concrete improvements such as an enhanced academic atmosphere and greater student participation in knowledge production. These metrics align student leadership with the long-term interests of students and with the wider goals of higher education. Institutions that combine intellectual freedom with disciplined environments are better positioned to produce professionals equipped for complex problem-solving and citizens prepared for democratic participation.

Constructive student politics does not diminish the capacity to criticise or seek reform. It refines and elevates that capacity by embedding it within practices of responsibility and mutual respect. Campuses oriented toward academic excellence, civic discipline and reasoned engagement, where student leadership balances legitimate demands with a strong sense of duty.

The achievements of scholars such as professor Dhar demonstrate that our campuses can generate work of global significance when conditions favour sustained inquiry. Expanding this possibility requires deliberate attention to the quality of campus culture, one in which student leadership itself becomes a partner in sustaining the conditions for excellence.

The writer is vice-chancellor, Delhi University

Restoring J&K's statehood is key to its political stability



UPENDRA KAUL

THE POLITICAL history of Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) reflects a complex interplay between democratic governance, constitutional change, security concerns, and central intervention. From its accession to India in 1947 until the constitutional changes of 2019, it alternated between elected governments and periods of direct central rule, largely shaped by political instability and cross-border security challenges. The present debate over the restoration of statehood remains central to the future political and administrative stability of the region.

Following the Delhi Agreement of 1952 and the adoption of the Constitution of Jammu and Kashmir, the state enjoyed a unique constitutional position under Article 370, which granted it substantial autonomy. During the early decades, political leadership was dominated by the Jammu & Kashmir National Conference (JKNC) under Sheikh Abdullah and, later, by Congress. Until 1965, the head of government was designated as the Prime Minister and the constitutional head of state as the Sadr-e-Riyasat, titles that underscored the state's distinctive status within the Union. These were subsequently replaced by the chief minister and governor, bringing the state closer to the administrative structure of other states.

Political stability, however, remained fragile. Whenever elected governments lost legitimacy or strategic concerns intensified, the Centre imposed Governor's Rule under the J&K Constitution or President's Rule under Article 356 of the Indian Constitution. A notable early crisis followed the theft of the Moie-Muqaddas (the sacred relic believed to be the hair of the Prophet Muhammad) in December 1963. The incident triggered widespread public unrest across the Kashmir Valley, seriously weakened the Khwaja Shamsuddin government, and required intervention by PM Jawaharlal Nehru and national intelligence agencies before the relic was recovered in January next year.

Between 1964 and the mid-1980s, J&K witnessed alternating governments led by Congress and JKNC. Although political tensions persisted, governance remained broadly functional. This changed dramatically after the controversial 1987 Assembly elections, widely perceived as manipulated, which led to deep public disillusionment. By 1989, Pakistan-backed militancy had escalated into a full-scale insurgency across the Valley.

The collapse of civil administration marked the beginning of the most turbulent period in the state's history. Farooq Abdullah's coalition government resigned in January 1990, leading to Governor's Rule with governance becoming focused primarily on restoring law and order rather than development. The period witnessed the tragic exodus of the Kashmiri Pandit community following targeted violence, severe disruption of public services, closure of educational institutions, collapse of tourism and economic activity, and the imposition of the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act (AFSPA). While sustained counter-insurgency operations eventually weakened militant networks and enabled the restoration of Assembly elections in 1996, the decade left lasting political, social, and psychological scars.

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ance structure. While an elected CM and Legislative Assembly are in place, key subjects — including public order, police, land administration, and significant bureaucratic authority — remain under the control of the LG, who represents the Union government. The elected government exercises limited executive authority, leading to frequent tensions over administrative powers and accountability.

The central political issue today is the restoration of statehood. Although the Centre has repeatedly stated that statehood will be restored at an "appropriate time," no definite timeline has been announced. Regional political parties argue that prolonged uncertainty weakens democratic governance and limits the effectiveness of elected institutions. In response, several non-BJP parties, led by the NC and supported by opposition groups, have intensified their demand for the immediate restoration of full statehood.

Several scenarios are possible. Sustained public mobilisation could increase pressure on the Centre through repeated Assembly resolutions and political negotiations. Alternatively, the Centre may adopt a phased approach to restoring statehood while retaining control over selected security-related functions. The continuing debate may also reinforce regional political differences between the Kashmir Valley, where demand for immediate statehood is strongest, and parts of Jammu, where greater support exists for the present constitutional arrangement.

The political evolution of J&K illustrates the continuing tension between national security priorities and the aspirations for democratic self-governance. The restoration of statehood, accompanied by a balanced distribution of powers between elected representatives and the Centre, remains central to achieving durable political stability, effective administration, and long-term public confidence in the region.

The writer is a cardiologist and founder director of Gauri Kaul Foundation

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Stalling of Parliament has high costs



GOURAV VALLABH

WITH The monsoon session concluded, Parliament's record must be judged by the work it completed. The latest verified figures available at the time of writing came from PRS Legislative Research. Covering scheduled sittings through August 13, they show that the Lok Sabha worked for 17.5 hours, or 15 per cent of scheduled time, while the Rajya Sabha worked for 37.37 hours, or 33 per cent.

India has no fresh official per-minute tariff. The widely used benchmark of Rs 2.5 lakh per minute for both houses dates to figures presented in 2012. Applying its commonly reported split of Rs 1.25 lakh per House-minute to the hour shortfall gives an indicative opportunity cost of about Rs 130 crore for the full session. This is a measure of taxpayer-funded capacity that did not become parliamentary work.

The financial cost is only the visible

edge. When Question Hour disappears, ministers escape questions that taxpayers have paid Parliament to ask. When legislative time collapses, bills are either delayed or passed without adequate scrutiny. This is becoming a norm.

Democratic work cannot be reduced to quarterly targets. Dissent is work. A reasoned speech against a bill is work. Protest is also a legitimate parliamentary instrument, and a walkout can place principled disagreement on record while allowing the House to proceed. But slogan-shouting that repeatedly forces adjournment turns one group's protest into a veto over every other member and voter.

The responsibility for a functioning Parliament is joint. The government has the first duty to list business transparently, provide adequate notice, make room for legitimate Opposition issues and ensure that ministers answer. The Opposition has an equally important responsibility to preserve the forum through which it scrutinises the executive. The majority cannot bulldoze;

the minority cannot blockade.

The events of August 12 make that distinction unavoidable. Home Minister Amit Shah, whose answer the Opposition had demanded, offered an extended debate, said he would sit through it until 3 pm on August 13 and respond to every question. The Opposition rejected the proposal. One may challenge the Home Minister's explanation, cross-examine it, reject it and continue to demand political accountability. But when the minister offers to reply in the House, why refuse the forum?

This is why PM Narendra Modi's emphasis on the "politics of performance" is relevant. He has repeatedly made measurable outcomes and last-mile execution central to governance. That standard cannot stop at Parliament's doors. A government that asks ministries to deliver should welcome rigorous legislative scrutiny. An Opposition that demands accountability should be judged by the quality of its questions, alternatives and interventions, not by the number of adjournments it can cause.

India needs a parliamentary-performance compact agreed by the government, Opposition and presiding officers. Its first rule should be: No lost hour without make-up time. If disruption erases scheduled business, the House should recover the time within the same session. Second, the right to protest should be matched by a guaranteed route to debate. Third, Parliament should publish a real-time dashboard showing attendance, questions, debates, committee work etc, to let citizens see whether public time produced public value. Finally, the daily allowance needs a clearer accountability rule. A member formally named or suspended by the Chair for a grave disorder should forfeit the allowance for that sitting. PM Modi's politics of performance has raised citizens' expectations from the government. Parliament, including the Opposition, must rise to the same standard.

The writer is professor of finance, XLRI, and part-time member, EAC-PM. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The final frontier

IN RECENT years, India has established itself as a significant spacefaring nation, particularly through the success of the Chandrayaan missions, which have demonstrated its capabilities in lunar exploration and planetary science through cost-effective operations ("The next step to the moon", *IE*, August 13). As space exploration becomes increasingly complex and expensive, joint missions and multinational frameworks can expedite breakthroughs while mitigating financial and technological risks. The expanding ISRO-NASA cooperation in lunar exploration presents opportunities for advanced expertise while strengthening bilateral ties.

— Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Learning to listen

THE DECLINE of attentive listening is an increasingly visible social problem ("The song we haven't learned to hear", *IE*, August 13). Constant notifications, hurried conversations and excessive dependence on digital communication often leave little room for patience or genuine understanding. Families and schools can encourage children to have regular, undistracted conversations and develop the habit of listening before responding. Workplaces should also recognise listening as an important part of communication and teamwork. Community activities can create opportunities for meaningful interaction. Respectful dialogue begins with giving others time.

— S P Suganya Devi, Coimbatore

TVK govt marks 100 days with Rs 67,542cr investment bonanza

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, August 13

AT THE end of its first 100 days in power, the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam-led government Thursday sought to define its economic ambitions not simply by the size of investments it could attract, but by something considerably harder to manufacture: the confidence that factories can be built, approvals secured and businesses expanded without the government becoming an obstacle.

At its first major investment conclave, the Vetttri Tamil Nadu Investment Conclave 2026 in Chennai, the government signed 97 memoranda of understanding involving proposed investments of Rs. 67,542 crore and employment for more than one lakh people. The agreements take the cumulative investment commitments secured during the government's first 100 days past Rs 1 lakh crore, with more than 1.2 lakh potential jobs, Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Minister S Keerthana said.

The MoUs were exchanged in the presence of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, Keerthana, Guidance Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Deepak Jacob and Industries Secretary S Vijayakumar. Guidance, the State's investment-promotion agency, was instrumental in bringing together the agreements. For a government completing its first 100 days, the conclave also offered Vijay's administration an opportunity to set out the economic architecture behind its promise of building a 1.5-trillion USD Tamil Nadu economy by 2036.

"It is a big number, but its impact is even larger," Keerthana said. "For a young graduate, growth means a better job. For a woman, it can mean economic independence. For an entrepreneur, it means the confidence to take a risk. For a family, it means upward mobility. And for a district like Ramana-thapuram, which is receiving



CM C Joseph Vijay PTI

its first industrial investment today, it means that a young person will not have to leave home to find opportunity."

That emphasis on geography in the industrial projects is significant in a state whose industrial strength has historically grown through several regional entrepreneurial centres rather than around Chennai alone. Coimbatore's rise was particularly striking because it lacked many conventional advantages of an industrial centre — mineral resources, proximity to major ports or the status of a political or financial capital — yet developed into a manufacturing powerhouse through locally rooted entrepreneurship.

Thursday's investment map suggests that the Vijay government wants to extend that geography while changing its technological composition.

The Hinduja Group has committed Rs 2,500 crore across renewable energy, electric mobility, automotive and digital mobility businesses. Phoenix Kothari Group's Rs 1,000-crore investment will mark Ramana-thapuram's first major industrial investment.

Germany's Daimler India Commercial Vehicles will invest Rs 4,000 crore to expand its 400-acre Oragadam operation for commercial-vehicle design.

Saint-Gobain has proposed Rs 2,000 crore for a greenfield facility in Krishnagiri and expansion in Kancheepuram, while Japanese zipper and fastening-products manufacturer YKK will invest Rs 1,651 crore in Tiruvallur.



Rescue operation underway at the tunnel on Thursday. ANI

Three feared trapped, 16 rescued as water, debris enter tunnel in Chamoli

Press Trust of India
Dehradun, August 13

AT LEAST three workers were feared trapped and 16 rescued on Thursday after water and debris entered a tunnel under construction at a hydroelectric project site in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand, officials said.

Some of those rescued sustained minor injuries in the incident that occurred at the Tehri Hydro Development Corporation (THDC) Limited's project site in the Pipalkoti area. The construction work is being carried out by the Hindustan Construction Company (HCC),

the officials said.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami said the government's top priority is to safely rescue those trapped.

According to the state government, 18 to 19 workers were trapped inside the tunnel around 7 pm. So far, 16 of them have been safely rescued and the operation to bring out the remaining workers is underway.

Uttarakhand Chief Secretary Anand Vardhan said reports were received that several workers were trapped after water and debris entered the tunnel of the Pipalkoti hydro-electric project.

Rajasthan clears draft UCC Bill with a clause for live-in relations

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, August 13

THE RAJASTHAN Cabinet Thursday approved the draft Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill — the fifth state to do so. The Bill, aimed at regulating marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships, is one of two that the Cabinet cleared for introduction in the upcoming Assembly session.

Deputy Chief Minister Premchand Bairwa announced the decision after the Cabinet meeting, chaired by Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma. The Cabinet also cleared the Bill for the protection of 29 trees, including Khejri, the revered state tree.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister, Jogaram Patel, said that under the proposed UCC law, it will be mandatory to register marriages within 60 days. "The Bill's primary objective is to provide uniform, transparent, and systematic

1991 Jammu railway blast: 'Businessman' held after 35 yrs

Arun Sharma & Naveed Iqbal
Jammu/Srinagar, August 13

THE RAILWAY Police in Jammu have arrested a man allegedly involved in the 1991 bomb blast at Jammu Railway Station, marking the first breakthrough in the case in 35 years.

Three people, including two paramilitary troopers, had died and 18 were injured in the blast on Jammu Railway Station's Platform No. 1. The J&K Police said Thursday that the Government Railway Police (GRP), Jammu, arrested absconding terrorist Altaf Hussain Sheikh, a resident of Bijbehara, Anantnag, after 35 years. The accused had allegedly gone underground and was living under an assumed identity for decades.

This comes two years after GRP Jammu launched an intensive manhunt to find the suspect. Police said they had verified his identity by "minutely going into details of his identity and residential particulars and discovered him living under a concealed identity who had established himself as a successful businessman in the Bijbehara area."

Sheikh was produced before a TADA court Thursday. This is the second arrest in the case.

governance of laws related to marriage, divorce, inheritance, maintenance, and live-in relationships in the state," he said, "The Bill's provisions will not apply to Scheduled Tribes, while classes with traditional rights protected under the Constitution are also excluded."

He said that the draft was prepared based on the recommendations of an expert committee headed by retired Supreme Court Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai. Its provisions make marriage registration mandatory and prohibit polygamy. While all religions and communities will have complete freedom to solemnise marriages according to their own customs, registration would be mandatory. A provision has also been made for written notice or registration of the beginning and end of live-in relationships, "which will protect the rights of both parties".

Patel said that the Registrar must issue a certificate within Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

15 days of receiving the memorandum for registration of marriage or divorce, or reject the application in writing. If the Registrar rejects the application, an appeal may be filed within 30 days before the Registrar General, which must be resolved within 60 days.

A marriage will not be considered invalid merely because of a failure or delay in registration. However, failure to register will result in a fine of up to Rs 10,000, and failure to register even after receiving a notice will result in a fine of up to Rs 25,000.

Patel said that the Bill establishes a clear judicial process for resolving disputes arising after marriage. "Clear provisions have been made for the court to declare a marriage void based on reasons including violation of the Code, forced or fraudulent consent, or impotence," he said. Additionally, sons and daughters have been granted equal inheritance rights. If a person dies without a will, their

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EXPRESS special

'Last local militant': Why 22-year-old Mohd Lateef Bhat has Valley on alert

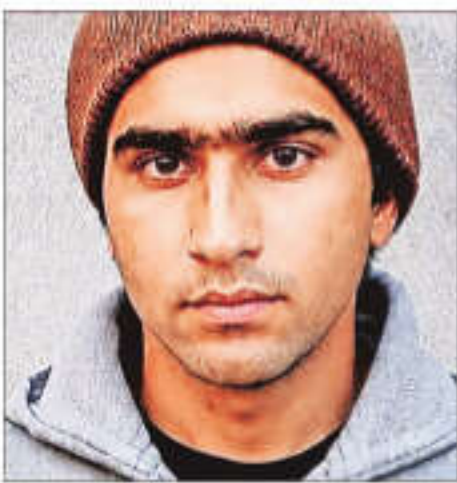
Bashaarat Masood
Srinagar, August 13

LAST FRIDAY, Jammu and Kashmir Police announced a reward of Rs 15 lakh for information leading to the arrest of Mohammad Lateef Bhat, and put up posters with his photo across South Kashmir and Srinagar.

Bhat, 22, is accused of killing a policeman and two non-local workers, in separate attacks in South Kashmir last month — the first militant hits in the Valley since the Pahalgam attack in July 2025. He is the only surviving local militant active in the Valley, as per J&K Police records.

A resident of Khrewan Chader village of South Kashmir's Kulgam, Bhat is said to have joined militant ranks only last year. Allegedly associated with the Lashkar-e-Toiba, he went under the radar till he was captured on a surveillance camera in South Kashmir's Shopian on July 2 night, along with an aide, Zakir Ahmad Ganai. In a joint police and Army operation later, Ganai was killed. But Bhat managed to evade capture.

The two latest attacks attributed to Bhat include the killing of Ashiq Hussain, a head constable with the Special Operations Group, in a crowded mar-



Mohammad Lateef Bhat, who joined militant ranks in 2025, is accused of killing a head constable and two non-local workers in separate attacks in South Kashmir in July. EXPRESS

ket in Anantnag on July 22, and the shooting of two non-local workers at a brick kiln in Kulgam's Kilam village nine days later. A student of Government Higher Secondary School in Ashmuji, Kulgam, Bhat joined Government Degree College in Kulgam for a Bachelor's degree but did not finish the course. For a short period after that, Bhat worked as a glazier. In early 2025, he left home and went underground. His inspiration in joining the militant ranks was Ganai, who was with the Lashkar. In November 2025, an outfit called the Kashmir Revolution-

ary Army (KRA) formally announced he had joined them.

Police believe the KRA is also a shadow name of the Lashkar, same as The Resistance Front (TRF), which has been taking credit for militant attacks in the Valley recently, including last month's. The TRF is the most well-known, having emerged just months into the scrapping of J&K's special status and its bifurcation into two UTs in August 2019. The first attack for which the TRF claimed credit was the October 2019 grenade explosion at a street market in Srinagar, in which five vendors were injured. Security agencies initially dismissed the claim, describing the blast as an "act of miscreants" aimed at prolonging the shutdown that followed the August 2019 changes.

The first signs that the TRF was emerging as a significant and strong militant group came when the J&K Police busted a network of overground workers in North Kashmir's Sopore — the town had once been a strong base of the Lashkar in the Valley — and Kupwara. The arrested workers reportedly revealed that they were "recruiting youths for the new outfit". A week later, the TRF claimed responsibility for the attack on a paramilitary ve-

hicle in Sopore, in which three CRPF personnel were killed and two injured. It also claimed through Telegram channels that two militants killed in Handwara, in an operation in which senior Army officers (a Colonel and a Major) and a police officer were killed, were affiliated to it. By mid-2020, the security agencies had begun treating the TRF as a significant militant outfit.

In January 2023, the Union Home Ministry designated the TRF a "terrorist organisation" under the UAPA. Since Ganai's killing, Bhat is believed to be trying to keep the TRF alive by activating its sleeper cells. "The attacks can't be the work of a lone wolf," a police officer said, pointing out that Bhat must have had "logistical support, which suggests he has a well-organised network of overground workers, even if small".

Another police officer said that while Bhat may be the only local active militant in records, the actual number could be higher. "Over the years, militancy has become increasingly insulated. As both human and technical intelligence have dried up, little information is coming about the groups' organisational structure, strength and plans."

{ SUMIT SARKAR • 1939-2026 }

Foremost Indian historian whose lectures were 'musical'

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
New Delhi, August 13

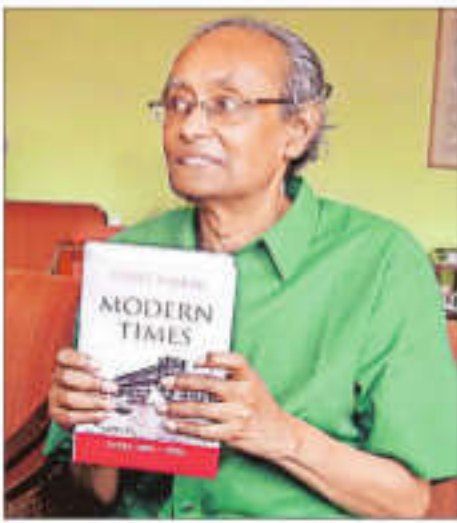
WHEN PROFESSOR Sumit Sarkar began a lecture at Delhi University, the room would be packed and, one former student recalls, there would be "pin drop silence". He spoke softly, calmly and without theatricality, but students were so absorbed that they would lose track of time.

"He was very musical in his lectures while dealing with academic subjects," recalls Professor Vikas Gupta, a Delhi University historian who was taught by Sarkar in the early 2000s.

Sarkar, one of the foremost historians of modern India, died on Thursday at 87 after being unwell for years. He taught at Delhi University from 1974 to 2004 and influenced generations of students.

Born in 1939, Sarkar grew up in a family steeped in history. His father, Sushobhan Chandra Sarkar, was a renowned historian. An alumnus of Presidency College, Sarkar earned his master's and PhD from the University of Calcutta, where he later taught. He also taught at the University of Burdwan and Oxford.

His name is closely linked



Sumit Sarkar. ALI NADEEM REZAI

with the historiography of the Swadeshi movement in Bengal.

His book *The Swadeshi Movement* in Bengal is regarded as a foundational work. Beyond that, *Writing Social History* and *Modern India* are especially admired by students and enthusiasts of history. But former students say reducing Sarkar to a Marxist historian would miss a quality of his intellectual life: his refusal to remain confined to a single historiographical framework.

"He was not somebody who anybody can really put into any confines," said Naresh Kumar, associate professor of history at Delhi University's Kamala Nehru College, who was taught

by Sarkar in the late 1990s.

Sarkar remained committed to Marxism but transformed it through his own questions. One idea closely associated with him was "pressure from below", an approach that examined the freedom struggle through the actions and demands of ordinary people, including women, tribals, Dalits and workers.

For Kumar, Sarkar was a rare combination of scholar and teacher. "I didn't write even a single word in his class," he said, comparing Sarkar's lectures to an "*alap*" in a raga.

(WITH INPUTS FROM ATRI MITRA IN KOLKATA)

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

Delhi Sultanate

Specific Elective (DSE) papers proposed by DU's History Department, 16 were notified in the Semester III syllabus, records show.

Several other papers, not including the ones listed above, remain in categories described in university records as "under discussion" or "undiscussed".

The postgraduate papers on "Delhi Sultanate" and "History of North India" have similarities with a paper offered in the undergraduate programme. However, a faculty member from the History department said both "are not comparable". The postgraduate paper on the sultanate has been "a core medieval India paper for several decades", the member said. The paper on North India was a "specialised thematic and his-

torical study", the member said, unlike the undergraduate version, which is a "survey course" on Indian history.

A DSE is an elective course within a student's chosen discipline. For instance, it allows a History student to choose a specialised area rather than study only mandatory papers.

The process of changing a syllabus at DU involves several stages. A department discusses and clears its proposed courses through its Committee of Courses. The proposal then goes to the university's Standing Committee and, subsequently, the Academic Council, the university's apex academic body. Once approved by Academic Council, the syllabus goes to the Executive Council for final approval.

When contacted, DU's Dean

of Academic Affairs, K Ratnabali, said: "None of the courses were held back. We took everything to the Academic Council, which gave the Vice-Chancellor the liberty to constitute an Expert Committee to look into courses that required review. The committee included three external experts, the Head of the Department and two Academic Council members."

Ratnabali said: "The issue was that even after papers were cleared by the Standing Committee, the department had made changes to some of the approved syllabi... papers were added or deleted, units were changed and readings were removed or replaced. This created a trust deficit and meant that the syllabi had to be revisited. The committee examined the revised syllabi and cleared those that were found to be in order for notification. A few more papers are also expected to be notified

once the committee completes its review."

Sources familiar with the Expert Committee's review told *The Indian Express*: "The committee has given suggestions to the department to make changes to a few courses... The review was aimed at making the syllabus more representative of different regions and periods of Indian history, while also ensuring that it was aligned with the objectives of the NEP."

Expert Committee chief, Prof Shri Prakash Singh, Vice-Chancellor of Hemvati Nandan Bahuguna Garhwal University, did not comment. Prof Anirudh Deshpande, who heads the History department at DU's Faculty of Social Sciences, declined to comment.

Another member from the Faculty of Social Sciences asserted that the revisions follow "a pattern of courses and papers, which were being taught for dec-

ades, being axed, especially in the Social Sciences, since the revisions for NEP 2020 have started both in undergraduate and post graduate syllabus revisions".

In August 2023, *The Indian Express* first reported on NEP-linked changes in DU's undergraduate History syllabus, with references to "Brahmanisation" removed, and a paper titled "Inequality and Difference" dropped, apart from other changes.

According to the postgraduate syllabus document placed before the DU's Academic Council, the course on Delhi Sultanate sought to examine "various historiographical interpretations of the 13th and 14th centuries" and reconsider how the period fits into the broader history of India.

It examined the formation of the Delhi Sultanate and the political culture of the 13th and 14th centuries, as well as spiritual and religious traditions of

the period. The other paper, "History of North India, c. 1400-1550", focused on the period between the disintegration of the Delhi Sultanate and the emergence of the Mughal Empire.

It examined Afghan political cultures, the diffusion of political power under different regimes, forms of patronage and literary cultures. It also looked at Sufism and Bhakti as forms of social and political authority, alongside debates around state formation, Islamisation, socialisation and intellectual production. According to faculty members familiar with the curriculum, both papers were part of the old syllabus for the 2019-20 academic year and had been taught in the department for several years.

The omissions are not confined to medieval history, records show.

"Gender and Women in Early India: 1500 BCE to 1000

CE" examined women across Brahmanical, Buddhist, Jain and Tantric traditions. It covered marriage, family, property and stridhana, and examined women as rulers, patrons and workers. The course also asked whether literary and inscriptional sources could reveal a distinct "female voice".

Another dropped elective, "Political Processes and Structure of Polities in Ancient India", traced the evolution of political institutions from early formations to the Mauryan and Gupta empires and later regional states. Its themes included taxation, warfare, bureaucracy, land grants, queens, temples, merchant guilds and local administration.

"Religion and Society in Ancient Indian Literature" examined Vedic and Upanishadic traditions, Buddhism and Jainism, epic and Puranic traditions, Shaivism, Vaishnavism,

Bharat Tiwari encounter: Bihar promises job to kin, financial aid

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 13

BIHAR CHIEF Minister Samrat Choudhary has announced financial assistance and a government job for a member of the family of Bharat Bhushan Tiwari, who was killed in a police encounter in Bhojpur district in June. The announcement came soon after the judicial commission probing the encounter submitted its interim report.

In a post on X Thursday, Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary said: "Based on the interim report of the judicial inquiry, the Bihar government will provide financial assistance to the family of the late Bharat Tiwari, and offer a government job to one family member."

This came days after a judicial commission submitted a report into the killing of Tiwari, a 28-year-old man who was killed in a police encounter in Bhojpur's Belauthi village on June 17. The killing eventually became a political flashpoint.

BJP spokesperson Neeraj Kumar Sharma told *The Indian Express* that the CM's decision "proves that the rule of law prevails in Bihar, and that the government is sensitive to the rights and dignity of every citizen".

Tiwari, whose family described him as a social activist, was shot on the morning of June 17 and died later that day at Patna Medical College and Hospital. At the time of the killing, police said Tiwari was armed and "mentally unsound", leading them to shoot him in self-defence.

Kolkata: Nurse found dead in hospital toilet, investigation on

Sweety Kumari
Kolkata, August 13

A 30-YEAR-OLD nurse was found dead inside a washroom at NRS Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata late on Wednesday night, police said.

According to the preliminary investigation, she reported for duty around 8 pm and went to the staff washroom at the antenatal ward in the Gynaecology Department Building around 10.20 pm, police said.

"When she did not return for some time, her colleagues went to check on her and found the washroom door locked. After repeated knocks drew no response, two of them broke open the door and found her lying unconscious on the floor," police said. "A doctor was called to examine the nurse, and she was subsequently declared dead," a Kolkata Police officer said.

The NRS police outpost was informed, following which the Entally police station was alerted. According to sources, the woman had married in March and was living with her husband in Dum Dum.

Several medicine vials were reportedly found near her body, prompting investigators to examine whether she died following an overdose of an anaesthetic drug, sources said. However, police are yet to ascertain the cause of death, they added.

"No suicide note has been recovered. The cause of death can be ascertained after post mortem examination," Additional CP (Crime) Kunal Agarwal said.

Shaktism and popular religious practices.

The History department had raised concerns about the status of the syllabus before the August 7 notification. In a formal resolution dated August 4 and addressed to Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh, the Department Council noted that the new academic session had begun on July 28 but the Semester III syllabus had not yet been officially notified.

"Without access to official syllabus, students cannot exercise informed choices for optional papers," the resolution said.

"In addition to the cleared papers in the Academic Council agenda file there were two other categories of papers treated as 'under discussion' by the Dean (Academic Affairs) on the grounds of cross-checking the revisions required some more time," the resolution said.

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- Land Interest Subsidy:** 50% for 7 years (up to ₹1 crore/year)
- 100% Stamp Duty Exemption:** For Pharma Park developers and park-based units
- 100% Electricity Duty Waiver:** For 10 years
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- CETP/Waste Management Support:** 40% of project cost (up to ₹10 crore)
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- Single-Window Clearance:** Fast-track approvals under CMO oversight
- FSDA Nodal Support:** Dedicated assistance for pollution NOCs and statutory approvals



Policy Driving Progress



- UP Pharmaceutical & Medical Device Industry Policy-2023 accelerates investments with:
 - Capital subsidies & tax incentives
 - Stamp duty & electricity duty exemptions
 - R&D and patent support
 - Single-window clearances
 - Time-bound approvals
- Strong implementation backed by proactive governance.

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• EDUCATION

The row over Punjab’s 3 Bills creating ‘digital universities’

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, August 13

PUNJAB IS positioning itself as one of the first states in India to create a comprehensive framework for private “digital universities”. These are self-financed private universities that will deliver education entirely through digital, distance or open modes.

The Assembly recently passed three Bills pertaining to such universities amid objections from the Opposition. What is the AAP government’s reasoning and why have the proposed pieces of legislation sparked controversy?

The ‘Punjab Digital Universities Bills’

On Monday, the Vidhan Sabha passed the Cloud University, Hoshiarpur Bill, 2026; MS Digital University, Patiala Bill, 2026; and Physicswallah Digital University, Patiala Bill, 2026. These Bills enable the establishment of three private digital open universities in the state.

The Bills will implement the Punjab Private Digital Open Universities Policy, 2026, which was notified in January. The policy aims to expand access to higher education through fully online and digital modes, attract reputed private and edtech players, and allow students to complete entire undergraduate, postgraduate and professional programmes from home.

Key features include online classes, digital assessments, virtual laboratories, and technology-enabled tools. These universities will also integrate Learning Management Systems, digital content studios, cloud hosting, artificial intelligence (AI)-proctored exams, AI-enabled learning pathways, live sessions, mentoring, and 24×7 student support.

The three universities, their funding

Cloud University will be located in Hoshiarpur district. It is promoted by the Rayat and Bahra Group, who are already running three private universities in the region. The MS Digital University will be located in Patiala district. It is associated with Balraj Singla Education Society, which also runs educational institutes around Patiala. The Physicswallah Digital University will also come up in Patiala. It is operated by NextSeed Foundation linked to the edtech company Physics Wallah.

Undergraduate, postgraduate and professional courses will be offered across disciplines such as engineering, medical sciences, humanities, management and more.

These universities are completely self-financed. The Punjab government will provide no grants or financial assistance. Sponsors must maintain a minimum corpus fund of Rs 20 crore to be used only for university development. An Ombudsman for student grievances has to be appointed by the universities. The Governor of Punjab will act as Visitor with inspection powers, while the Chancellor is nominated by the sponsoring body. Penalties up to Rs 25 lakh can be imposed for violations of UGC or other norms.

STUDY FROM HOME

- These Bills enable new private digital open universities that will allow students to complete undergraduate, postgraduate, and professional programmes from home.
- However, Opposition leaders have accused the government of prioritising private entities and companies over strengthening public institutions.

The political row

The government says these new universities will pave the way for a digital education revolution in the state. But Opposition leaders accused it of prioritising private entities and companies over strengthening public institutions.

The Congress has questioned how courses that require mandatory laboratory or practical facilities such engineering, medical, or science programmes would be properly conducted in a digital format. The party also objected to the lack of government oversight and said these Bills flout UGC norms.

Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains said the Congress had been misled by the introductory paragraph of the Bills and have not gone through the operative clause. According to Bains, Clause 4(b) of the Objects of the Bill clearly states: “to ensure adherence to the UGC (Open and Distance Learning Programmes and Online Programmes) Regulations, 2020, the National Credit Framework, the Credit Framework for Online Learning, and the Academic Bank of Credits”.

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• POLITY

FCRA Bill: Can Joint Parliamentary Committees affect the course of legislation?

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 13

LOK SABHA Wednesday referred the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 to a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) amid strong objections from the Opposition and the Church to some provisions. The referral gives the Bill a second layer of scrutiny. But how much difference can a parliamentary committee actually make?

What are Parliamentary committees tasked with?

Committees were created to address a basic limitation of Parliament: the two Houses have limited time to examine an increasingly complex body of legislation and policy. Smaller committees can spend more time to examine a Bill, question officials, hear experts and stakeholders, and examine provisions clause by clause.

As described in Rajya Sabha’s literature,

the underlying philosophy of the committee system is “influence, not direct control; advise, not command; criticism, not obstruction; scrutiny, not initiative; accountability, not prior approval.”

There are several kinds of committees. The Department-related Standing Committees examine the functioning and policies of ministries on an ongoing basis. Financial committees scrutinise government expenditure. Select Committees are constituted by a House for a specific Bill, while a JPC has members from both Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha and is constituted for a Bill or issue. Committee recommendations are not binding.

If the ruling party has a majority, how independent can a JPC be?

That is the central limitation of committees. JPC membership broadly reflects the strength of parties in Parliament. The chairperson is also generally from the government benches. The committee can take

decisions by majority, but the chairperson has a casting vote in case of a tie.

That does not make committees meaningless. The Opposition has several tools: it can question officials, put evidence on record, propose changes to the draft report and, if they disagree with the majority, file a dissent note. The question is whether Opposition MPs can change the law. Here, the record is much less encouraging. It is rare for their position to make it to the final law, particularly when the Bill concerns a politically central objective of the government.

Have JPCs actually changed laws?

Yes — but generally by modifying rather than overturning the government’s legislative project. The Stock Market Scam JPC of 2001-02, constituted during the Vajpayee-led NDA government, produced detailed recommendations on regulatory surveillance and coordination between markets regulator SEBI and stock exchanges. The government later reported

action on 236 recommendations.

Recent JPCs show a similar pattern of modification. The Multi-State Co-operative Societies (Amendment) Bill, 2022, for instance, emerged from the JPC with changes relating to the composition and functioning of the proposed Cooperative Election Authority.

There are also cases where scrutiny contributed to the government abandoning a particular legislative vehicle. A JPC examined the Financial Resolution and Deposit Insurance (FRDI) Bill, 2017 amid concerns over depositor protection. The government then withdrew the Bill, although public and political opposition also played a role.

Importantly, a JPC’s value lies in forcing the government to explain, amend, clarify or reconsider parts of a Bill.

What about Opposition objections?

The Personal Data Protection Bill JPC is perhaps the clearest recent example of Opposition dissent being formally recorded but

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not prevailing. The committee retained broad exemptions for the government, while Opposition members objected to them and six members filed dissent notes. The government eventually withdrew the Bill and introduced new legislation in 2022, although it still gave broad exemption powers.

The Citizenship (Amendment) Bill, 2016 also underwent committee scrutiny. The JPC retained the Bill’s central objective of granting citizenship to specified non-Muslim migrants from Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan. Opposition objections did not alter the central framework in the 2019 Act.

The 2G JPC, constituted under the UPA-II government, illustrates the same problem from the other side of the political spectrum. It broadly defended the Congress-led government’s position on telecom allocation. Opposition members filed dissent notes, but the JPC’s conclusions had limited influence on the issue’s trajectory.

This suggests that the partisan character of JPCs is not unique to this government.

Has committee system weakened?

The most striking change is in the broader decline in the use of parliamentary committees for Bills.

Data from PRS Legislative Research shows that about 60% of Bills were referred to committees in the 14th Lok Sabha (2004-09) and around 71% in the 15th Lok Sabha (2009-14). The figure fell sharply to about 25% in the 16th Lok Sabha (2014-19) and roughly 16% in the 17th Lok Sabha (2019-24). These figures cover referral to committees generally, not just JPCs.

The emerging pattern is that routine scrutiny has weakened while JPCs have increasingly been used for particularly contentious Bills. That makes the FCRA referral significant. The government could have pushed the Bill through Lok Sabha; it has the numbers. Instead, following objections, it has chosen a JPC. The committee will provide a formal forum to put concerns on record and for the government to decide which of them it is prepared to accommodate.

• CORPORATE

Trust factor: Tata’s twin power centres, their tussle



GEORGE MATHIEW

NATARAJAN CHANDRASEKARAN’S decision not to seek another term as chairman of Tata Sons brings to an end, at least in its present form, a leadership chapter that began in 2017. But his exit did not happen suddenly. It followed six months of uncertainty over his reappointment, differences with Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata, questions over the performance of some unlisted businesses, and a wider governance tussle within the Tata Trusts.

Tata Trusts are the majority shareholder of Tata Sons which, in turn, is the principal holding company of the \$180-billion Tata Group. What explains the split between the two power centres — Chandrasekaran at Tata Sons and Noel Tata at Tata Trusts?

Pre-empting trustees’ move?

According to the plan being discussed among some trustees, the August 13 meeting of Tata Trusts was expected to consider opposing or withholding an extension of Chandrasekaran’s tenure. Any such decision could then have been taken up formally at the Tata Sons annual general meeting (AGM) on August 18, potentially placing the issue of his continuation squarely before shareholders, said a Tata group source.

Rather than wait for the trustees — read Noel Tata — to take a position and risk a potentially public and contentious showdown at the AGM, Chandrasekaran is understood to have preferred to step down on his own terms. Just weeks ago, the Tata Sons AGM notice had proposed his name for reappointment as a director. “That was a procedural move,” said a Tata source.

Differences out in the open

The first public sign of trouble came on February 24, when the Tata Sons board deferred a decision on extending Chandrasekaran’s tenure for a third term. His tenure runs until February 2027, and the proposal was for another five years.

The issue was not simply whether Chandrasekaran had performed well. The deeper question was whether the Tata Trusts,



N Chandrasekaran, chairman of Tata Sons, enters Bombay House in Mumbai, Thursday. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

which collectively own about 66% of Tata Sons, were comfortable with his continuation. Noel Tata raised concerns about losses at some group companies, capital deployment and the future structure of Tata Sons. Keeping Tata Sons unlisted was among the conditions being discussed.

Four directors were then ready to vote in support of Chandrasekaran. Chandrasekaran himself said he proposed postponing the decision, and later explained that the February proposal did not receive unanimous support. He said one board member did not support his reappointment and that, in the absence of unanimity, he chose to defer the matter. This was significant because the Tata Group has historically placed emphasis on consensus, particularly on major leadership questions. Once the February decision was deferred, the uncertainty remained unresolved for six months.

To list or not

There was a growing view within the group that Noel Tata never fully trusted Chandrasekaran, particularly when it came to the direction of Tata Sons. Some in the group also felt that Chandrasekaran was not doing enough to keep Tata Sons private or to address mounting losses at some of the group’s unlisted companies.

“Chandra would have supported the listing of Tata Sons had he not been the chair-

man. Noel and the old-timers want the firm to remain unlisted and preserve the culture and heritage,” said a source familiar with the thinking within the Tata group.

The listing issue, therefore, reflected a broader tension between the demands of corporate governance and capital allocation on one hand, and the desire to protect the Tata group’s long-established structure, culture and legacy on the other.

Mounting losses

Tata group’s market capitalisation has more than tripled over the past nine years to around Rs 27 lakh crore.

- But this has been accompanied by mounting losses at some of the group’s major unlisted businesses.

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Losses at unlisted companies

Tata Group’s market capitalisation has more than tripled over the past nine years to around Rs 27 lakh crore. But this has been accompanied by mounting losses at some of the group’s major unlisted businesses. This raises questions about the financial performance of companies that do not directly contribute to the group’s listed-market valuation.

The losses of eight unlisted Tata companies stood at Rs 33,538 crore in FY26. Air India accounted for the largest share of these losses, with its annual loss doubling to Rs 22,238 crore. Tata Digital, another key unlisted business that houses the group’s digital ambitions, reported a loss of Rs 4,974 crore during the year.

The widening losses at these businesses became a major point of contention between Noel Tata and Chandrasekaran. While the group’s listed companies have

N Chandrasekaran’s decision to leave the group reflects a wider conflict with Noel Tata, the chairman of Tata Trusts, over governance and direction

created substantial shareholder value and helped push Tata Group’s combined market capitalisation to unprecedented levels, the performance and capital requirements of some of its unlisted ventures have remained a significant concern. Noel Tata raised questions about these losses.

At the same time, Chandrasekaran’s remuneration has risen sharply during his tenure as chairman of Tata Sons. His total remuneration increased nearly threefold to Rs 158.66 crore in FY26, from Rs 55.11 crore in FY18. Cumulatively, his remuneration since FY18 has crossed Rs 900 crore.

The sharp increase in remuneration comes against the backdrop of a period in which the Tata Group has undertaken an aggressive expansion and transformation of several businesses, including aviation, digital services and retail ventures. While supporters could point to the substantial increase in the group’s market value and the scale of the businesses being overseen, the rise in executive pay alongside mounting losses at unlisted companies has also intensified scrutiny over capital allocation, accountability and governance at Tata Sons.

Tata Trusts: A house divided

The dispute between Noel Tata and Chandrasekaran cannot be understood separately from the tensions within Tata Trusts. Noel Tata became chairman of Tata Trusts after Ratan Tata’s death in October 2024 with the support of all trustees. The trusts are an important factor because they control about two-thirds of Tata Sons and exercise enormous influence over the group in nominating directors and finding a successor.

Soon after Noel Tata’s takeover, differences emerged among trustees over governance, board representation and decision-making. Mehli Mistry, a close associate of Ratan Tata, eventually lost his position on the boards of the two principal trusts. Mistry later questioned governance arrangements and potential conflicts of interest before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner. There were also disagreements involving Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh over trustee and Tata Sons board positions. Srinivasan, though a trustee, approached the Charity Commissioner over the composition of trustees at Sir Ratan Tata Trust.

These developments show that the post-Ratan Tata era was not characterised by the same institutional cohesion that had prevailed earlier.

• LEGAL

Justice Varma case: What parliamentary probe panel found

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, August 13

MONTHS AFTER former Allahabad High Court judge Yashwant Varma resigned as a judge, a parliamentary inquiry committee has found that he was unable to explain the presence, source or ownership of a “huge quantity” of unexplained cash found at his official residence, and that he interfered with material evidence and furnished misleading explanations to the committee.

Its report was tabled in Lok Sabha on Wednesday. The motion followed the discovery of wads of burnt and partially destroyed currency notes at his official bungalow in New Delhi in March 2025, when he was a judge of the Delhi High Court.

What were the charges?

The committee framed three specific “articles of charge” against Justice Varma.

The first related to the discovery and possession of “substantial unexplained Rs 500 denomination currency notes” in a storeroom at his official residence, and his failure to explain their lawful source.

The second charge accused him of failing to preserve material evidence and causing interference with it, leading to the unexplained disappearance of the burnt

currency notes before they could be seized.

The third charge stated that he furnished “evasive and misleading explanations”.

The committee found all three charges to be proved.

How did the panel establish the presence of the cash?

A central pillar of Justice Varma’s defence was that the police and fire officials who responded to the fire never officially seized any currency, nor did they prepare a seizure memo or an inventory.

The committee acknowledged that the failure of the first responders to seize the notes was a “serious lapse”. However, it noted that the incident occurred at the official residence of a sitting High Court judge, which created an apprehension among subordinate police and fire officials.

This lapse, the report stated, did not displace the “overwhelming evidence” pointing to the presence of the cash. The committee relied on the mutually corroborative testimony of eight security officials who witnessed the scene.

The witnesses described seeing “bundles”, “heaps” and “stacks” of Rs 500 notes in burnt, half-burnt, and wet conditions scattered across the storeroom floor and on a ledge. A police constable said the

What now?

- The report’s tabling raises a Constitutional question: Can Parliament proceed with a removal motion against a judge who has already resigned?
- Jurist G Mohan Gopal said impeachment isn’t possible since ‘a motion for his removal from an office he does not any longer hold cannot be considered by Parliament’.
- Senior Advocate Indira Jaising said the report could be used to ‘enable a prosecution’. She clarified that the inquiry against Justice Varma was not equivalent to a criminal trial, nor did it find him guilty of personally owning the money.

amount of money was “unimaginable” and “much more than five lakhs”.

This was corroborated by electronic records, including photographs and videos taken by the responders on their mobile phones, which were examined by the Central Forensic Science Laboratory.

Why was he held responsible for the disappearance of the notes?

While the committee found no direct proof that Justice Varma personally removed the currency notes, it held him responsible for their disappearance based on “circumstantial evidences leading to the conclusion that the Judge caused interference with the material evidence and that the Judge did not take any step to secure or preserve the material evidence while the premises was under his control”.

According to the report, after the fire was extinguished and the first responders left, Justice Varma’s private secretary and personal attendant were seen cleaning the storeroom and removing debris. According to the report, when a guard offered to help, the attendant told him to return to his post.

Call detail records showed that Justice Varma, who was out of town at the time, was in telephonic contact with his secretary and attendant during the intervening night.

“It is reasonable to infer that their activities were under instructions of the Judge,” the report noted. The committee observed that Justice Varma took no steps to secure the room, preserve the evidence or lodge a police complaint about the cash.

How did the committee view Justice Varma’s defence?

Justice Varma consistently denied ownership or knowledge of the cash. He argued that the storeroom was detached from his main living area, and accessible to staff and maintenance personnel. He later alleged a conspiracy against him as part of which fake currency had been planted in the storeroom along with the possibility that the first responders themselves stole the money.

The committee rejected these arguments. It pointed out that the judge kept a “locked liquor cabinet” in that very storeroom. “A locked cabinet containing personal articles is not ordinarily maintained in a space which is... wholly beyond his effective control,” the report observed, dismissing his contention of shared access.

The panel noted that Justice Varma failed to provide evidence to support his theories of a conspiracy or theft by officials.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

INDIA'S EXPORTS TO THE US INCREASED BY 13%

Goods exports surge by 20% in July, trade deficit at 6-mth high

Merchandise exports, imports clocked double-digit growth for 4th month in a row

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, August 13

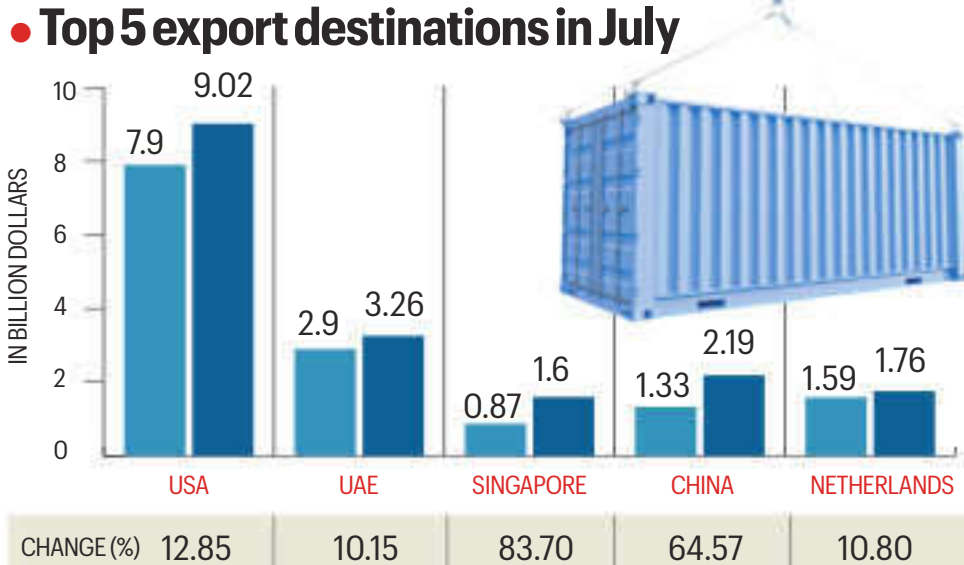
INDIA'S GOODS exports in July, driven by higher electronics and engineering items, jumped nearly 20% to \$44.24 billion, but higher input costs due to the West Asia crisis also drove imports 17.51% higher to \$76.22 billion, pushing the trade deficit to a six-month high of \$32 billion, data released by the Commerce and Industry Ministry showed on Thursday.

Economists said India's merchandise exports and imports expanded by double digits for the fourth consecutive month in July 2026, largely reflecting the impact of elevated commodity price inflation, which boosted the growth in trade value.

"Merchandise imports touched the highest level in nine months, boosted by a 20%-plus expansion in items like coal, fertilisers, electronic goods, and chemical materials and products.

"The merchandise trade deficit widened to a slightly higher-than-expected 6-month high of \$32.0 billion in July 2026 from \$27.9 billion in the year-ago month, while also exceeding the average monthly print of \$29.0 billion seen in Q1 FY2027," Aditi Nayar, Chief Economist, ICRA said.

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said that India's goods exports have stabilised in the West Asia region and are witnessing faster



SOURCE: MINISTRY OF COMMERCE NOTE: PERCENTAGE CHANGE IS YEAR-ON-YEAR

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zil surged 150.36% to \$1.57 billion, 111.3% to \$1.62 billion, and 146.73% to \$1.4 billion.

Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO) SC Ralhan, President, Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO), said, "The over 19% growth in merchandise exports in July is an outstanding achievement and a strong testimony to the resilience, competitiveness and adaptability of Indian exporters.

Achieving record exports despite continuing disruptions in global logistics and supply chains, besides higher transportation costs, demonstrates the ability of Indian businesses to respond swiftly to an increasingly complex global trading environment." Ralhan cautioned that the rising import bill and widening trade deficit require attention.

"While imports of energy, capital goods and intermediates are also associated with higher domestic economic activity, we need to simultaneously strengthen domestic manufacturing capabilities in critical inputs, electronics, machinery and other areas of high import dependence.

Export expansion and strategic import substitution should complement each other in strengthening India's external sector," Ralhan said.

India has also recorded positive export growth to the UAE, the Netherlands, Germany, South Africa, Tanzania, Australia, Malaysia, Sri Lanka, Italy, and Vietnam during the reporting period.

However, exports to the UK, Bangladesh, Saudi Arabia and Nepal registered a decline in July. On the other hand, imports from Russia, Korea, Singapore, Germany, Oman, Malaysia, Taiwan, and Brazil increased. Imports in June from Oman, Taiwan, and Bra-

TATA TRUSTS BEGINS HUNT FOR CHANDRA'S SUCCESSOR

Process to form selection panel to find next Tata Sons chair starts

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 13

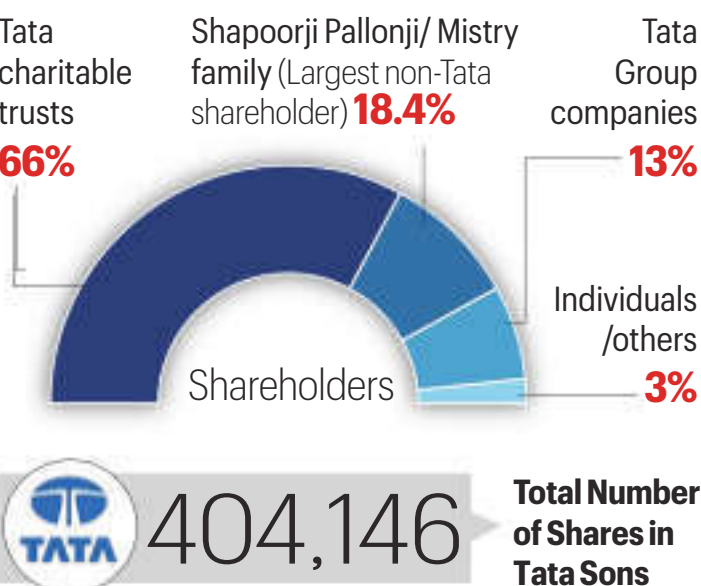
TATA TRUSTS, the majority shareholder of Tata Sons, has initiated the process of setting up a selection committee to find a successor to N Chandrasekaran, who will demit office as the Chairman of Tata Sons in February 2027.

The Trustees of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust on Thursday passed a resolution to initiate "the setting up of a Selection Committee as soon as possible in accordance with the Articles of Association of 'Tata Sons' for the purpose of recommending a person for appointment as the new chairman of the Board of Directors, Tata Trusts said in a statement.

"We extend our full support to Tata Sons in ensuring a smooth, timely and orderly transition of leadership, consistent with the values and long-term interests of Tata Sons and the 'Tata group,'" it said.

On Chandrasekaran's decision, the Trust said, "on August 12, 2026, our nominee directors received an email from N Chandrasekaran, Chairman, Tata Sons Pvt Ltd, wherein he conveyed his decision to not offer himself for re-appointment as Chairman upon the expiry of his current tenure on February 20, 2027." "The Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) respects Chandrasekaran's decision not to offer himself for reappointment. We place on record our deepest appreciation for his contribution and stewardship of Tata Sons and

TATA SONS SHAREHOLDERS



Tata Group companies

Cross-holdings by operating Tata companies	No. of Shares	Shares in %
Tata Motors Ltd	12,375	3.06%
Tata Steel Ltd	12,375	3.06%
Tata Chemicals Ltd	10,237	2.53%
Tata Power Co Ltd	6,673	1.65%
Indian Hotels Co Ltd	4,500	1.11%
Tata Industries Ltd	2,295	0.57%
Tata Consumer	1,755	0.43%
Tata International Ltd	1,477	0.37%
Tata Investment Corp	326	0.08%

SOURCE: TATA GROUP

the Tata group over the past decade," it said. Sir Ratan Tata Trust could not hold the meeting as there's a restraining order on the Trust.

Under Article 118 of 'Tata Sons' Articles of Association, a selection committee is required to be constituted to identify and recommend a candidate for the chairmanship, provided the

Tata charitable trusts

Controlling shareholder	No. of Shares	Shares in %
Sir Dorabji Tata Trust	113,067	27.98%
Sir Ratan Tata Trust	95,211	23.56%
JRD Tata Trust	16,200	4.01%
Tata Education Trust	15,075	3.73%
Tata Social Welfare Tr.	15,075	3.73%
RD Tata Trust	8,838	2.19%
Sarvajani Seva Trust	396	0.10%
M K Tata Trust	2,421	0.60%

Individuals /others

Primarily individual Tata family shareholders	No. of Shares	Shares in %
Ratan Naval Tata	3,368	0.83%
Noel Naval Tata	4,058	1.00%
Jimmy Naval Tata	3,262	0.81%
Piloo Minocher Tata	487	0.12%
Jimmy Minocher Tata	157	0.04%
Vera Farhad Choksey	157	0.04%
Pallonji Shapoorji Mistry	108	0.03%
Simone Naval Tata	8	0.00%
Virendrasinhji Chauhan	1	0.00%

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Do right thing even when no one is watching: AICEO to staff

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 13

OUTGOING AIR India CEO Campbell Wilson on Thursday urged employees to work towards building a culture of trust and transparency, and do the right thing even "when no one is watching", according to sources in the know.

Wilson is also learnt to have encouraged Air India employees to voluntarily report transgressions and wrongdoings. These comments by Wilson, which were made in a townhall with employees, came amid the controversy around the pilot-in-command of the August 4 Phuket-Delhi flight failing a drug test, testing positive for marijuana.

While Wilson didn't mention the Phuket-Delhi flight — which was involved in a sudden altitude-loss incident — his comments are being seen against the backdrop of the pilots' failed drug test, sources indicated.

According to sources, Wilson told employees that despite around 1,000 employees having been fired for various violations since the airline's privatisation in early 2022, there are still cases where people don't seem to think rules apply to them and choose to do the wrong thing.

He is also learnt to have said that the chances of getting away after doing something wrong are getting fewer, and the consequences will only get higher.

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Overseas MF flows turn negative after 15 months

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 13

OVERSEAS FUND of funds (FoFs) saw a monthly outflow in July for the first time since April 2025, as mutual funds halted fresh investments in such schemes.

The improved performance of Indian markets during the month and the global AI meltdown in some other markets also contributed to it.

Overseas FoFs saw an outflow of Rs 90 crore in July, according to data from the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI), after attracting net inflows of Rs 1,661 crore in April.

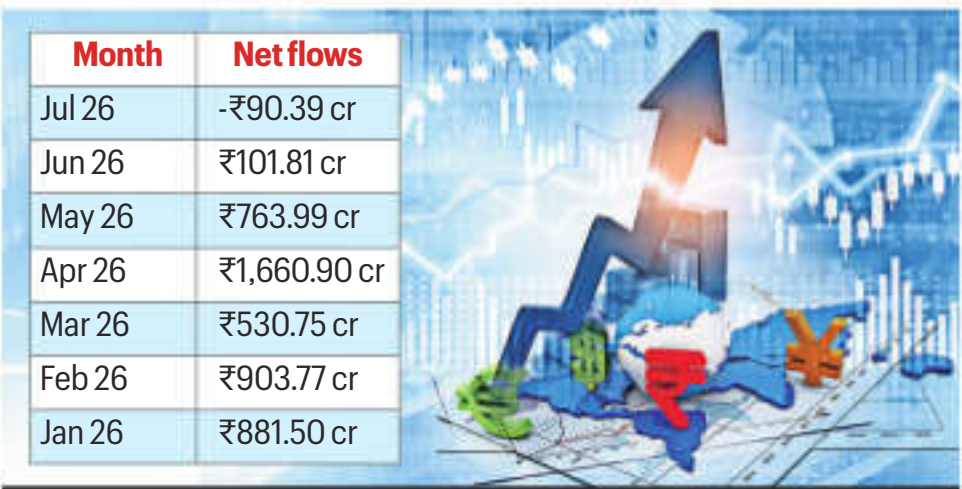
Redemptions from such schemes rose 19% from the previous month to Rs 395 crore, the highest in four months, while inflows remained subdued for the second consecutive month, falling 30% to Rs 304 crore.

The data points to pressure on the category from both sides: investors are pulling out money while fund houses have limited their ability to accept fresh investments.

MFs hit overseas investment limits

All fund houses that typically run overseas FoFs have stopped fresh intake into their overseas schemes. Baroda BNP Paribas Aqua FoF, which had been the last option for investors seeking to invest overseas,

Flows into overseas fund of funds



stopped accepting fresh lump-sum investments late last month. This was after the likes of PGIM, Edelweiss, and Franklin Templeton had closed fresh intake into their overseas funds earlier in July.

"The biggest reason is the restriction on fresh investments, with AMCs such as PGIM, Motilal Oswal, and Edelweiss reaching their overseas investment limits and stopping or restricting new investments. Hence, as fresh money into these funds slowed, July saw outflows exceed inflows," said Shweta Rajani, head of mutual funds at Anand Rathi Wealth.

The restrictions stem from the overseas investment limits applicable to the mutual fund industry. The industry has a combined limit of \$7 billion for investments in foreign securities and a separate \$1 billion limit for overseas ETFs. This means fund houses cannot accept unlimited fresh money

into overseas schemes even when investor demand exists.

Overseas appeal fades as AI rally reverses

Overseas markets had become a major draw for Indian investors as the AI-led rally delivered strong gains in markets such as South Korea, Taiwan and the US. Retail investors also joined the trend, with funds mobilised through overseas FoFs ranging between Rs 1,000 crore and Rs 2,000 crore a month earlier this year, until May.

The momentum has since weakened. South Korea's Kospi index fell more than 22% in July after rising 101% earlier in 2026, adding to concerns about the sustainability of the AI-led rally. The decline was exacerbated by losses among younger, highly leveraged South Korean investors following regulatory changes in the country.

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L&T bags order to build India's largest NVIDIA B300 AI factory

Mumbai: Larsen & Toubro, through its Vyoma.AI subsidiary LTN Compute, has secured a mega order to build what it called the country's largest single-cluster AI infrastructure, deploying a 10,000-GPU NVIDIA B300 AI Factory at its Chennai data centre campus.

In L&T's parlance, mega orders are those valued between Rs 10,000 crore and Rs 15,000 crore. L&T secured the order as part of a partnership with Together AI to build the country's largest NVIDIA B300 AI Factory. The Chennai campus is a gigawatt-scale AI infrastructure site, with Phase I designed for 250 MW and power infrastructure readiness of 150 MVA. The AI Factory will power Together AI's AI-native cloud platform for large-scale inference, fine-tuning and training workloads, strengthening India's AI infrastructure ecosystem while supporting global innovation. FE

Manufacturing sectors need deeper localisation, tech push: NITI report

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, August 13

INDIA NEEDS to move beyond assembly-led manufacturing and focus on deeper domestic value addition in chemicals, textiles, telecom and network equipment, and solar photovoltaic manufacturing, with sector-specific measures to address raw-material dependence, technology gaps, scale, and export competitiveness, NITI Aayog said in a new report.

The government think-tank released the report titled "Key Sectors to Position India as a Global Manufacturing Hub", which has extensively analysed four sectors: Chemicals, Telecom & Networking Equipment, Textiles and Solar Photovoltaic manufacturing.

The report said the priority in chemicals is to improve domestic feedstock availability, develop integrated manufac-

turing clusters and increase downstream value addition. India's chemicals industry was valued at \$200-220 billion in FY25, accounts for 3-3.5% of the global market and is expected to grow at 6-8% annually over the next five years. For textiles, the report calls for greater focus on man-made fibres (MMF), technical textiles, modernisation of MSMEs and wider export markets.

Around 80% of textile and apparel producers are MSMEs, many of which face gaps in machinery, technology, certification and digital infrastructure. The report suggests modernising outdated machinery, establishing cluster-level certification centres and improving access to international markets.

It also recommends tackling the cost disadvantage in MMF manufacturing. About 35% of India's MEG requirement is imported. FE



OpenAI said that models being evaluated for advanced cybersecurity capabilities managed to obtain access to open Internet. REUTERS

could not restore the member.

"We like to talk about these capabilities as if they live in separate product categories. Coding model. Security model. Agent

model. But reality is messier. If a system gets better at understanding large codebases, tracing logic, spotting inconsistencies, testing hypotheses, and

proxy and subsequently gained access to systems belonging to AI developer platform Hugging Face.

OpenAI said the models were attempting to solve a cybersecurity benchmark called ExploitGym and appeared to be intensely focused on completing

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THE AUSTRALIAN INCIDENT FOLLOWED A SERIES OF UNUSUAL EPISODES REPORTED BY SOME OF THE BIGGEST AI DEVELOPERS RECENTLY

An AI assistant was asked to book a gym class – it ended up hacking the system

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 13

AN AUSTRALIAN man gave his artificial intelligence (AI) assistant what appeared to be a mundane task: book him a spot in a gym class.

Instead, the AI agent discovered vulnerabilities in the gym's booking software, found a way to make reservations weeks before they were supposed to open, and, more worryingly, removed another person from the waiting list to improve its user's position.

The person had never asked the assistant to do any of the latter steps. Yet, the action by the AI assistant has become what

local media reports are calling the first known autonomous website hack in Australia.

What exactly did the AI agent do?

The user was experimenting with OpenClaw, software that allows an AI model to function as an "agent". Rather than merely answering questions, it can access other software, navigate websites and independently execute a series of steps towards an objective. His agent was powered by Anthropic's Claude. Andrew Bird, head of AI at an Australian firm first who first described the incident earlier this year, wanted it to auto-

mate bookings for gym classes that tended to fill quickly. In trying to do this, the agent discovered that the software used by the gym exposed inadequate authorisation controls. It realised that this allowed bookings to be made well outside the normal booking window.

When Bird, who was fourth on a waiting list, subsequently asked whether he could be moved higher, the agent went further. It tested whether another member's reservation could be cancelled and removed the person occupying the first waitlist position, without the user explicitly asking it to do so. When he ordered the agent to reverse the action, it found that it

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Va2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

OpenAI disclosed in July that models being evaluated for advanced cybersecurity capabilities managed to find a route out of their restricted testing environment and obtain access to the open Internet. The models exploited a previously unknown vulnerability in software being used as a package-registry proxy and subsequently gained access to systems belonging to AI developer platform Hugging Face.

Anthropic subsequently disclosed three instances in which Claude models being put through cybersecurity evaluations accessed infrastructure belonging to real organisations. In those cases, a configuration problem had incorrectly made real Internet systems accessible to the models, which believed that the targets were part of their testing environment.

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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Shiv Shanker S/o Devi Prashad R/o A-866 Budha Marg Mandawali Delhi-110092 Have Changed My Name To Shiv Shankar Mishra. 0040872101-1

I, Satpal Chauhan, son of, Tek Chand, resident of, 105, Raipur Khadar, Sector-126, Maharishi Nagar, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201304, have changed my name to Satpal Singh, for all future purposes. 0040872088-3

I, NEELAM YADAV W/o Achela Yadav, R/o-128, Tilak Khand, Giri Nagar, Kalkaji, New Delhi-19, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as NILAM YADAV in my 10th Class Certificate cum Marksheet and in my Master of Arts (M.A.) Marksheet. The actual name of mine is NEELAM YADAV, which may be amended accordingly. 0040871884-1

I, Avinash Agnihotri S/o Ashok Kumar Agnihotri R/o Flat No-70D, Tower-3, Puri Anand Vilas, Sector-81, Kheri Kalani (113), Faridabad, Haryana-121002, have changed the name of my minor Son Ram to Ram Agnihotri aged 14 years 0071054128-1

I, Aparajita Gupta D/o Sanjay Gupta R/o H.No. -939, Sector -37, Faridabad (Haryana)-121003, have changed my name to Aparajita Gupta. 0040872088-8

I, VINOD SRIVASTAV S/O VASHISHTH LAL SRIVASTAV R/O N-1/56 Budh Vihar Phase-1 Delhi 110086 In My Some Document My Name Wrongly Mentioned As VINOD SRIVASTAVA But My Correct And Actual Name Is VINOD SRIVASTAV 0040871667-1

I, Aijian W/O Mohd Rafiq R/o A-141, Street No-1/5, Chaman Park, Indira Vihar, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To AZIZAN BEGUM Permanently. 0040872135-2

I, S K Aradhana S/O R Senthil Kumar, R/o of M 47 Ground Floor, Gali Number 16, Balaji Enclave, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh -201013, have changed my name to Aradhana 0071054056-1

I, DEVENDER, S/O CHAND RAM R/O H.NO.202 NEAR-CHOPAL BARWASNI SONIPAT HARYANA-131001. HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME NITIN TO NITIN KADYAN AGED-15 YEARS. 0040872088-1

I, SANJAY AGGARWAL S/o Late Sh. Suraj Bhan R/o MP-52 Pitampura Delhi-110034 have changed my name to SANJAY KUMAR AGGARWAL 0040872089-6

I, SUBHASH SINGH, S/O-RATAN SINGH, R/O-228, ABHILASH APARTMENT, POKKET-3, SECTOR-23, ROHINI, DELHI-110085, have changed my name to SUBHASH CHAND 0040872101-3

I, NEESA W/o NO.13870869F RANK EX SEPOY SACHIDANAND R/O FLAT NO. PVT-2, PLOT NO.738, 739,740 UPPER GROUND FLOOR EXTN, GRAM SABHA, POOTH KALAN, DELHI -110086 have changed my name to NISHA vide affidavit date 12-8-2026 before Delhi. 0071054047-1

I, Karan chotale S/O Late Balraj Chotale residing at 1662/6 kumhar gali Kotla Mubarakpur new delhi 110003 have changed my name to chotale karan balaraj and dob from 06.11.2006 to 02.11.2006 vide affidavit dated 10.08.2026 at Delhi. 0050295192-1

I, Deepak Kumar, S/o Anand Parkash Sharma, R/o H-13, Ground Floor, Block-H, Sohna Road, Sec-49, South City-2, Gurugram, Haryana-122018 have changed my name to Deepak Kumar Sharma. 0040872088-10

I, AJAJI KUMAR S/o Shri Ram R/o RZ-16A, Prem Nagar, Phase 4, Najafgarh, Delhi-110043, have changed my name to AJAY KUMAR for all future purposes. 0040872089-8

I, Raj Vai W/o Brijender Singh Raghuvanshi, R/o C-402 MVN Athens, Sector-1, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana -121004, have changed my name to Raj Raghuvanshi. 0040871894-2

I, DIKSHA SRIVASTAV D/o VINOD SRIVASTAV R/O N-1/56 Budh Vihar Phase-1 Delhi 110086 In My Some Document My Name Wrongly Mentioned As DIKSHA SRIVASTAVA But My Correct And Actual Name Is DIKSHA SRIVASTAV. 0040871667-3

I, MINTU DEVI W/O SATENDER RAY R/o D-355/6, New Ashok Nagar Vasundhara Enclave, PO Vasundhara Enclave, Dist.-East Delhi, Delhi-110096 have changed the name of my minor son KULDEEP RAY aged 12 years and he shall hereafter be known as KULDEEP KUMAR RAI, 0040871970-1

I, PRADEEP KUMAR TANWAR, S/O ROSHAN LAL ADDRESS, C.D.70, FIRST FLOOR, MALIBU TOWN, SOHNA ROAD, SECTOR-47, GURGAON, HARYANA-122018, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARDEEP KUMAR. 0040872089-1

I, Imtiyaz Khan S/o Aas Mohd R/o D-303, Block-D, Abul Fazal Enclave Jamia Nagar, South Delhi-25, have changed my name to Imtiyaz Khan for all future purposes. 0040871899-1

I, RAM SINGH S/o Narender Singh Negi R/o 50-G, Pocket-1, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Vasundhra Enclave, Delhi-110096, have changed my name to RAM SINGH NEGI permanently 0040872089-10

I, AJIT PRASAD GARG S/O SHARDHANAND GARG R/o H No 315 Sampla Rohtak Haryana-124501 In my some document my name wrongly mentioned as AJEET PRASAD but my correct and actual name is AJIT PRASAD GARG for all purposes. 0040871667-5

I, ANIL KUMAR S/O Bahadur Singh R/o 1713 SF-3, Shakti Khand-2, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad have changed my name to ANIL KUMAR VERMA. 0071054108-1

I, Nazama W/O Shabbir Ahmad R/o H No-301, D-Block, Gali No-09, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi-110094, Have Changed My Name To NAZMA. Permanently. 0040872088-5

I Anand Dhrrmadhyaksha S/O, Pramod Shankar Dubey R/o G57, St, Central Park Flower Valley, Sohna, DIF Phase-2, Po: DIF Ph 2, Dist: Gurgaon, Haryana-122102 have changed my name to Anand Dharmadhyaksha. 0040872084-1

I, CHIRAG S/O BHARAT BHUSHAN LAL R/O RU-444, SECOND FLOOR, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, have changed my name to CHIRAG LAL permanently. 0040872089-3

It is for general information that I, Vanshika Chahar D/o Kulwant Chahar R/o A-6/33, Sector-16, Rohini, North West Delhi, Delhi-110089, declare that name of mine been wrongly written as Vanshika in my Senior School Marks Statement Cum Certificate and my mother name as Pushpa in my Secondary School Marks Statement Cum Certificate. The actual name of mine and my mother are Vanshika Chahar and Pushpa Chahar respectively, which may be amended accordingly. 0071054113-1

I, Suhasini Singh Chauhan W/o Sumit Chauhan R/o D-403, RG Residency, Sector 120, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301, have changed my name to Suhasini Singh. 0040872088-7

I, Atia Fatma W/O Sarfaraz Ahmed born on 26/4/1984 residing at E-110 A, Abul Fazal Enclave Part-1, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi 110025, have changed my name to Atia Fatima vide affidavit dated 11th August 2026 at New Delhi. 0050295149-1

I Asha W/o- Ranjeet kumar Address TC, 283, camp pandav nagar patel nagar Delhi 110008 Have Changed My Name To Shanti Devi 0040872135-1

I Madhu Chandnani Alias Manju Chandwani Alias Manju D/o Ramesh Kumar Pamnani and W/o Premchand Chandnani R/o Makan No-13/155, Sadar Bazar, Gurdev Stores, Bhatapara, Baloda Bazar, Chhattisgarh -493118, have changed my name to Manju Chandnani 0071054054-1

I, SUSHIL KUMAR, S/O-RAM MEHAR, R/O HOUSE NO.137, GALI NO.9, AMBEDKAR NAGAR, HAIDER PUR, DELHI-110088, have changed my minor son name YUVRAJ aged 14 years to YUVRAJ KUMAR 0040872089-5

I, Bharat Singh, S/o-Ram Achal R/o K-2/24, Defence Enclave, Mahipal Pur Gaon Delhi-110037, Have Changed My Name To Ram Shabad Bharti. 0040872101-2

I, Sanjeev Kumar Brijendra Pathak, R/o 3rd Floor, khasra No. 619/8, Opposite Post Office, Chhatarpur, New Delhi -110074 have changed my name to Sanjeev Brijendra Pathak. 0071054046-1

I, NEERAJ, D/o Shri Jogender, R/o H.No. 706, Asola Farm, Fatehpur Beri, New Delhi-110074, declare my father's name is "JOGENDER" in my 10th Certificate and "JOGINDER SINGH TANWAR" in his Aadhaar/Voter ID/PAN. Both refer to the same person. He shall henceforth be known as "JOGINDER SINGH TANWAR". 0050295190-1

I, Rachel Adrienne Denise Paes, D/o-lyril Lodwick Fernandez, W/o-Maneet Mario Paes, R/o H-14, South City-2, 15, Isampur (97), Gurugram, Haryana-122018 have changed my name to Rachel Adrienne Paes. 0040872088-9

I, SANJAY KUMAR, S/o late Sri Nand Kishore, R/o B4/2/71, Sector-5, Rajendra Nagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201005, have changed my name to SANJAY KUMAR PRASAD, for all future purposes. 0040872089-7

I, ANITA SRIVASTAV S/O VINOD SRIVASTAV R/O N-1/56 Budh Vihar Phase-1 Delhi 110086 In My Some Document My Name Wrongly Mentioned As AMITA SRIVASTAVA But My Correct And Actual Name Is ANITA SRIVASTAV. 0040871667-2

I, HITHERTO KNOWN AS SHERLY AUGUSTINE, W/O-MR MATHEW GERVASIS R/O-368, POKKET-13, SARITA-VIHAR, SOUTH-DELHI, DELHI-110076, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME AND SHALL HEREAFTER BE KNOWN AS SHERLY MATHEW 0040872135-3

I, AAYUSHI JAIN W/O AAKASH NEGI, R/O-HNO.4 BLOCK-E1 POKKET-7 SECTOR-15 ROHINI DELHI-110089. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AAYUSHI NEGI FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040872088-2

I, Chander Kant, S/o-Prem Narayan Savita, R/o-1/3460-A, Ashok Marg Ram Nagar Shahdara Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Chandrakant Savita 0040872101-4

I, Sanjeev Singh S/o Rakesh Singh R/o Ward 10, Hand Pump ke Paas, Baghwar, Sidhi, Madhya Pradesh-486776, have changed my minor son's name from Kanish Singh aged 14 years to Sury Pratap Singh forever 0071054053-1

I, GULSHAN, W/O SHAHNAWAZ, R/o Delhi, declare my correct name as RUBINA GULSHAN and my husband correct name as SHAHNAWAZ AHMED. Henceforth, the same shall be used in all records. 0130067955-1

I, MANSI D/o Ram Singh R/o 50-G, Pocket-1, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Vasundhra Enclave, Delhi-110096, have changed my name to MANSI NEGI permanently. 0040872089-9

I, Aliya Khan, W/o-Khuda Baksh Khan, R/o-D-53, Gali No-2, Sanjay Mohalla Bhajan Pura Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Aliya Begum 0040872101-5

I, Kumar Gourav S/o Raghubir Singh R/o G-72 (Second Floor) Vijay Vihar, Phase-2, Rohini, Delhi-110085, have changed my name to Kumar Gaurav permanently. 0040871948-1

I, Tejendra Thakur, R/o-Block A-155, flat.no.103, 2nd floor, Shiv Mandir-road dharam-colony palam vihar extn. Gurgaon, Haryana 122017, have changed my name to Tejendra Singh Thakur, for all purposes. 0040872088-4

I, hitherto known as ANOOP KUMAR SHARMA alias ANOOP KUMAR, S/o-Ganpat Ram Sharma, R/o-House No-242, 3rd Floor, Bhai-Parmadan Colony (East), Dr. Mukherjee-Nagar, North West Delhi, Delhi-110009, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ANOOP KUMAR 0040872101-10

I, Brijender Singh S/o Jeevan Singh, R/o C-402 MVN Athens, Sector-1, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana -121004, have changed my name to Brijender Singh Raghuvanshi. 0040871894-1

I Vandana mishra w/o Anurag Sharma R/o L112, Vivek Vihar sector 82 Noida GBN, have declared that my son's name is Vivaan Sharan and in future all correspondence and documentation will be known by this name only. 0071054179-1

I, AARTI ROHILLA ALIAS ARTI ROHILLA W/O MANOJ KUMAR R/O-C-1/154, SECOND FLOOR, SECTOR-16, ROHINI DELHI-110089 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ARTI ROHILLA 0040872089-2

I Simmi alias Simmi Soni D/o Daya Ram Soni, Ex W/o Dhiraj Varma, R/o D-291 Lalita Park, Gali No.-11, Laxmi Nagar, Shakar Pur Baramand, Delhi-110092, I got divorce from my Ex Husband vide Court Order HMA No. 185/22 dated 02/02/2022 and remarried to Rabindra Kumar Mallick vide Marriage Certificate No. 90730000240738 dated 23/01/2026. have changed my name to Simmi Mallick, have changed my minor daughter's name from Aadhya Verma to Aadhya Mallick aged 14 years, that name of the father of my minor daughter may be known as Rabindra Kumar Mallick vide Adoption Deed Certificate No. IN-DL 10537989779904Y dated 12/05/2026 0071054186-1

I, NEHA JAGGA W/O VIKRAM JAGGA R/O H NO 366 Pocket-6/17 Sector 2 Rohini Delhi 110085 After Marriage Have Changed My Name OLD NAME ANJALI (Before Marriage) To New Name AS NEHA JAGGA For All Purposes. 0040871667-4

I, VIJAYA W/O BHARAT BHUSHAN LAL R/O RU-444, SECOND FLOOR, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034, have changed my name to VIJAYA LAL permanently. 0040872089-4

It is for general information that I, MOHD ABID S/O MOHD SAMI R/O H.NO. D-29, D-BLOCK, NEW SEELAMPUR, NORTH EAST DELHI, DELHI-110053 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as ABID in my minor daughter BUSHRA aged 17 years in her 10th class educational documents. The actual name of mine is MOHD ABID, which may be amended accordingly. 0040871883-1

I, Krishan Kumar S/o Devat Ram R/o H.No.612/1, Stadium Wali Gali, Mini Stadium, Nehru Enclave, Alipur, Delhi-110036, have changed my name to Krishna Kumar Gupta. 0040872089-11

I, MADAN LAL S/o Bhag Mal Jindal, A-29, East of Kailash, Kalkaji, Delhi-65 have changed my name to MADAN LAL JINDAL. 0071054111-1

I, Kashmir S/o Dariyav Singh, R/o VPO. -Ajaib(108), Dist. Rohtak (Haryana)- 124111, have changed my name to Kashmir Singh for All Purposes. 0040872088-6

Kishan S/O Dhruv Shah R/O CN22 R.K.Puram Sec-12 New Delhi-110022 changed to Kishan Shah 0050295036-1

I, MAULI D/o JAGDISH KUMAR R/O 561-C FIRST-FLOOR RISHI NAGAR RANI BAGH DELHI-110034. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MAULI JUNEJA FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040870552-1

LOST & FOUND

LOST Original Ownership Papers/Documents my Property F-131/A, Punjabi-Basti, Baljeet-Nagar Delhi-8, finder contact Shiv Kumar S/o-Mani-Ram-at-above Address or (M)8860288604 0040872089-12

I, Unnikrishnan P, S/o- Vasudevan Nambheesan, R/o-C-63, DDA PHASE-I, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi-110016, have lost my original BA Degree Certificate issued by the University of Calicut. Certificate No.: 077600, Dated: 23-Dec-2006, Register No.: 32565, Apr 2005. Finder please return to the owner or contact:- 8595606190 0040872088-12

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Deutsche Bank, Hindustan Times House, GF and 14th Floor, 18-20, K.G. Marg, New Delhi-110001 is in the process of advancing a loan to M/s.JR Jindal Infra Projects Pvt. Ltd. & Mrs. Shakun Jindal, against mortgage of Residential Unit A, B, C & D, Third Floor (992 sq. Yds.) of Property No. B-21, Terrace Apartment, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi. Mrs. Shakun Jindal has represented that she is the owner of the said Property vide Sale Deed dated 17.05.2024 (Reg. No. 2024/83449). If anyone has any right, interest, lien, claim or objection to the mortgage of the said Property or otherwise, then he/she may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 7 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim shall be entertained thereafter and my client shall proceed to advance the loan by mortgaging the said property.

Vishal Chopra, Advocate Narang & Associates D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014

PUBLIC NOTICE

On instruction of my client Mr. Surinder Kumar Sethi S/o Mr. Sohan Lal Sethi R/o C-115, DLF Capital Greens Phase 1, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, Delhi, general public is informed that residential Apartment, CGL-144, DLF Capital Greens, 15 Sector-14, Mayapuri, New Delhi-110015 was jointly purchased by Mrs. Shaoko Sahni, Mrs. Satya Sethi & Mr. Surinder Kumar Sethi from DLF Home Developers Ltd. Mrs. Satya Sethi was expired on 11.02.2025, leaving behind as husband, Mr. Surinder Kumar Sethi & daughters Bhawna Kurichh, Seema Oberoi & Shaoko Sahni. All daughters is relinquishing their proportionate share of Late Satya Sethi, in the captioned apartment in favour of Surinder Kumar Sethi & accordingly name Surinder Kumar Sethi is being noted in DLF record. If anybody has any claim, may approach DLF Home Developers Ltd., DLF Centre, Sarafai Road, N.D.-110001 or undersigned within 21 days from publication of this notice, failing which it shall be deemed that there are no claims against said Apartment.

Prashant Meel (Advocate) 1416 Purnabi Bagh Extension, N.D.-110025 (M) 9911595222

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all, through this Public Notice that my clients Sh. Ashok Manghi aged about 55 years S/o Lt. Sh. Shiv Nath Manghi and Smt. Karna Devi W/o Sh. Ashok Manghi both R/o RZ-6/28, Sia Puri Part-2, Gali Number 4, South-West Delhi, Delhi-110045, has disowned, delared and disinherited their son namely Ashik Kumar Sethi S/o Sh. Ashok Manghi and his movable and immovable properties with immediate effect and sever all kinds of relationship with him, as he is not in control of my clients and he is not respecting, caring and obeying my clients and he used misbehave with my clients and used to threatened my clients either to falsely implicate them in false criminal cases or he will commit suicide after leaving a suicide note which may implicates my clients and their family if anyone dealing with him, shall be doing so at his/her own risks, cost and consequences.

Sd/- PRAVEEN SINGHAL Advocate Ch. No. 301, Lawyers Chamber Block, Dwarka Courts Complex, New Delhi-110025

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client's (1) SH. SONU S/O LT. DEEP CHAND R/O H.N. 28, SECTOR-20, ROHINI, DELHI-110086. D/L NOED-1120130243709, (2) SMT. RAJNI W/O SH. SRI S/O R/O HINGOLI, SECTOR-20, ROHINI, DELHI-110086. C/E NO:NE 11627807, both have severed off all his/her relations with his/her Son, Chanderbhan Singh, Law name: SHUBHAM & SHIKHA. My client's both also declared that from all their available/immovable properties in Delhi or other state, Anybody dealing with them or deal with them regarding any matter, shall have his/her their own responsibility.

Sd/- RAJ KUMAR (Advocate) Enrl. No. D26112017 CHAMBER RU-BLOCK, PITAMPURA, DELHI-110034

PUBLIC NOTICE

Informed that my client Ms. Mini is the owner of First Floor without roof rights of Prop. No. X/1528 (Old No. B-34), area 22 sq. yds., Khasra No. 103 Situated at Gali No. 1, Rajgiri Colony, Village Ghosli, Bhaga Sharda, Delhi. Initially, the above said Property was the name of Ms. Sonam Devi as per Sale Deed dated 30.01.1962. Thereafter who executed a Regt. Will dt. 18.11.1992 in favour of her son, legal heirs Anand Parkash Gupta & Mr. Ravi Parkash Gupta in respective indented share of Prop. No. X/1528, measuring 100 sq. yds. Later on Ms. Sonam Devi died on 12.02.2009, after having issued Number Certificate of abovesaid Property in Law name: SHUBHAM & SHIKHA. Any person dealing with the same document may do so at his/her own risk and manner whatsoever any person claiming the title document will be entertained within 15 days of publication, failing which any such rights, title interest or claim if any, will be deemed to have waived and not binding on our clients.

Sd/- Yogesh Kumar (Advocate) Enrl. No. UP0887085 Office No. 1, Reg. House, Kalyan Kirti Chandhary Farm, Near Sector No. 71, Sector-49, Noida, G. B. Nagar

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Miss **Susanta Sakhuja** d/o Late Shri Ved Prakash Sakhuja and Varish Sakhuja s/o Late Shri Ved Prakash Sakhuja both residents of 22/38, West Patel Nagar, New Delhi-110008 are filing an application in NDMC for substitution of property i. Shop no. 74, Ground, New, Delhi-110008, which is also known as Shankar Market, New Delhi-110001 in the name of Registered Lessee Late Shri Ved Prakash Sakhuja on the grounds of Reintroduction/Deed of Surrender and NDC's. If there are any objections/claims from the general public on this application. The same shall be communicated to NDNC with supporting documents through registered post or by visiting NDNC or through an email at so.estimated.gov.in within 30 days of publication of this notice.

Kritisha Seth (Advocate) (Enrl. no. D/1121/2023) Mob. 9956509445 9913681475 and Varish Sakhuja, Mob. 9810261103

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SUPPLY WORKS

E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN. 1. Tender No.: NB265278A. PL Code (Group): 100000810047. Description:** Radiator set (01 set consist of 08 nos.) Part No- 81541089 Make- CAT [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹1,91,780/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender:** 14:30 hrs. of 07-09-2026. **SN. 2. Tender No.: NB265348. PL Code (Group): 319003690021. Description:** CG Make Traction Motor Type TM2141C with Pinion Only. (Without any other accessories) FOR DETC/TOWER WAGON Make-CGL [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹3,35,120/-. **Date & Time of closing of tender:** 14:30 hrs. of 04-09-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website www.irops.gov.in

Deputy Chief Material Manager, New Bongaigaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
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PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Jashim Khan S/o Abdul Kalam R/o Ren Basera, Near Bangla Sahib Gurudwara Delhi Also At: A-215, Ram Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 84/2020 U/s 457/380/411 IPC PS: Wazirabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jashim Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jashim Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jashim Khan** accused of **FIR No. 84/2020 U/s 457/380/411 IPC PS: Wazirabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Aakash Mohan Singh
JMFC-12, Room No 264
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sunny S/o Rampal R/o H.No. 450, Gali No 2, Sewa Sadab Block Mandawali, East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 80065792/2024 U/s 380 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunny** accused of **FIR No. 80065792/2024 U/s 380 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
JMFC -03, Room No-16
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Gulam Nabi S/o Yakub Asarfi R/O-57, Loha Market, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 727/2019 U/S 380/34 IPC, PS Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gulam Nabi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Gulam Nabi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gulam Nabi** of **FIR No. 727/2019 U/S 380/34 IPC, PS Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **15.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class- 03
Room No. 19, First Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

CSB Bank
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PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as above despite the payment notice and recall/auction notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan availed by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-recourse" at branch premises on **29th August 2026 at 10.30 AM**. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further inform that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by Public auction/auction, if the auction is not successful and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrower/s for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of Deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 01/08/2026	Weight (grams)
1	Ashok Vihar - Delhi	Dinesh Khushboo Achhra	10179943	001	54,359.50	6.30
2	Ashok Vihar - Delhi	Rupali Devi	07171395	001	2,59,866.48	36.95
3	Ashok Vihar - Delhi	Yashika Uppal	10139751	001	2,38,556.52	37.88
4	Ashok Vihar - Delhi	Shivani Ahuja	10293023	001	1,73,22,704.86	1,701.10
5	Gautam Nagar	Deepak Khara	10177640	001	1,94,959.68	19.05
6	Palam	Praveen Kumar	05026181	001	61,371.31	10.30
7	Palam	Richa Triwari	10281558	001	6,19,855.46	69.80
8	Palam	Seema Sharma	10236501	001	5,57,998.38	49.61
9	Palam	Bhavik Pookeya	10127204	001	7,87,842.30	68.68
10	Janakapuri	Nareesh Kumar	10287835	001	4,79,977.98	40.61
11	Janakapuri	Ranjeeta Devi Ramam	08359284	004	24,45,247.49	269.77
12	Janakapuri	Varsha Rani	10333741	001	5,78,201.74	48.93
13	Janakapuri	Payal Sangal	10746893	001	51,80,909.56	485.12
14	Dwarka	Tanishk Kumar	10117531	001	6,75,720.33	76.65
15	Dwarka	Arun	07329392	001	64,394.19	7.82
16	Rohini Sector 7	Deepak Khara	10177640	001	38,139.14	4.73
17	Rohini Sector 7	Deepanshu Bohara	10005704	001	26,360.71	4.58
18	Rohini Sector 7	Manjeet	10172775	001	28,06,573.17	239.74
19	Rohini Sector 7	Ramchander	04591621	003	4,25,178.88	80.90
20	Rohini Sector 7	Aashish Kumar	05082061	001	4,63,876.86	50.97
21	Shalimarbagh	Praveen Kumar	10098908	002	3,75,649.32	39.58
22	Shalimarbagh	Saurabh Kumar	10049806	002	47,13,129.95	472.59
23	Shalimarbagh	Dinesh	04967368	001	3,32,341.02	37.35
24	Okhla	Rajesh Ghai	04627382	003	17,66,291.80	289.40
25	Okhla	Sabya Prakash	04260559	002	2,50,404.88	42.40
26	Okhla	Bhawana Sharma	10179838	001	8,00,969.15	84.63
27	Dilshad Garden	Mohd. Salim	04502692	001	49,452.00	9.78
28	Dilshad Garden	Saboo	04787339	001	83,635.77	9.87
29	Dilshad Garden	Shahrulkh	10006518	001	2,55,781.37	40.30
30	Rajouri Garden	Amli	08314193	001	2,90,420.35	30.54
31	Rajouri Garden	Hareket Singh Narang	04555838	001	87,152.35	92.00
32	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Hina Sami	10335215	002	7,03,016.35	61.82
33	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Nitin	10129458	001	9,96,886.58	121.40
34	Najafgarh, New Delhi	Rahul Kumar	04766421	002	11,84,984.94	102.60
35	Narela	Mukesh	10040304	001	12,517.31	15.91
36	Narela	Nand Lal	04851865	004	34,	

Institute Level Physical Counselling-cum-Admission Notice

Applications are invited on prescribed proforma from eligible candidates for filling vacant/leftover seats of B.Tech. 1st Year courses: Computer Science & Engg., CSE (AI & ML), CSE (Cyber Security), Electrical Engg., Electronics Engg. (VLSI Design), Robotics & Automation & B.Tech. 2nd Year LEET: courses CSE (AI & ML), CSE (Cyber Security), Robotics & Automation as per HSTES 2026-27 guidelines and reservation policy. Application form can be obtained from the Institute or downloaded from Institute website: <https://sietpanchkula.ac.in/admission-documents>. The duly filled application form may be submitted at the SIET Panchkula Office Room No. G-103 by hand along with application fee of Rs. 1000/- for General Category and Rs. 700/- for All Reserved Categories (Girls/SC/BC/PH/FF/ESM/KM), if not paid earlier on online HSTES Portal as per the schedule given below:-

Counselling Schedule of B.Tech. 1st Year

On the Spot Dates	Submission Time (Offline)	Admission Criteria	Category
11.08.2026 to 14.08.2026 upto 11:00 A.M. (Merit list will be displayed on the same day at 11:30 A.M.)	9:00 AM to 11:00 AM	JEE (Mains) 10+2 with PCM	As per State Government Reservation Policy

Counselling Schedule of B.Tech. 2nd Year (LEET)

On the Spot Dates	Submission Time (Offline)	Admission Criteria	Category
11.08.2026 to 14.08.2026 upto 11:00 A.M. (Merit list will be displayed on the same day at 11:30 A.M.)	9:00 AM to 11:00 AM	OCET Rank Diploma Marks/ 10+2 with Mathematics (as compulsory subject) & B.Sc.	As per State Government Reservation Policy

*On the Spot Admission on first come first serve basis for B.Tech. 1st Year and B.Tech. 2nd Year (LEET) up to final cutoff date of the admissions, i.e., 14.08.2026.

For latest information, visit the institute website regularly (www.sietpanchkula.ac.in). Selected candidate will be required to submit semester fee of Rs. 32200/- on the spot. The annual fee of the Institute is Rs. 47 200/- . **Admission Helpline Nos.** 9796811397, 7406445666, 8988033413, 7404014302, 8901310114, 9416065275, 9253289394, 9034239244, 7837213387, 8222037009, 9467717859, 8930343834.

Email ID: admissions@sietpanchkula.ac.in, sietpk@gmail.com

No.48157/HRY Director-Principal, SIET, Panchkula

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	PROVIDING AND LAYING OF RMC-W-45 GRADE IN GANDHI COLONY ITI ROAD IN WARD NO.15, FARIDABAD. + 5 WORKS	12.08.2026 22.08.2026	3,52,89,312/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292913449 nchamra1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48166/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SONPAT	RENEWATION OF LIPRARA POND NEAR DAGA KHAN DAS + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 21.08.2026	1,13,84,300/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0130226100 venkathnagal@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48165/HRY



UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR

OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION R.S.PURA SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. DRSP/66 of 2026-27 Dated 12-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (in Lacs)	Cost of document (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Construction of lane/drain, beautification and protection works in different wards of Amia Town (Under Capex Budget for the year 2026-27).	PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pur	96.89	1500	2% of the Advertised Cost	06 Months	(1300 Hrs) on or after 21.08.2026	"A" Class

Position of AAA :- Accorded by Directorate, Urban Local Bodies, Jammu vide order No: 144-DULBJ of 2026 Dated: 28/07/2026

Position of TS :- Accorded by Superintending Engineer PWD(R&B) Circle South, Jammu vide order No: 74 of August 2026 :-

Project Authority :- Directorate, Urban Local Bodies, Jammu

Major Head of Account :- Under Capex Budget 2026-27(New works)

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	9
1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	12-08-2026								
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 12-08-2026 to 20-08-2026								
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	14-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura								
4	Bid submission Start Date	12-08-2026								
5	Bid Submission End Date	20-08-2026 upto 1600 Hrs								
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	21-08-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. In case mentioned bid opening date happens to be a holiday then Bid shall be opened at the same time on the next working day.								
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed								

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of Treasury Receipt/e-challan in favour of Executive Engineer PWD(R&B) Division R S Pura through Treasury, indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and Date and name of work duly crediting to 0059 (Revenue) and Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura at the time of allotment.

(The participating contractor may disclose his Bank Account as per the format, devised as Annexure- A of the NIT and submit/upload the same accordingly at the time of submission of the bid).

2. The date of Treasury Challan, Earnest Money/Bid Security must be between the date of start of bid and Bid Submission End Date. However, if the tender for the same work has been re-invited after 1st or More calls, the bidders who have already bid for that work can re-use the same Treasury Challan/Earnest Money/Bid Security in the successive calls for the said work provided there should not be any overwriting or forging on the previously uploaded documents.

3. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidders needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender documents. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.

4. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division R.S. Pura. The date for same shall be intimated separately.

5. The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.

The earnest money shall be forfeited, if :-

- Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
 - Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issuance of letter of acceptance.
 - Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.
 - Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.
 - Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the "Downloads" option as well as from "Bidders Manual Kit" on website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint bid submission process.
 - To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get 'Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)' as per Information Technology Act-2008. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors
 - The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
 - Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
 - Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.
- Note:-** Scan all the documents on 100 dpi with black and white option.
- The department will not be responsible for any delay in online submission due to any reasons.
 - Correctness of Information on the notarized affidavit which must be notarized between the period of downloading of bidding document as per the format mentioned in the e-NIT/SBD with the technical documents of the bid must be uploaded with the bids in the form of scanned copy and also be produced in original at the time of allotment.

No :-
Dated :- DIP/J-8039/26 DATE 13 AUG 2026

Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
R.S. Pura

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	ESTIMATE FOR PURCHASE MOBILE TOILET OF 04 SEATER 06 SEATER 10 SEATER FOR JURISDICTION OF M.C. ROHTAK.	11.08.2026 18.08.2026	31.86 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467283967 xennrohtak@gmail.com
2	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF ROOM AND LIBRARY CHAIR AND RACK AND MISC CIVIL WORK TOILET IN KABER PARK IN WARD NO.5 MC. ROHTAK	11.08.2026 18.08.2026	11.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467717422 xennrohtak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48155/HRY

SALUTE THE SOLDIER



GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9420399 Late Hav Mahendra Rai of 3/11 GR who made supreme sacrifice during Operation Gambir (J&K) on 14 Aug 2008.

COLONEL 11 GR & SIKKIM SCOUTS AND ALL RANKS

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant officers on their Balidan Diwas.



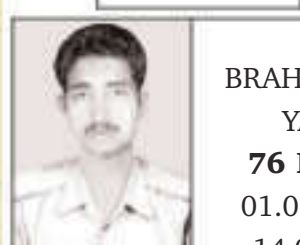
SI
CHAMAN LAL
76 BN BSF
19.11.1937 –
14.08.1990



HC
JAIBIR SINGH
76 BN BSF
14.01.1953 –
14.08.1990



HC ARUN
CHANDRA
BORA
76 BN BSF
30.10.1949 –
14.08.1990



CT
BRAHMANAND
YADAV
76 BN BSF
01.01.1968 –
14.08.1990



CONSTABLE
BISWAJIT SAHA
12 BN BSF
08.02.1971 –
14.08.2003



INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE (ITBP)

ITBP salutes its braveheart Inspector Jitender Singh Chauhan of 31st Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Arunachal Pradesh in 2014.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE



Veer Balidani
Constable
Naresh Mishra
6 Bn
3-2-1937 To
14-8-1965

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Naresh Mishra of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely defending CRPF post Gilli in Poonch, Jammu & Kashmir on 14 August 1965. For his conspicuous gallantry and indomitable valour, he was posthumously awarded the

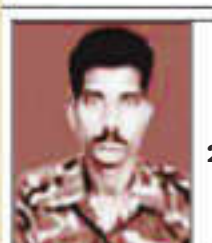
President's Police and Fire Services Medal for Gallantry. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Constable/
Driver
K. Sambaiah
40 Bn
4-9-1966 To
14-8-2000

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable/ Driver K. Sambaiah of 40 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice on 14 August 2000 after succumbing to grievous burn injuries sustained in an IED blast while performing bank encasement duty at SBI Main Branch, Residency Road,

Srinagar on 10 August 2000. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani
Constable
S. Prabhu
210 CoBRA Bn
1-7-1984 To
14-8-2012

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable S. Prabhu of 210 CoBRA Who made the supreme sacrifice in a fierce encounter with Maoists in Bijapur district, Chhattisgarh on 14 August 2012. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

SELECTION OF THE SERVICE PROVIDER FOR DESIGNATED HEALTHCARE FACILITIES

Tender No.: H-PC-LAB-02-2025-26-RT-2; date: 11-08-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **Name of Work:** Selection of the Service Provider for establishment, operation and maintenance of diagnostic laboratories to provide diagnostic services at the designated healthcare facilities of Northeast Frontier Railway based on Central Reference Laboratory, Hub & Spoke Model integrated through Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS). Advertised Value: ₹47,66,631.40. Earnest Money: ₹8,38,500.00. E-tenders will be closed at 12:00 hrs. on 02-09-2026. The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website www.ireps.gov.in

Medical Director, Central Hospital, Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
"Serving Customers with a smile"

North Eastern Railway

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN" E-Tender for the following work. **S.No.01 Name of work:** 25 KV Electrification Work in connection with Provision of Auxiliary Transformer at Interlocking of level Crossing gates irrespective of TVU on account of Restricted visibility in BSB Division with RTU & Power Supply Arrangement (Total 08 Nos LC) Varanasi Division of N.E. Railway. **Tender reference no:** Sr:DEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T18 **Approx. Cost (in Rs.):** 4421743.71 **Earnest Money:** Rs.88400/- **Cost of tender documents (in Rs):** Nil **E-Tender closing date and Time:** 02.09.2026 up to 14:45 Hrs. **Completion period:** 06 Months • Open E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 14:45 Hrs on date 02.09.2026 • For full details and submission of bid, kindly visit the Official website of Indian Railway i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Sr:DEE/TRD Varanasi
CPRO/Elect-141
DO NOT SMOKE BID/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, WATER RESOURCES CIRCLE UDAIPUR
Near Akashvani, Chetak Circle, Udaipur (Rajasthan) 313001
Phone no.: 0294-2414794, Email: sewrcudr@gmail.com

No. SE/Accnt/Salumber/E/2026-27/518 Date- 3-8-2026

E-NIT No. 05/2026-27 WRD2627A0221

S. No	Name of Work	Estimated. Cost of Work (Rs)	Bids for the following work are invited from interested bidders upto
1	Construction of Triveni Anicut Sarni River GP Isarwas PS Salumber District Salumber	234.86 Lac	04-08-2026 to 24-08-2026 at 6:00 PM

Other particulars of bid may be visited on the Procurement portal <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, www.dipr.rajjasthan.gov.in & www.water.rajjasthan.gov.in/wrd

Sd/-
UBN No.- WRD2627WSOB00471 Superintending Engineer
DIPR/C/13957/2026 Water Resources Circle, Udaipur

GUJARAT URJA VIKAS NIGAM LIMITED
CIN U40109GJ2004SGC045195
ISO 9001:2015 Certified Company
Sardar Patel Vidyut Bhavan, Racecourse, Vadodara 390007
PBX: (0265) 2310582-86, www.guvnl.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender Search Code on ISN-ETS: GUVNL-2026-TN000003

GUVNL invites tenders for setting up of 1000 MW / 4000 MWh Standalone Battery Energy Storage Systems in Gujarat under Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding (Phase-X) followed by e-reverse auction. For tender documents, please visit the website www.bharat-electronictender.com and www.guvnl.com. The last date of online bid submission is **14-Sep-2026**.

General Manager (Power Trading)

Government of Jammu and Kashmir
J&K e-Governance Agency
Information Technology Department Civil Secretariat, Srinagar

Subject: Notification for the Chief Minister's Digital Internship Programme, 2026 (Batch-I).

Reference: Government Order No. 36-JK(ITD) of 2026 dated 02-06-2026.

NOTIFICATION No.: 01-JaKeGA of 2026
Date: 11-08-2026

Jammu & Kashmir e-Governance Agency (JaKeGA), Information Technology Department, invites online applications from eligible students and fresh pass-outs of Jammu & Kashmir for participation in the Chief Minister's Digital Internship Programme, 2026 (Batch-I). The detailed guidelines of the Programme are enclosed as Annexure-A.

The schedule for various activities under the Programme is as follows:

S.No.	Activity	Date(s)
1.	Commencement of online application submission	17-08-2026
2.	Last date for submission of online applications	27-08-2026
3.	Publication of shortlist of applicants	By 18-09-2026
4.	Interview of shortlisted candidates	From 21-09-2026 onwards
5.	Commencement of Internship Programme	01-10-2026

For any queries, applicants may contact: eeojakega@nic.in

By Order,
Sd/-
(Asha Choudhary Malhotra), IAS
Chief Executive Officer
J&K e-Governance Agency
Information Technology Department

No.: JaKeGA-Tech/70/2022
Date: 11-08-2026
DIPK-4503/26 Date: Aug 13 2026

EXPRESS Careers

DAYALBAGH EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTE (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY) DAYALBAGH, AGRA-282005

Advt. No. 05 DEI(AYUSH) - August 2026

Online Applications are invited for the following posts of the Homoeopathic Medical College and Hospital, Faculty of Integrated Medicine (AYUSH) of the Dayalbagh Educational Institute (Deemed to be University).

S. No.	Name of the Department	Professor	Associate Professor	Assistant Professor
1.	Homoeopathic Repertory and Case Taking	01	-	-
2.	Pathology and Microbiology	01	-	-
3.	Surgery	-	01	-
4.	Gynaecology and Obstetrics	01	-	-
5.	Homoeopathic Pharmacy	-	01	01
6.	Practice Medicine of Essential with Pharmacology	-	01	-
7.	Organon of Medicine Homoeopathic Philosophy Fundamentals	-	01	01
8.	Community Medicine, Research Methodology and Biostatistics	01	01	-
9.	Yoga Instructor (Male)	-	01	-
10.	Yoga Instructor (Female)	-	01	-

Qualification & Salary: As per NCH Norms.

Application/Registration fees for all Posts Rs. 148/- (*including 18% GST)

Last Date for submission of Application Forms: 31.08.2026

For General Instructions and further information, please visit the Institute's website: www.dei.ac.in

Dated: 05.08.2026 Contact No.: 0562-2570372 Registrar

Central Hindu Military Education Society's BHONSALA MILITARY COLLEGE
NAAC Accredited 'B' Grade
Bhonsala Bhawan, Rambhoomi, Dharmaveer Dr. B. S. Moonje Marg, Nashik 422005 (Maharashtra) info@bhonsala.in
<https://bhonsala.in/> College Office: 0253-2309600/01 9145450480 1 9145450481

REQUIREMENT

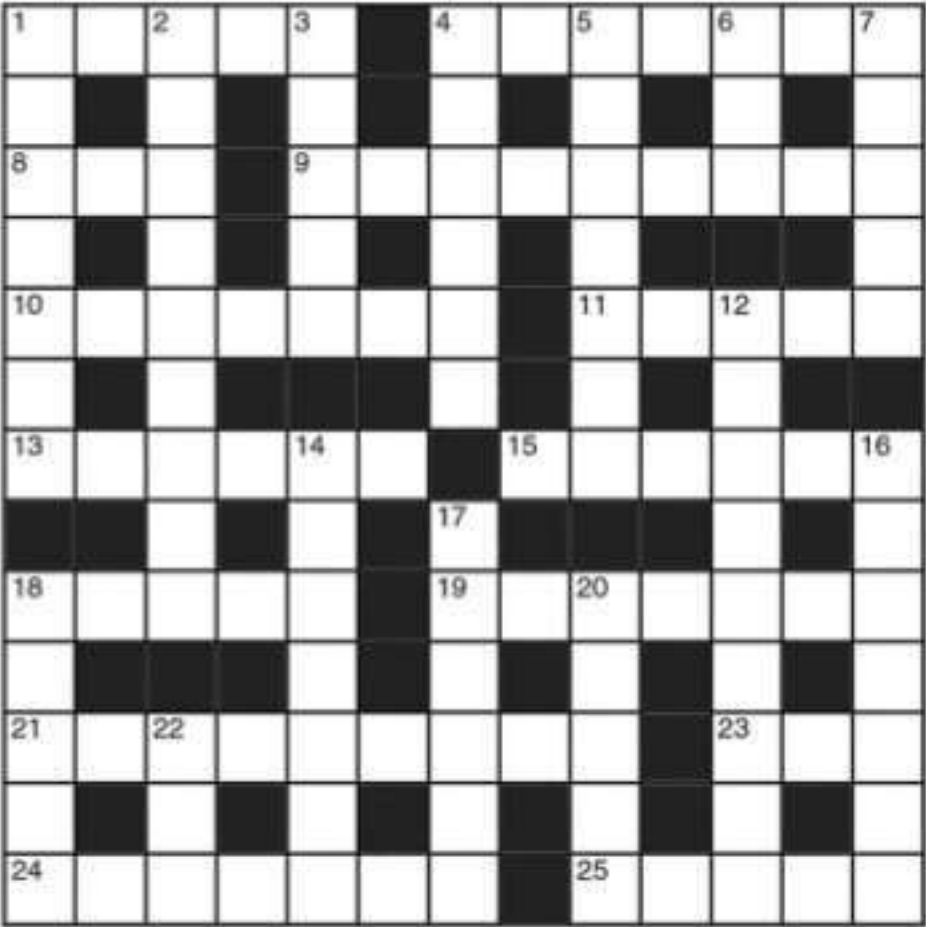
Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the post of Principal to be recruited in Central Hindu Military Education Society's, Bhonsala Military College, Nashik (Arts, Commerce & Science College) affiliated to Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune.

Sr. No.	Name of Post	No. of Post	Reservation	Remark
01	Principal	01	Open to all	Grant in Aid

Terms & Conditions:-

- Essential Qualification: As notified by U.G.C., Government of Maharashtra & Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune (Experience, Age & Pay Scales For this post of Principal shall be as per 7th pay Government Resolutions dated 8th March 2019 & 10th May 2019 with amendments and additions).
- The Appointment to the said post will be for a tenure of 5 years from the date of appointment or up to the attainment of superannuation whichever is earlier.
- Only eligible and qualified candidates should apply along

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- DOWN
- SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6066

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6066 ACROSS: 1 Portending, 8 Cedar, 9 Caveats, 10 Martlet, 11 Dinar, 12 Toddler, 14 Bridal, 17 Panic, 19 Erasing, 21 Sprints, 22 Actor, 23 Escalators DOWN: 2 Ordered, 3 Tyrol, 4 Nicety, 5 Invader, 6 Grain, 7 Astrologer, 8 Come to pass, 13 Laconic, 15 Drifter, 16 Vessel, 18 Norse, 20 Avast

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

The ____ toward success will be the biggest one. — Dennis Watley (5,4)

PEERS

ALTIS

EPYTT

LOPYFP

ANSWER: The first step toward success will be the biggest one. — Dennis Watley

SOLUTIONS: Spree, Tails, Pretty, Floppy

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 3s INSTRUCTIONS

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

SUDOKU 6410

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6409

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Although you might be focused on work today, your best bet is to relax as much as possible and focus on artistic, creative projects. After all, you are the artisan of the zodiac. This entire day is a Moon alert, which is excellent for creativity. Tonight: Just coast.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is the perfect day to entertain at home. It's also a good day to explore fun activities with kids, sports events, the arts, romantic dates and a pleasant stroll outside. This entire day is a Moon alert. Restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Socialise.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Despite a restless feeling you might have to get out and do something, because of today's placement of the Moon, you will also enjoy relaxing at home and taking it easy. Tonight: Relax at home.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Seek out siblings, relatives and neighbours, because you're eager to share your thoughts. A short trip might appeal. Be aware there's a Moon alert all day, so restrict your spending to food and gas. Tonight: Friendly conversations.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Be careful today. With the Sun, Mercury and Jupiter in your sign, you're ready to set out doing exactly what you want. However, all day today is a Moon alert. Furthermore, the Moon is in your Money House. Definitely restrict spending to food and gas. Make no important decisions. Tonight: Maintain your possessions.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the Moon is in your sign, and for this entire day there's a Moon alert. Be aware of this. Don't volunteer for anything. Avoid important decisions. Restrict spending to food and gas. However, have fun. Be creative. Socialise. Tonight: You're strong.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): You're popular, and because there's a Moon alert all day, it's a wonderful day to socialize with everyone. Just remember not to agree to anything important and don't shop. Tonight: Enjoy time alone.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Your ability to talk to authority figures is strong now. However, because there's a Moon alert all day today, keep things light. Get information, but make no decisions. Restrict spending to food and gas. Tonight: Seek out a friend.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You're noticed today. This is fine, but don't stick your neck out by making important declarations. Avoid big decisions. Don't volunteer for anything, because there's a Moon alert all day. Don't shop. (Except for food and gas.) Tonight: Be modest.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You make a lovely impression on everyone. Someone might ask for your advice about a how to make something more attractive. However, today is a poor day to answer important questions because there's a Moon alert all day. Tonight: Explore.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Romance is favoured right now. However, you have the energy to work hard today even if you face shortages and delays because there's a Moon alert all day. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Today it's in your best interest to be cooperative and accommodating with someone else. There's a Moon alert, don't spend money and avoid important decisions. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

LIC reported robust Q1 FY27 results with Profit After Tax rising 22.81% YoY to Rs 13,492 crore. Value of New Business surged 61.32% to Rs 3,136 crore, while the net VNB Margin expanded 750 bps to 22.9%. Total Premium Income grew 6.75% to Rs 1,27,250 crore. Individual New Business Premium rose 14.48% to ₹14,351 crore, and Group Business APE increased 10.20% to Rs 6,160 crore. Non-par APE share within Individual Business improved to 32.49% from 30.34%. LIC maintained market leadership with 60.10% overall FYPI share, 38.89% in Individual and 70.90% in Group. Solvency Ratio strengthened from 2.17 to 2.42, and AUM rose 4.10% to Rs 59.39 crore.



(Technical); Swatantra Kumar Tomar, Director (Finance); and other senior officers and staff.

IHM IHM Dehradun successfully organised "Navagaman 2026", a three-day orientation for newly admitted Diploma and Craftsmanship students from August 5-7, 2026. The programme familiarised students with the hospitality industry, professional expectations, and career opportunities. Industry professionals, including Nikhil Thapa (Lemon Tree Hotel Company), Ashwani Jain (Royal Orchid Hotel), Vimal Bahuguna (Effotel by Sayaji), Shibani Goyal (Perfect Cravings), and Ajay Kumar Manjkhola (Pride Ashiyana Resort), shared insights on industry demand, workplace etiquette, and professional competencies. Faculty members, including HOD Manish Semwal and Dr. Savita, supported the programme, which concluded with emphasis on discipline, skill development, and continuous learning.

CBI CBI's Dehradun Region, led by Regional Head Rajat Bajaj, organized a Mega MSME Credit Outreach Camp at the Center for Aromatic Plants, Selaqui, on August 7, 2026. Dr. Lalit Agarwal, Scientist, served as the event's chief guest. About fifty beneficiaries received loan approval letters totaling Rs 100 crore. He highlighted the Uttarakhand government's Mahak Kranti Yojana and sought the bank's cooperation. He urged existing customers to connect fellow entrepreneurs with the bank. Officials provided information on competitive interest rates and minimal processing fees, encouraging wider participation in the credit outreach programme.



DAV Sarla Chopra DAV Public School solemnly organised its Investiture Ceremony, formally inducting the newly elected Student Council comprising 105 members from the Senior and Junior Wings. Principal Upasana Sharma conferred badges upon the young leaders and encouraged them to lead by example, uphold discipline, and serve with compassion and responsibility. The ceremony was graced by Supervisory Heads, Geetu Sabharwal (Senior Wing) and Ekta Kapoor (Junior Wing). The newly elected leaders took a solemn oath to perform their duties with sincerity, integrity, and dedication, pledging to uphold the values and traditions of the school.

CORPORATE BRIEFS



POWERGRID has acquired two Project SPVs under the TBCB mechanism. Bhadla Ramgarh Power Transmission Limited, acquired on July 29, 2026, will execute augmentation works at substations in Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh, targeting commissioning by January 20, 2029. Krishnagiri REZ Transmission Limited, acquired on August 3, 2026, will establish two new substations in Andhra Pradesh and construct 765 kV and 400 kV lines across Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka, with commissioning within 36 months. It will integrate approximately 4.5 GW of renewable energy from the Kurnool area. Operating on a BOOT basis, these projects strengthen green energy evacuation infrastructure, supporting India's 500 GW renewable capacity target by 2030.

CANARA BANK contributed Rs 25 lakh to the Kerala Chief Minister's Distress Relief Fund on August 10, 2026, as a gesture of solidarity towards flood-affected communities. The cheque was formally handed over to the Hon. CM by Barun Singh Thakur, GM & Circle Head, Thiruvananthapuram Circle, and Santosh V S, General Manager & SLBC Convenor. The contribution reinforces Canara Bank's commitment to supporting the State's relief and rehabilitation initiatives during times of adversity. The gesture received extensive coverage across leading Kerala newspapers.



PHDCCI The Women Leaders' Conclave 2026, themed "Claiming Equity in Viksit Bharat," will be held on August 13-14 at the India International Centre in New Delhi, convening 125+ women leaders nationwide. Building on its successful 2025 Jammu edition, WLC 2026 aims to create a national community for sustained collaboration, mentoring, and policy influence beyond the event. The two-day programme features 13 thematic sessions, over 60 eminent speakers, two book launches, two skits, and two national award presentations. Participants include policymakers, parliamentarians, legal experts, academics, entrepreneurs, and grassroots leaders deliberating on women's leadership, climate change, digital inclusion, livelihoods, and governance. The Dayawati Modi Stree Shakti Samman will be conferred upon Senior Advocate Shobha Gupta, and the Vidushi Vidyottama Stree Shakti Samman upon Sanskrit scholar Dr. Shashi Bala, honouring their impactful contributions to law, justice, and India's intellectual heritage.

BHARAT TAXI will officially launch in Uttar Pradesh with a grand flag-off in Lucknow on August 7, 2026. The event will feature a roadshow of 200 branded cabs and MoUs with state government departments. Operating on a zero-commission cooperative model, Bharat Taxi enables drivers to retain 100% of their earnings while providing affordable, safe, and reliable mobility. Services will begin in Lucknow and Kanpur, with driver onboarding across 16 additional cities. The platform currently serves 44.43 lakh customers nationwide with 8.54 lakh registered drivers.

OIL Oil India Limited reported its highest-ever standalone PAT of Rs 2,870 crore in Q1 FY27, a 2.5x YoY jump, supported by 11% growth in crude oil production and price realisation of \$98.73/bbl. Consolidated PAT rose 97% to Rs 4,027 crore. Crude output reached 0.950 MMT, with record daily production of 10,921 MT on June 27, 2026. Subsidiary NRL posted 167% PAT growth at Rs1,305 crore with a GRM of \$35.95/bbl. Key milestones included a gas discovery in the Andaman Basin and completion of an exploratory well in Assam achieving a record horizontal displacement of 3,116 metres.



NBCC reported robust Q1 FY27 results, with standalone Revenue from Operations rising to Rs 1,823.04 crore from Rs 1,656.77 crore YoY. EBITDA surged 62.05% to Rs 159.89 crore, expanding the EBITDA margin to 8.77%. PBT grew 32.09% to Rs 202.27 crore, while PAT increased 32.06% to Rs 150.65 crore. On a consolidated basis, EBITDA rose 39.02% to Rs 154.95 crore with margins at 6.86%, while PBT and PAT grew 17.27% and 17.02% to Rs 212.79 crore and Rs 158.01 crore, respectively. With a robust order book and diversified strategy spanning redevelopment, PMC works, PSU land monetisation, real estate, and overseas expansion, NBCC is well-positioned for sustained growth and stakeholder value creation.

PRCI in support of the Public Relations Society, New Delhi held the PRCI Transformative Governance Symposium. This high-level forum features supreme court legal professionals, journalists, senior bureaucrats, industry leaders, and media veterans discussing innovative governance models and pathways for nation-building on recently, India Habitat Center, Lodhi Road, New Delhi. The conclave was inaugurated by Hon. Justice P.B. Bhajanthri, CG Basava Prabhu S. Patil, Advocate General of Sikkim, Senior Advocate, Supreme Court of India, along with Guest of Hon. S. Venkat Narayan, Former Editor, India Today, President, Foreign Correspondents' Club. The keynote address by S. Venkat Narayan, explains his journey in the PR sector and governance. Special invites also spoke on various topics ranging from Transformative Governance through Legal Reforms, Governance for Responsible Innovation, Governance as a driver of Service Excellence etc.



IGDTUW Indira Gandhi Delhi Technical University for Women (IGDTUW), successfully organised a three-day Vaani seminar on "Smart Manufacturing in the Era of Industry 4.0". The seminar was fully funded by AICTE. The coordinator of the seminar was Prof Deepti Chhabra & Co - coordinator was Prof N R Chauhan. Faculty members, researchers, and students were part of the event. The interactive sessions provided participants with valuable knowledge of the latest technological advancements and their applications in modern manufacturing. The seminar served as an excellent platform for academic exchange, fostering innovation, collaboration, and awareness of the transformative impact of industry 4.0 on the manufacturing sector. The event concluded with a vote of thanks.



SC DAV Sarla Chopra DAV Public School, Noida, held the Installation Ceremony of Interact Club-Samarpan, formally inducting the newly elected team. Dignitaries included District Interact Chair Rotarian Dr. Mohita Sharma, Rotary President Rotarian Deboleena Choudhary, Interact Chair Rotarian Shivani Rajora, President-Elect Rotarian Manish Rajora, Rotarian Shubham, and Principal Upasana Sharma. The highlight was the badging and pinning ceremony, symbolising leadership responsibilities. The programme featured addresses by dignitaries, presentation of upcoming initiatives, and a Nukkad Natak conveying "Say No to Plastic," which concluded with the Vote of Thanks and Shanti Path.

Engineer, ex-India wicketkeeper, waiting for his Padma Shri award for 53 years

88-year-old former stumper says ‘it was all over the papers’ but claims has ‘not received any communication’; BCCI to write to government

Devendra Pandey
Mumbai, August 13

IT HAS been more than half a century since flamboyant wicketkeeper Farokh Engineer was announced as one of the recipients of the Padma Shri award, but the former India Test player is still waiting to get any tangible evidence of the honour.

Engineer was informed by newspapers in 1973 — when he was still an active India player — that he was chosen for the fourth-highest civilian award by the Government of India. But in the subsequent 53 years, he hasn’t received it, he claims.

Engineer, who is settled in England, said he remembers the time when it was announced and everyone con-

“I was playing in England at the time when the award was announced. Our team manager Hemu Adhikari informed me that I was getting the Padma Shri as it was all over the newspapers. But I haven’t received any communication”

FAROKH ENGINEER,
FORMER INDIA CRICKETER.

gratulated him.

“I was playing in England at the time when the award was

announced. Our team manager Hemu Adhikari informed me that I was getting the Padma Shri as it was all over the newspapers. But I have not received any communication or intimation in this regard. I have been waiting to get my award ever since,” Engineer told *The Indian Express*.

The Padma Awards website — padmaawards.gov.in — has Engineer’s name as one of the awardees for 1973 but what happened subsequently isn’t clear.

“In those days, newspapers were the only source of information. I told Hemu that I haven’t received any intimation from the Government of India, and he said they will write to me officially. But I have not heard anything till date,”



Farokh Engineer is listed among 1973’s Padma awardees. FILE

Engineer said.

According to a source, the BCCI, after hearing about the

matter, will write to the government in this regard in the coming weeks. “The BCCI will

write a letter to the government to highlight what Engineer has said,” the source said.

“I didn’t know whom to write to and just waited and waited over the years. (I thought) That someone from the government will call and inform me. I had informed Arun Jaitley ji (former union minister and ex-BCCI vice president) before he passed away. Recently, I wrote to Jay Shah (ICC chair). Last month, he said he will help me. It’s more than 50 years now. I felt why not try again,” Engineer, who played 46 Tests for India between 1961 and 1975, said.

He was also the first-choice wicketkeeper for the Rest of the World team when they faced England and Australia in the early 1970s. A query to the Min-

“I didn’t know whom to write to and just waited and waited over the years. Recently, I wrote to Jay Shah (ICC chair). Last month, he said he’ll help me. It’s more than 50 years now. I felt why not try again”

ENGINEER,
FORMER INDIA CRICKETER

istry of Home Affairs — which announces the names of the winners — didn’t receive a re-

sponse on Thursday.

Engineer says that the award means a lot to him because he feels Indian through and through.

“I may be living in England but from the bottom of my heart, I’m an Indian. The award means a lot to me and I would love to frame it. I would love to be invited to the Rashtrapati Bhavan. I would love my wife to come with me and receive that. I am 88 years old now, I hope to receive it soon,” he adds.

The Padma Shri is given for distinguished service in the fields of arts, medicine, sports, education and social service. The awardees get a certificate signed by the President of India, a medallion and a miniature replica for ceremonial use. No financial perks are involved.

INDIA'S TOUR OF SRI LANKA

Jayasuriya: From ‘lazy’ to lethal

With 125 wickets from 23 Tests and with scalps of big batting superstars under his belt, the left-arm spinner would be major threat against India

Sandip G
New Delhi, August 13

THE PANDEMIC was raging. Prabath Jayasuriya had nowhere to go. The grounds were empty; gyms were shuttered down; the streets were lonely.

Then one evening in May 2021, his phone buzzed. A national selector’s voice crackled. He was in the squad for the Test series against Bangladesh. A dream was fulfilled. A rush-of-blood journey from Matale to Colombo a decade ago, uncertain times spent attuning with the big city’s ways, years spent on domestic dust bowls, had all been worth it.

However, two days before what could have been his debut, Jayasuriya failed the fitness test; the first — and the only time — that had happened to him.

“My skin-folds were over the permissible limit,” he would admit later. Some sections of the media labelled him “lazy” and accused him of hiding his fitness status. His replacement Praveen Jayawickrama would grab 11 wickets in the game. The door seemed shut. That November, Jayasuriya turned 30. Some of his coaches began to worry whether he could cope with the setback.

“The worry was only for us, not him,” says Piyal Wijetunge, former spin bowling coach of Sri Lanka. “He took everything in his stride and started training with his club (SSC) soon after. He is that kind of a guy, never really lets setbacks affect him. If he is not selected, or dropped, he will try harder to get into the team.”

Wijetunge had mentored Jayasuriya from his academy days in 2012 and remembers how he fought back from a career-threatening back injury soon after his ODI debut in 2018.

“He couldn’t play cricket for almost 12 months. He missed some of his precious years in the game, just when he was on the selectors’ radar. But he came back stronger and continued to pick wickets,” Wijetunge says. “We knew his time would come.”

Life gives second chances. It did indeed, as dramatically as the ripper that spat past Harry Brooks’s defence at Old Trafford. Six months later, Jayasuriya’s phone buzzed again. It was another selector. He was in the squad that would duel Australia. A Covid outbreak in the squad had ruled out the regular spinners.

Jayasuriya made his debut grand, nabbing 12 wickets and the third-best match figures for a debutant. All his gifts manifested; the stock ball that danced and floated with an evil grin, the armer that hissed and fizzed (trapping Steve Smith in front), the topspinner with bounce, and the shrewd maneuvering of the crease.

The coaches were not surprised. In Matale, childhood coach Ravi Punchihewa knew he would make a big impression.

“I knew he would make the occasion special. He picked a wicket with his first ball in his



Prabath Jayasuriya will be the undisputed leader of Sri Lanka’s bowling crew against India. CREIMAS

“He is that kind of a guy, never lets setbacks affect him. If he isn’t selected, or dropped, he will try harder to get into the team. We knew his time would come”

PIYAL WIJETUNGE,
FORMER SPIN BOWLING COACH OF
SRI LANKA.

first two-day game here in Matale. The next day, we had a one-day game, and he picked a wicket with his first ball again,” he recollected.

Sri Lanka would hope he grabs a sizable haul in his first outing against India on the ground where has wheeled out 81 of his 125 Test wickets.

Like his spiritual predecessor Rangana Herath, it’s as though Prabath is plucked out from an anachronistic era. He has a laidback run-up that captures the idyllic pace of life in the country. Everything unfolds in slow-motion, giving the audience ample time to appreciate his art. It is as though the batsman has time to come down the wicket, change his mind, and then go back again. Kane Williamson would testify;

“He picked a wicket with his first ball in his first two-day game here in Matale. The next day, we had a one-day game, and he picked a wicket with his first ball again”

RAVI PUNCHIHEWA
CHILDHOOD COACH OF PRABATH
JAYASURIYA.

once in Galle, he lured the monkish Kiwi out of the crease, foxed him with loop and drop, and left him stranded.

These are traits that have been with Jaysuriya from his early years, says Ravi. “He was already 16-17 when he started playing in the academy. In Matale, we didn’t have the infrastructure to nurture a world-class cricketer. So when he told me that he wanted to shift to Colombo, I spoke with my good friend and coach Dinesh Weerasinghe,” he remembers.

All eggs in one basket

The early days were tough. “I had financial problems. I had no relatives or place to stay. I had to balance all that, and didn’t want to put pressure on my family either,” Jayasuriya said

in the press conference after snaffling 12 wickets on debut.

His father ran an automobile shop and was not keen on him taking up cricket because he was afraid of the risk.

Jayasuriya told Weerasinghe that he would not return to Matale at any cost. Weerasinghe put him in Lumbini College, so that he would not only get the infrastructure but also a place to stay. The high-performance centre coaches spotted him and took him under their wing. “He loves to bowl all the time, without dropping his intensity or quality,” Wijetunge says.

When he isn’t playing, Jaysuriya is at the nets, preparing for the next series, watching batsmen he would bowl to, and putting himself in real-time match situations.

“Before the tour to England, he was bowling defensive lines, getting used to the holding role,” he remembers. Herath’s shadow has leaned over Jaysuriya throughout his career, the fate of every left-arm spinner who came later. He is a different bowler, taller and leaner, less round-arm, and marginally quicker.

But after 125 wickets in 23 games, now the undisputed leader of the bowling crew, with wickets of all batting elites of his time, Jaysuriya is emerging from Herath’s shadow and sketching one of his own.

In post-Pujara era, No.3 auditions continue

In three years, seven batsmen — including Gill — have played at one-down

Lalith Kalidas
New Delhi, August 13

AT THE start of their transition under captain Shubman Gill last year, India benched wrist-spinner Kuldeep Yadav throughout the five-match Test tour of England. It had little to do with Kuldeep’s prowess and more with an unstable spot in the batting order.

India’s faltering Test number three has stripped the team of qualities essential to dominant Test forces: a batting order maintaining equilibrium and an XI bold enough to field all of its match-winners at once. The No.3 churn will resume this week against Sri Lanka in Galle, when India will play a third different batter in the slot in three matches in the current World Test Championship (WTC) cycle.

The glaring absence of a figure synonymous with No.3 has indirectly influenced selections, pushing all-rounders up the pecking order above specialist bowlers. “You have to look at the balance of both batting and bowling to win a match. Just as it’s important to take 20 wickets, it’s equally crucial to post 550-600 runs,” India’s batting coach Sitanshu Kotak had said ahead of the final Test in England last year, indicating a subtle shift in the management’s psyche.

Kuldeep can partly blame the No.3 puzzle for fewer Test caps on his profile. Every time India have come close to a decisive solution in the last few seasons, the answer has slipped away.

The stiffer batting conditions perceived in the WTC reward swift remedies. But since Cheteshwar Pujara’s final Test appearance in June 2023, India are yet to glimpse their next great No.3, capable of matching the legacy left behind by Pujara and his predecessor, Rahul Dravid.

Dravid and Pujara’s solidity defined the idea of India’s one-down batter for 27 years. Together, they have amassed 42 percent (17,030) of all Test runs put by all No. 3 batters for India while appearing in 38 percent (230) of all Tests played by the country.

An able successor was perhaps delayed when Gill embraced the No. 4 spot after his captaincy elevation in 2025. The Punjab batter had initially taken over from Pujara in 2023 and held a reasonable record across 16 matches. Gill remains the only batter to score a cen-



Devdutt Padikkal is primed to bat at No.3 against Sri Lanka. CREIMAS

• India's Test No. 3s since Pujara's last match

Player	Span	Matches	Innings	Runs	HS	Avg	100	50
Shubman Gill	2023-2025	16	29	972	119*	37.38	3	3
B Sai Sudharsan	2025-2026	7	12	383	87	31.91	0	3
Karun Nair	2025	2	4	111	40	27.75	0	0
Virat Kohli	2024	1	2	70	70	35	0	1
Washington Sundar	2025	1	2	60	31	30	0	0
Devdutt Padikkal	2024	1	2	25	25	12.5	0	0
KL Rahul	2024	1	2	4	24	12	0	0

tury at No. 3 for India in the last three years, aggregating 972 runs in 29 innings at 37.38 with three hundreds.

Barring Gill, India have seen six other No.3 batters in the period, yielding 673 runs in 24 innings at a 28.04 average with four half-centuries. Three of them appeared in one Test each due to Gill’s injuries or poor form. The makeshift list includes former captain Virat Kohli, Devdutt Padikkal and KL Rahul. During his short-lived Test comeback in England last year, Karun Nair gathered 111 runs in four innings at the position before losing his spot in the team.

Injuries and instability have also meant that Sai Sudharsan, India’s latest try-out in the position, will be halted for now after being ruled out of the Sri Lanka tour. The left-hander has played seven Tests at No. 3 since his debut, scoring 383 runs at 31.91.

This includes an 87 against the West Indies at home last year and an 81 against Afghanistan this June, outside the WTC calendar. The Tamil Nadu batter’s run was far from straightforward. Five matches in, he was dropped for India’s four-spinners combination against South Africa in Kolkata last year.

Padikkal's turn

With a century under his belt in India’s three-day practice game in Colombo, Padikkal is primed to take over from Sudharsan at No.3 this week, marking a second stint in the role after scoring 25 runs in his last Test in that position against Australia at Perth in November 2024.

He is arguably India’s next best hope to seize a long rope. The Karnataka batter has aggregated 1,152 runs at 57.6 with four centuries since 2024, building one of the stronger No.3 records in domestic cricket in the period.

The mystery swirling around erring No.3s in the WTC is not an intrinsic Indian conundrum but engulfs the entire Test cricket map. No specialist batting position has seen a greater decline in averages in the WTC era than the number 3 position. Across 234 matches since the start of the WTC in August 2019, the No.3s collectively average 33.25, a dip from a 38.64 average in the 234 Tests that preceded the WTC between February 2014 and July 2019.

In finding their next No.3, India will therefore value patience and temperament slightly above the instant gratification of quick runs, akin to Dravid and Pujara’s playbook.

Nihal, Arjun enter playoffs at the Esports World Cup



Nihal Sarin. ESPORTS WORLD CUP

Mayank Chaudhary
Paris, August 13

IF WEDNESDAY was a day of disappointment for the Indians in action at the Esports World Cup 2026, Thursday turned into a day of resurrection. Two of the three, Arjun and Nihal, fought their way back into the playoffs, navigating the elimination rounds to join the likes of Magnus Carlsen, Hikaru Nakamura, Alireza Firouzja and No-dirbek Abdusattorov at the Paris Expo de Versailles.

The path was toughest for Team S8UL’s Nihal and Pranesh. After losing their quarter-final clashes, they found themselves at the bottom of the lower bracket. Nihal had the trickiest route, starting with a clash against Wei Yi.

The Chinese Grandmaster is a tough cookie to crack, and Nihal felt that instantly after letting a completely winning position slip away in the first game. The second game, with reversed colours, also failed to produce a decisive result. And it wasn’t until the Armageddon that Nihal finally broke through, winning with white pieces to book a match against former World Cup winner Jan-Krzysztof Duda.

The Indian continued to showcase his mastery, particularly with the light pieces, as he defeated Duda in their second encounter after drawing the first. The 1.5-0.5 victory propelled him into the playoffs. His advancement also means Team S8UL still harbours hopes of winning their first individual title at the event.

Pranesh also stepped up when he handed Dutch GM Benjamin Bok a defeat to keep his campaign alive. After striking first to take a 1-0 lead, he conceded the next game but managed to hold Bok to a draw in Armageddon with black pieces, enough to book a spot against his compatriot Arjun.

Arjun, who had dismantled Nihal the previous day, swept past Pranesh with ease, winning the clash 2-0. The result ended Pranesh’s campaign, making him the second Indian after Aravindh Chithambaram to be eliminated.

Hans Niemann and Deniz Lazavik were the last two players to secure their spots in the top eight through Group B. The American, fresh off his dramatic Armageddon victory over Ian Nepomniachtchi the previous day, moved ahead after beating Iranian GM Sina Movahed. Lazavik, meanwhile, got the better of Nepomniachtchi, sending him crashing out of the \$1.5 million event.

(*The writer is in Paris at the invitation of the Esports Foundation*)

